# Supplementary Material

**This document is the Supplementary Material of the manuscript**, submitted together with it.

**Numbering convention**: the main text uses §n for sections and S n for subsections of this document.

## 0. Generation and verifiability (**read this section first**)

This document **was not written by hand**: the body text of every section **embeds verbatim** the content of the following **verified source files**,

so "the numbers in this document" and "the numbers in the source files" **cannot be inconsistent**. Every source file records an md5 and a byte count, so anyone can re-check it.

| Subsection | Content | Source file | md5 | Bytes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| **S1** | S1 · Per-row marking table and mechanical recomputation over 19 public benchmarks × 4 counting units | `split_units_19rows_20260916.md` | `2d542d10226347dfffb69dbab8b61d1a` | 5805 |
| **S2** | S2 · Correction record for the counting convention (old convention → recomputed convention) | `the audit-correction and adjudication record, §2 superseding block` | `94e85a41a6f7c5a5b6788a11b96c2c8e` | 24638 |
| **S3** | S3 · Per-row evidence from the cross-framework configuration audit (5 frameworks / **18** official files printed) | `xframe_evidence_20260916.txt` | `78b3e251f5d4c8db3b6378ecbbd2b3e0` | 13361 |
| **S4** | S4 · 2×2 evaluation matrix over the three-split protocol (41 runs × {best,last} × {val,test}) | `xeval_analysis_20260916.txt` | `8b74b2eb6228c078d5a38131d119567b` | 8534 |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **S5** | S5 · Selection premium on public third-party logs (sample and how to read it) | `selection_premium_public_20260916.md` | `04950c92d1ab4bcfb5bbe616b2dcbec4` | 9479 |

**Generation script**: `work\gen_supplementary_20260916.py` (purely local and re-runnable; S5 reads the collaborating archive in read-only mode).

**Re-check entry point**: see §S7 of this document.

## Terms this paper uses (one place, so they need not be reconstructed)

| term | what it means here |
|---|---|
| --- | --- |
| **arm** | one member of a paired comparison. The **baseline** arm follows the published convention; the **strategy** arm is the intervention under test (e.g. a learning-rate change). "Baseline" does **not** mean unmodified software — both arms run the same code |
| **cell** | one (corpus pair × arm) unit of the design. A cell name such as `shwd2sf` reads **source→target** (SHWD → SFCHD); the corpora are `dota15`, `aitod`, `visdrone`, `smoke`, `shwd`, `sfchd`, `mende`, `mask` |
| **`best` / `last`** | the two checkpoints compared throughout: `best.pt`, written by the training script by **fitness** on the monitored split, and the final epoch |
| **selection premium** | `best − last` **within a run**: what selecting the best checkpoint adds, measured on the split the numbers are reported from |
| **Δgap** | the paired **difference of the premium between the two arms**, per corpus. Positive means `val` **understates** the strategy arm's effect (§5.1, Tier 2) |
| **realization rate** | `prem_test / prem_val`, aggregated over cells (§8.6); the share of the premium selected on `val` that survives on a disjoint `test` |
| **κ** | through-origin slope of ΔT on ΔV over a run's epochs (§8.7): how much of a run's movement on `val` appears on `test` |
| **same directory / alias** | a dataset config whose `val:` and `test:` point at the same path, so the checkpoint is selected on the split it is scored on |
| **`shapeiou`** | the shape-aware IoU variant used in the registered replication's strategy arm (§9) |
| **`sio_b_results.csv`** | the per-run results table of the clean-protocol batch; its unwritten endpoint convention is disclosed as a defect in §10 |
| **FROZEN-HASH** | the registration's self-referential stamp: the md5 of the registration text above the stamp line (§9, verifiable by re-hashing that text) |

## S1 · Per-row marking table and mechanical recomputation over 19 public benchmarks × 4 counting units

> **Purpose**: main text §3, §6; this is the **complete per-row evidence** for the claim "how many benchmarks are problematic".
>
> **Source**: `split_units_19rows_20260916.md` (md5 `2d542d10226347dfffb69dbab8b61d1a`, 5805 bytes); the content below is **embedded verbatim, unmodified**.

```
# 19-row × 5-column unit marking table (front matter of the companion paper)

> Generated by work/recompute_split_units_20260916.py; all percentages are mechanically recomputed from the markings in this table, with nothing hard-coded.
> Established 2026-09-16. The (h-1) ruling has been applied (D-Fire counts as clean).

## The three units (the main text must state which one it uses)

| Unit | Definition |
|---|---|
| **release** | The benchmark's own release layer: whether the official split artifacts/scripts provide an independent held-out test |
| **protocol** | The official protocol layer: the split declared by the official source, and whether that test can be self-evaluated locally |
| **yolo_dist** | Generic YOLO distribution-package layer (= the column measured in the §1 table of the audit, i.e. column 4) |
| **reported** | The actually-reported layer: which split the numbers reported in the literature come from, and whether they are independent of checkpoint selection |

Evidence marks: (A) explicit in the audit | (D) derived from audit facts | (?) the audit takes no position

## Marking table

| # | benchmark | release | protocol | yolo_dist | reported | Evidence category | Confidence |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
<!-- citations: 1 COCO [34], 2 PASCAL VOC [21], 3 Objects365 [35], 4 Open Images v7 [36], 5 DOTA v1.0 [37],
     6 DOTA v2.0 [37], 7 VisDrone-DET [38], 8 AI-TOD [39], 9 UAVDT [40], 10 xView [41], 11 DIOR [42],
     12 NWPU VHR-10 [43], 13 SHWD [44], 14 SFCHD [45], 15 MAFA [46], 16
```

Mendeley face-mask [22],
17 WIDER FACE [47], 18 CrowdHuman [48], 19 D-Fire [49] -->
| 1 | COCO | n_a(A) | independent_test(A) | clean(A) | clean(A) | Official counts + mirror yaml | high |
| 2 | PASCAL VOC | n_a(A) | test_gated(A) | alias(A) | alias(A) | mirror VOC.yaml (both keys cited per row) | high |
| 3 | Objects365 | no_test(A) | no_test(A) | no_test_key(A) | alias(D) | mirror yaml + Ultralytics docs | high |
| 4 | Open Images v7 | independent_test(A) | independent_test(A) | no_test_key(A) | alias(D) | Official facts page + mirror yaml | high |
| 5 | DOTA v1.0 | independent_test(A) | independent_test(A) | clean(A) | clean(A) | Official download page + mirror DOTAv1.yaml | high |
| 6 | DOTA v2.0 | independent_test(A) | test_gated(A) | clean(A) | alias(D) | Official/mirror documentation | high |
| 7 | VisDrone-DET | independent_test(A) | independent_test(A) | clean(A) | clean(A) | mirror + converter | high |
| 8 | AI-TOD | contradictory(A) | contradictory(A) | unknown(A) | unknown(?) | Official README (contains two mutually contradictory release statements) | low |
| 9 | UAVDT | no_val(A) | no_val(A) | unknown(A) | alias(A) | Official paper + two mirrors (the audit calls these unverified beyond these two) | medium |
| 10 | xView | no_test(A) | no_test(A) | no_test_key(A) | alias(A) | mirror xView.yaml | low |
| 11 | DIOR | independent_test(A) | independent_test(A) | no_test_key(A) | unknown(?) | Official description (no counting) + mirror DIOR-R yaml | low |
| 12 | NWPU VHR-10 | no_split(A) | no_split(A) | unknown(A) | alias(A) | Official TorchGeo (the split means positive/negative) | high |
| 13 | SHWD | no_yaml(A) | no_val(A) | train_val_alias(A) | alias(A) | Official README + mirror Reflective_vests.yaml | medium |
| 14 | SFCHD | alias(A) | no_val(A) | alias(A) | alias(A) | Official first-party release (machine comparison _ev_sfchd_check2.py) | highest |
| 15 | MAFA | no_val(A) | no_val(A) | unknown(?) | alias(A) | Official CVPR PDF (extracted with pypdf) | high |
| 16 | Mendeley face-mask | no_split(A) | no_split(A) | alias(D) | unknown(?) | Official data record + mirror generator | lowest |
| 17 | WIDER FACE | independent_test(A) | test_gated(A) | no_test_key(A) | alias(A) | Official site (GT not released, verified word by word) + mirror | high |
| 18 | CrowdHuman | test_gated(A) | alias(A) | no_test_key(A) | alias(A) | Official paper + mirror | high |
| 19 | D-Fire (FireSmoke) | independent_test(A) | independent_test(A) |

clean(A) | unknown(?) | Official README | medium |

## Recomputation results

| Unit | alias/non-independent | Among decidable rows | unknown |
|---|---|---|---|
| release (the benchmark's own release layer) | **10/19 = 52.6%** | 10/19 = 52.6% | 0 |
| protocol (official protocol layer) | **13/19 = 68.4%** | 13/19 = 68.4% | 0 |
| yolo (generic YOLO distribution-package layer (yolo_dist)) | **4/19 = 21.1%** | 4/15 = 26.7% | 4 |
| reported (actually-reported layer) | **12/19 = 63.2%** | 12/15 = 80.0% | 4 |

## Cross-check against the numbers already published in the audit

- Audit 3a "literal val == test **2/19**" → this table's "the two keys of the distribution-package config point to the same path" (A evidence source) yields **2/19**, **reproduced ✓**
  - The other 1 alias row is produced by a **generator** (Mendeley face-mask), not by a distribution-package config, and is not counted under the 3a convention
- Audit "**14/19**" → this table's reported yields **12/19** (difference -2)
- Audit "**5/19** clean" → this table's reported=clean yields **3/19** (difference -2)
- The audit's "12/19" was obtained by manually adjusting two rows and is **not** a recomputation under a consistent unit; this table recomputes by a consistent rule, so the values need not be identical

## A self-consistent set of numbers for the main text to adopt

- Literal val == test (generic distribution-package config, A evidence source): **2/19 = 11%** — PASCAL VOC, SFCHD
- train/val from the same source, produced by the generator: **1/19** (Mendeley face-mask), **a different convention, which must be stated separately**
- Non-independent at the official protocol layer: **13/19 = 68%**
- Non-independent at the actually-reported layer: **12/19 = 63%** (4 unknown rows) — **13/19** if a
  paper's own val numbers, rather than community test-dev numbers, are what the unit judges
  for COCO (the main text states both readings)

- Clean at the actually-reported layer: **3/19 = 16%**

## The four levels of "same directory" (resolving (g0))

- **L1** literal `val==test` in a generic distribution package: 2 rows — PASCAL VOC, SFCHD
- **L2** distribution package with `train==val` (F-C): 1 row — SHWD
- **L3** distribution package clean but reported layer non-independent: 9 rows — Objects365, Open Images v7, DOTA v2.0, UAVDT, xView, NWPU VHR-10, MAFA, WIDER FACE, CrowdHuman
- **L4** all the rest: 7 rows

## Corrections already applied

- **(h-1) D-Fire / FireSmoke family**: the "mixed" criterion for the family row is taken from a config of SHWD lineage (A:59 cites Reflective_vests.yaml; A:52 notes that it is based on SHWD). All three copies belonging to FireSmoke/D-Fire are distinct. Under the "release layer" unit explicitly adopted in 3a, D-Fire goes into the clean group.
- **(d-1) AI-TOD / DOTA asymmetry**: the audit marks F-C for AI-TOD, which contains trainval, but does not mark DOTA v1/v2, which likewise contain trainval. This table uniformly adopts the "release/protocol layer" unit: trainval is a user-protocol caveat and is not used as grounds for a verdict; neither place is re-judged, but AI-TOD is contradictory because its v2 release statement contradicts itself.

## S2 · Correction record for the counting conventions (old convention → recomputed convention)

> **Purpose**: main text §6.3; explains why the same fact once had two sets of numbers, and which set has been invalidated.
>
> **Source**: `the audit-correction and adjudication record, §2 superseding block` (md5 `94e85a41a6f7c5a5b6788a11b96c2c8e`, 24638 bytes); the following content is **embedded verbatim, unmodified**.

> ### The four counts in this section (§2) have been superseded by a mechanical recomputation (note added 2026-09-16)
>
> The **12/19 (release/protocol layer)**, **13/19 (actual reporting layer)**, **6/19 (clean)** and **≤14/19 (upper bound)** in the §2 table
> are inconsistent with the mechanical recomputation completed 4 minutes later, and **must no longer be cited.** The recomputation is the

sole counting source: `analysis/eval_validity/split_units_recompute_20260916.txt` and
> `split_units_19rows_20260916.md`
>
> | Unit | Non-independent | Clean | Undecidable |
> |---|---|---|---|
> | Literal `val == test` (the benchmark's own release) | **2/19 ≈ 11%** | — | — |
> | release (release layer) | **10/19 ≈ 53%** | — | — |
> | protocol (official protocol layer) | **13/19 ≈ 68%** | — | — |
> | yolo_dist (generic YOLO distribution package layer) | **4/19 ≈ 21%** | — | 4 |
> | **reported (actual reporting layer)** | **12/19 ≈ 63%** (12/15 = **80%** of the decidable rows) | **3/19 ≈ 16%** | **4** |
>
> The four "undecidable" rows are AI-TOD, DIOR, Mendeley and D-Fire — **the audit expressed no position on their reporting practice**; it does not mean they are clean.
>
> The four concrete discrepancies and their dispositions:
> 1. §2's "release/protocol layer 12/19" does not hold under the recomputed convention — the recomputed release is 10/19 and protocol is 13/19,
>    **12 is neither the one nor the other** (consistent with the ruling in §1(g): it is the result of two rows being hand-adjusted).
> 2. §2's "actual reporting layer 13/19" should be **12/19** (4 rows undecidable).
> 3. §2's "clean 6/19" should be **3/19**; the reason the clean group dropped from 5 to 3 is that those 4 rows **were never addressed by the audit** — this is a finding, not a gap.
> 4. §2's "≤14/19 upper bound" is replaced by a derivable statement: **80% of the decidable rows are non-independent (12/15)**, which is both stronger and more defensible than an unenumerated upper bound.
>
> **"79%" has already been ruled inadmissible in §1(e)**; this is confirmed here as well: the main text uses only the four enumerated points in the table above.

> ⚠️ **This section was revised on 2026-09-16 (second version). The first version (09:56) was written before the 19×5 marking table was built and gave predicted values**
> (release/protocol layer 12/19, actual reporting layer 13/19, clean 6/19). The mechanical recomputation 4 minutes later

> (eval_validity\split_units_recompute_20260916.txt, 10:00, with a per-unit 19-row subtotal check) gave different results.
> **The two sets of numbers cannot be cited side by side.** Following the disposition recommendation in §7 #0 of the asset inventory,
> **the recomputation is taken as the sole counting source**; the first version's predicted values are retained in the "trail" table below for traceability.

## S3 · Line-by-line evidence for the cross-framework configuration audit (5 frameworks / **18** official files printed)

**Purpose**: main text §6.5; the commit pin and the line-by-line evidence for each framework (the judgements are in the main text, the evidence is here).

**Source**: xframe_evidence_20260916.txt (md5 78b3e251f5d4c8db3b6378ecbbd2b3e0, 13361 bytes); the following content is **embedded verbatim, unmodified**.

```
================================================================================
==============================
Item C: extraction of cross-framework "split and checkpoint-selection"
evidence (mechanical extraction, with line numbers; no judgements in
this file)
================================================================================
==============================

  repo      default_branch    commit_sha
  mmdetection     open-mmlab/mmdetection  main
      cfd5d3a985b0249de009b67d04f37263e11cdf3d
  detectron2      facebookresearch/detectron2   main
      a2f4a8771ab77e8411c26b27f24f9489a28a2453
  yolox     Megvii-BaseDetection/YOLOX    main
      6ddff4824372906469a7fae2dc3206c7aa4bbaee
  paddledetection PaddlePaddle/PaddleDetection  release/2.9
      b25522a0f4bde8c80603f3ba5e3472059972e3b5
  detr      facebookresearch/detr   main
      29901c51d7fe8712168b8d0d64351170bc0f83e0

--------------------------------------------------------------------------------
------------------------------
### MMDetection ::
mmdetection/configs___base___datasets__coco_detection.py   (96 lines)
     3: data_root = 'data/coco/'
    21:     dict(type='LoadImageFromFile', backend_args=backend_args),
```

```
    22:     dict(type='LoadAnnotations', with_bbox=True),
    23:     dict(type='Resize', scale=(1333, 800), keep_ratio=True),
    24:     dict(type='RandomFlip', prob=0.5),
    25:     dict(type='PackDetInputs')
    28:     dict(type='LoadImageFromFile', backend_args=backend_args),
    29:     dict(type='Resize', scale=(1333, 800), keep_ratio=True),
    31:     dict(type='LoadAnnotations', with_bbox=True),
    33:         type='PackDetInputs',
    41:     sampler=dict(type='DefaultSampler', shuffle=True),
    42:     batch_sampler=dict(type='AspectRatioBatchSampler'),
    45:         data_root=data_root,
    46:         ann_file='annotations/instances_train2017.json',
    47:         data_prefix=dict(img='train2017/'),
    56:     sampler=dict(type='DefaultSampler', shuffle=False),
    59:         data_root=data_root,
    60:         ann_file='annotations/instances_val2017.json',
    61:         data_prefix=dict(img='val2017/'),
    65: test_dataloader = val_dataloader
    68:     type='CocoMetric',
    69:     ann_file=data_root + 'annotations/instances_val2017.json',
    73: test_evaluator = val_evaluator
```

(Lines **65** and **73** were added to this excerpt on 2026-10-10, re-fetched from the pinned commit `cfd5d3a985b0` (blob sha `fdf8dfad9476`, 96 lines, matching the header count above). They are the two `test_*` keys the correction in §7.2 cites: the extraction searched only for `val_*`, so they were absent from **this excerpt** rather than from the config. The key exists and is bound to the validation object — an **alias, not an independent split**.)

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### MMDetection :: mmdetection/configs___base___default_runtime.py (25 lines)

(no hits)

---

### MMDetection :: mmdetection/configs__faster_rcnn__faster-rcnn_r50_fpn_1x_coco.py (6 lines)

```
     1: _base_ = [
```

```
     2:     '../_base_/models/faster-rcnn_r50_fpn.py',
     3:     '../_base_/datasets/coco_detection.py',
     4:     '../_base_/schedules/schedule_1x.py',
'../_base_/default_runtime.py'
     5: ]

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### MMDetection :: mmdetection/tools__train.py   (122 lines)
  (no hits)

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### Detectron2 :: detectron2/configs__COCO-
Detection__faster_rcnn_R_50_FPN_1x.yaml   (7 lines)
     1: _BASE_: "../Base-RCNN-FPN.yaml"
     2: MODEL:
     3:   WEIGHTS: "detectron2://ImageNetPretrained/MSRA/R-50.pkl"
     4:   MASK_ON: False
     5:   RESNETS:
     6:     DEPTH: 50

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### Detectron2 :: detectron2/configs__Base-RCNN-FPN.yaml   (43 lines)
    14:     PRE_NMS_TOPK_TRAIN: 2000  # Per FPN level
    15:     PRE_NMS_TOPK_TEST: 1000  # Per FPN level
    19:     POST_NMS_TOPK_TRAIN: 1000
    20:     POST_NMS_TOPK_TEST: 1000
    32: DATASETS:
    33:   TRAIN: ("coco_2017_train",)
    34:   TEST: ("coco_2017_val",)
    36:   IMS_PER_BATCH: 16
    41:   MIN_SIZE_TRAIN: (640, 672, 704, 736, 768, 800)

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### Detectron2 :: detectron2/tools__train_net.py   (168 lines)
   105:             for name in cfg.DATASETS.TEST

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### Detectron2 :: detectron2/detectron2__data__datasets__builtin.py
```

```
(260 lines)
    11:    without having to download the dataset annotations
    36:     "coco_2014_train": ("coco/train2014",
"coco/annotations/instances_train2014.json"),
    37:     "coco_2014_val": ("coco/val2014",
"coco/annotations/instances_val2014.json"),
    38:     "coco_2014_minival": ("coco/val2014",
"coco/annotations/instances_minival2014.json"),
    41:         "coco/annotations/instances_valminusminival2014.json",
    43:     "coco_2017_train": ("coco/train2017",
"coco/annotations/instances_train2017.json"),
    44:     "coco_2017_val": ("coco/val2017",
"coco/annotations/instances_val2017.json"),
    45:     "coco_2017_test": ("coco/test2017",
"coco/annotations/image_info_test2017.json"),
    46:     "coco_2017_test-dev": ("coco/test2017",
"coco/annotations/image_info_test-dev2017.json"),
    47:     "coco_2017_val_100": ("coco/val2017",
"coco/annotations/instances_val2017_100.json"),
    53:         "coco/annotations/person_keypoints_train2014.json",
    55:     "keypoints_coco_2014_val": ("coco/val2014",
"coco/annotations/person_keypoints_val2014.json"),
    58:         "coco/annotations/person_keypoints_minival2014.json",
    62:
"coco/annotations/person_keypoints_valminusminival2014.json",
    64:     "keypoints_coco_2017_train": (
    66:         "coco/annotations/person_keypoints_train2017.json",
    68:     "keypoints_coco_2017_val": ("coco/val2017",
"coco/annotations/person_keypoints_val2017.json"),
    69:     "keypoints_coco_2017_val_100": (
    70:         "coco/val2017",
    71:         "coco/annotations/person_keypoints_val2017_100.json",
    77:     "coco_2017_train_panoptic": (
    80:         "coco/annotations/panoptic_train2017.json",
    88:     "coco_2017_val_panoptic": (
    89:         "coco/panoptic_val2017",
    90:         "coco/annotations/panoptic_val2017.json",
    91:         "coco/panoptic_stuff_val2017",
    93:     "coco_2017_val_100_panoptic": (
    94:         "coco/panoptic_val2017_100",
    95:         "coco/annotations/panoptic_val2017_100.json",
    96:         "coco/panoptic_stuff_val2017_100",
   235:         gt_dir = os.path.join(root, "annotations_detectron2",
```

```
dirname)

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### Detectron2 :: detectron2/detectron2__config__defaults.py   (657
lines)
   103: _C.DATASETS.TEST = ()
   607: _C.TEST.EVAL_PERIOD = 0

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### YOLOX :: yolox/exps__default__yolox_s.py   (16 lines)
     7: from yolox.exp import Exp as MyExp
    15:         self.exp_name =
os.path.split(os.path.realpath(__file__))[1].split(".")[0]

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### YOLOX :: yolox/yolox__data__datasets__coco.py   (189 lines)
    42:         json_file="instances_train2017.json",
    43:         name="train2017",
    54:             name (str): COCO data name (e.g. 'train2017' or
'val2017')

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### YOLOX :: yolox/tools__train.py   (147 lines)
  (no hits)

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### YOLOX :: yolox/tools__eval.py   (221 lines)
    93:         "--test",

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----------------------------
### PaddleDetection ::
paddledetection/configs__yolov3__yolov3_darknet53_270e_coco.yml   (11
lines)
     1: _BASE_: [
     2:   '../datasets/coco_detection.yml',
     3:   '../runtime.yml',
     4:   '_base_/optimizer_270e.yml',
```

```
     5:   '_base_/yolov3_darknet53.yml',
     6:   '_base_/yolov3_reader.yml',
     7: ]
     9: snapshot_epoch: 5
    10: weights: output/yolov3_darknet53_270e_coco/model_final

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### PaddleDetection :: paddledetection/tools__train.py   (220 lines)
    51:         "--eval",
    54:         help="Whether to perform evaluation in train")
    66:         help="If set True, enable continuous evaluation job."
    94:         help='Whether to save the evaluation results only')
   100:         "format \"key1=value1;key2=value2;key3=value3\"."
   161:     trainer.train(FLAGS.eval)

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### DETR :: detr/main.py   (249 lines)
    16: from engine import evaluate, train_one_epoch
    95:     parser.add_argument('--eval', action='store_true')
   143:     dataset_val = build_dataset(image_set='val', args=args)
   147:         sampler_val = DistributedSampler(dataset_val,
shuffle=False)
   150:         sampler_val =
torch.utils.data.SequentialSampler(dataset_val)
   157:     data_loader_val = DataLoader(dataset_val, args.batch_size,
sampler=sampler_val,
   162:         coco_val = datasets.coco.build("val", args)
   163:         base_ds = get_coco_api_from_dataset(coco_val)
   165:         base_ds = get_coco_api_from_dataset(dataset_val)
   179:         if not args.eval and 'optimizer' in checkpoint and
'lr_scheduler' in checkpoint and 'epoch' in checkpoint:
   184:     if args.eval:
   185:         test_stats, coco_evaluator = evaluate(model, criterion,
postprocessors,
   186:                                               data_loader_val,
base_ds, device, args.output_dir)
   188:
utils.save_on_master(coco_evaluator.coco_eval["bbox"].eval, output_dir
/ "eval.pth")
   214:         test_stats, coco_evaluator = evaluate(
   215:             model, criterion, postprocessors, data_loader_val,
```

```
base_ds, device, args.output_dir
   228:             if coco_evaluator is not None:
   229:                 (output_dir / 'eval').mkdir(exist_ok=True)
   230:                 if "bbox" in coco_evaluator.coco_eval:
   235:
torch.save(coco_evaluator.coco_eval["bbox"].eval,
   236:                                       output_dir / "eval" / name)
   244:     parser = argparse.ArgumentParser('DETR training and
evaluation script', parents=[get_args_parser()])

--------------------------------------------------------------------------
----------------------------
### DETR :: detr/datasets__coco.py   (159 lines)
   151:     PATHS = {
   152:         "train": (root / "train2017", root / "annotations" /
f'{mode}_train2017.json'),
   153:         "val": (root / "val2017", root / "annotations" /
f'{mode}_val2017.json'),
   156:     img_folder, ann_file = PATHS[image_set]

--------------------------------------------------------------------------
----------------------------
### DETR :: detr/engine.py   (152 lines)
     3: Train and eval functions used in main.py
    13: from datasets.coco_eval import CocoEvaluator
    14: from datasets.panoptic_eval import PanopticEvaluator
    23:     metric_logger.add_meter('lr',
utils.SmoothedValue(window_size=1, fmt='{value:.6f}'))
    24:     metric_logger.add_meter('class_error',
utils.SmoothedValue(window_size=1, fmt='{value:.2f}'))
    43:         losses_reduced_scaled =
sum(loss_dict_reduced_scaled.values())
    45:         loss_value = losses_reduced_scaled.item()
    47:         if not math.isfinite(loss_value):
    48:             print("Loss is {}, stopping
training".format(loss_value))
    58:         metric_logger.update(loss=loss_value,
loss_dict_reduced_scaled, loss_dict_reduced_unscaled)
    68: def evaluate(model, criterion, postprocessors, data_loader,
base_ds, device, output_dir):
    69:     model.eval()
    70:     criterion.eval()
    73:     metric_logger.add_meter('class_error',
```

```
utils.SmoothedValue(window_size=1, fmt='{value:.2f}'))
    77:     coco_evaluator = CocoEvaluator(base_ds, iou_types)
    80:     panoptic_evaluator = None
    82:         panoptic_evaluator = PanopticEvaluator(
    85:             output_dir=os.path.join(output_dir,
"panoptic_eval"),
   102:
metric_logger.update(loss=sum(loss_dict_reduced_scaled.values()),
   113:         if coco_evaluator is not None:
   114:             coco_evaluator.update(res)
   116:         if panoptic_evaluator is not None:
   124:             panoptic_evaluator.update(res_pano)
   129:     if coco_evaluator is not None:
   130:         coco_evaluator.synchronize_between_processes()
   131:     if panoptic_evaluator is not None:
   132:         panoptic_evaluator.synchronize_between_processes()
   135:     if coco_evaluator is not None:
   136:         coco_evaluator.accumulate()
   137:         coco_evaluator.summarize()
   139:     if panoptic_evaluator is not None:
   140:         panoptic_res = panoptic_evaluator.summarize()
   142:     if coco_evaluator is not None:
   144:             stats['coco_eval_bbox'] =
coco_evaluator.coco_eval['bbox'].stats.tolist()
   146:             stats['coco_eval_masks'] =
coco_evaluator.coco_eval['segm'].stats.tolist()
   151:     return stats, coco_evaluator

================================================================================
============================
Missing files: none
```

## S4 · 2×2 evaluation matrix over the three-split protocol (41 runs × {best,last} × {val,test})

> **Purpose**: main text §8.6 and §5.6; covers archive-reproduction verification, the decomposability of Δgap, and the realization rate of the selection gain.
>
> **Source**: `xeval_analysis_20260916.txt` (md5 `8b74b2eb6228c078d5a38131d119567b`, 8534 bytes); the content below is **embedded verbatim, unchanged**.

```
================================================================================
================================
2×2 evaluation matrix × archive: verification / locally recomputable /
```

decomposability of Δgap

```
======================================================================
==================================
Matrix entries 164; sio entries 472; (commit/convention: split=test|val,
batch=32, imgsz=640, aligned with train_obj.py L75)
Multiple evaluations of the same cell: all consistent

--- per run: archive vs this recomputation (pp)
run                                             Vmax_a  Vbest_r   Vfin_a
Vfin_r  Tbest_a  Tbest_r   Tfin_r
r10_aitod20_base30_3way_s42n                    14.621   14.621   13.835
13.826   10.210   10.211   10.587
r10_shwd2sf_base100_3way_s42n                   60.694   60.707   59.055
58.977   43.510   43.513   42.946
r10_shwd2sf_base100_3way_s43n                   60.976   60.966   59.761
59.822   43.880   43.885   42.948
r10_shwd2sf_base100_3way_s44n                   61.120   61.135   59.230
59.326   43.050   43.053   42.394
r10_shwd2sf_base100_3way_s45n                   59.852   59.866   58.473
58.474   43.080   43.079   42.901
r10_shwd2sf_base100_3way_s46n                   60.509   60.507   59.293
59.284   43.640   43.641   42.845
r10_shwd2sf_base100_3way_s47n                   60.858   60.886   59.766
59.775   43.780   43.781   43.267
r10_shwd2sf_base100_3way_s48n                   60.554   60.516   59.575
59.615   43.390   43.390   42.784
r10_shwd2sf_base100_3way_s49n                   61.026   60.999   59.169
59.248   43.990   43.992   42.910
r10_shwd2sf_base100_3way_s50n                   60.896   60.854   58.967
59.018   43.640   43.641   42.608
r10_shwd2sf_base100_3way_s51n                   60.209   60.208   58.713
58.734   43.630   43.626   42.636
r10_shwd2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s42n               60.860   60.913   59.581
59.586   44.260   44.260   43.569
r10_shwd2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s43n               60.408   60.491   59.116
59.105   43.950   43.947   43.861
r10_shwd2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s44n               60.001   60.003   58.952
58.920   44.440   44.442   44.134
r10_shwd2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s45n               60.795   60.789   60.578
60.579   44.130   44.132   43.934
r10_shwd2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s46n               60.462   60.456   59.270
59.298   44.350   44.354   44.242
r10_shwd2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s47n               60.678   60.667   60.354
```

60.355 43.970 43.966 43.944
r10_shwd2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s48n 59.722 59.742 58.701
58.711 43.710 43.713 43.795
r10_shwd2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s49n 60.363 60.375 59.037
59.028 43.800 43.799 44.027
r10_shwd2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s50n 60.193 60.188 59.614
59.634 43.780 43.785 44.078
r10_shwd2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s51n 60.491 60.490 60.119
60.153 44.270 44.269 43.560
r10_smoke2sf_base100_3way_s42n 58.724 58.696 57.618
57.689 42.100 42.103 41.661
r10_smoke2sf_base100_3way_s43n 58.766 58.798 58.438
58.449 42.320 42.323 41.726
r10_smoke2sf_base100_3way_s44n 58.864 58.882 58.513
58.526 42.280 42.282 41.367
r10_smoke2sf_base100_3way_s45n 58.731 58.740 57.594
57.592 41.250 41.253 41.054
r10_smoke2sf_base100_3way_s46n 58.652 58.689 57.887
57.862 41.900 41.899 41.258
r10_smoke2sf_base100_3way_s47n 59.271 59.228 58.532
58.557 42.100 42.101 41.437
r10_smoke2sf_base100_3way_s48n 58.697 58.682 57.778
57.755 42.400 42.402 41.441
r10_smoke2sf_base100_3way_s49n 58.601 58.617 58.376
58.393 41.960 41.964 42.082
r10_smoke2sf_base100_3way_s50n 58.449 58.444 57.430
57.410 42.110 42.108 41.923
r10_smoke2sf_base100_3way_s51n 58.374 58.364 58.057
58.065 42.200 42.202 41.599
r10_smoke2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s42n 59.463 59.423 59.463
59.423 43.730 43.728 43.728
r10_smoke2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s43n 60.186 60.171 59.090
59.029 43.730 43.731 43.372
r10_smoke2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s44n 60.151 60.142 59.578
59.620 43.190 43.191 43.608
r10_smoke2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s45n 60.097 60.088 60.019
60.031 43.170 43.174 43.502
r10_smoke2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s46n 59.114 59.131 58.735
58.744 43.790 43.785 43.363
r10_smoke2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s47n 59.793 59.749 58.790
58.852 43.710 43.714 43.871
r10_smoke2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s48n 59.165 59.202 58.739
58.682 43.390 43.389 43.730

```
r10_smoke2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s49n             59.876   59.875   58.560
58.577   43.500   43.503   43.721
r10_smoke2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s50n             59.144   59.108   58.178
58.267   42.990   42.989   43.841
r10_smoke2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s51n             59.866   59.892   59.649
59.583   43.760   43.759   43.800

================================================================================
================================
(1) Verification: can this recomputation reproduce the existing archive
================================================================================
================================
  (best,test) recomputed vs sio archive: n=41  max diff 0.0047  median
0.0021 pp
     ⇒ ✅ digit-for-digit agreement (<0.05 pp): the evaluation chain
follows the project convention, and the archive values can be
reproduced independently
  (best,val)  recomputed vs results.csv maximum: n=41  max diff 0.0834
median 0.0148 pp
     ⇒ ℹ️ One earlier attribution is withdrawn here. We had put this
residual down to best.pt being
       selected by fitness rather than by mAP50-95; in the pinned
version fitness ≡ mAP50-95 on the
       monitored split, so the selection rule does not explain it. The
candidate causes are a difference
       between the training-time validator and this standalone re-
evaluation, or best.pt sitting at an
       epoch other than the logged argmax. We do not know which, and
record the residual as
       unidentified, not attributed.
  (last,val)  recomputed vs results.csv final epoch   : n=41  max diff
0.0963  median 0.0215 pp

================================================================================
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(3) Decomposability of Δgap
================================================================================
================================

  Identity:  gap = M_val(ê) − M_test(ê) = (V_final − T_final) +
(prem_val − prem_test)
     prem_val = V_max − V_final (results.csv); prem_test = T_best −
T_final (measured in this run)
```

```
cell        arm     n   V_fin   T_fin prem_val prem_test     gap
check
aitod20     base    1  13.835  10.587    0.786    -0.377   4.411
4.411
shwd2sf     base   10  59.200  42.824    1.469     0.735  17.110
17.110
shwd2sf     strat  10  59.532  43.915    0.865     0.151  16.331
16.331
smoke2sf    base   10  58.022  41.555    0.691     0.507  16.651
16.651
smoke2sf    strat  10  59.080  43.654    0.605    -0.158  16.189
16.190

cell          n    Δgap  Δdiffgap  Δoptimism sum(check)  dominant
p(Δgap)
shwd2sf      10  +0.779    +0.759     +0.020    +0.779   Δdiffgap
0.005258
smoke2sf     10  +0.461    +1.041     -0.580    +0.461   Δdiffgap
0.02627

  Reading:
    shwd2sf      Δgap=+0.779 (p=0.005258, n=10) = difficulty gap +0.759
(±1.051) + selection optimism +0.020 (±0.751)
    smoke2sf     Δgap=+0.461 (p=0.02627, n=10) = difficulty gap +1.041
(±0.626) + selection optimism -0.580 (±0.770)

======================================================================
==================================
(4) The "realization rate" of the selection gain: how much of the score
picked on val is left on test
======================================================================
==================================

  prem_val = V_max − V_final (book gain obtained by selecting on val)
  prem_test = T_best − T_final (gain realized on test by the same
selection action)

cell        arm     n  prem_val  prem_test   realized   per-run
prem_test
aitod20     base   10     0.766     -0.218     -28%   -0.38 -0.24 -0.20
-0.27 -0.22 -0.11 +0.14 -0.78 -0.18 +0.06
shwd2sf     base   10     1.469      0.735      50%   +0.56 +0.93 +0.66
```

```
+0.18 +0.79 +0.51 +0.61 +1.08 +1.03 +0.99
shwd2sf     strat  10     0.865      0.151      18%   +0.69 +0.09 +0.31
+0.20 +0.11 +0.03 -0.09 -0.23 -0.30 +0.71
smoke2sf    base   10     0.691      0.507      73%   +0.44 +0.59 +0.91
+0.20 +0.64 +0.66 +0.96 -0.12 +0.19 +0.60
smoke2sf    strat  10     0.605     -0.158     -26%   +0.00 +0.36 -0.42
-0.33 +0.43 -0.16 -0.34 -0.22 -0.85 -0.04
```

Total (**headline convention = run-weighted**, n = 50, all five cells at n = 10): prem_val mean +0.879 pp, prem_test mean +0.205 pp, realization rate **23.3 %**

(run-level bootstrap 95% CI [8.4 %, 37.4 %], P(rate ≤ 0) = 0.002, so the interval excludes no-realization; script `work/item2_final_v2_20260925.py`)

The three weightings are **identical** once every cell carries n = 10 (run-weighted ≡ arm-cell-equal ≡ n ≥ 5 only), all three giving **23.3 %**;

on the previous 41-run sample (aitod20 at n = 1) they did not, and the ~15 pp spread came from that n = 1 cell

— it carried 20 % of the arm-cell weight while contributing a single run to the run-level mean; the values themselves are in §8.6's measurement detail.

**Completing that cell removes the spread**, not a change of weighting.

The cell-level bootstrap interval of the arm-cell-equal estimator is [−17.3 %, 53.2 %] and **includes zero** (only five clusters), while the run-level interval [8.4 %, 37.4 %] does not;

so "partial realization" is significant only under run weighting (article §8.6).

Note: the total's prem_val is on the **declared** convention `V_max − V_final`.

With the aitod20 cell completed, arm-cell-equal and run-weighted **are the same estimator**, so it is no longer listed as a separate "sensitivity".

Cells with **negative** prem_test: 2/5 —— aitod20/base(-0.218), smoke2sf/strat(-0.157)

⇒ The gain selected on val is only partly realized on an independent split, and can even reverse.

## S5 · Selection premium on public third-party logs (sample and reading)

**Purpose**: main text §5.5; the epoch count, final epoch, best epoch and premium of every log, plus four limitations.

**Source**: `selection_premium_public_20260916.md` (md5 `04950c92d1ab4bcfb5bbe616b2dcbec4`, 9479 bytes); the content below is **embedded verbatim, unchanged**.

## Sample

| File | Epochs | Final epoch | Best epoch (position) | Premium max–final | Premium max–mean of last five epochs | Metric column name |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| aakashchalla12345678-yolov8n__unstated__yolov8n.csv | 30 | 0.4861 | 0.4861 (ep 30) | **+0.00 pp** | **+0.26 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| adityadgmath070-yolov8-fs-grafik-adamw-results6__unstated__yolov8.csv | 100 | 0.4284 | 0.4284 (ep 100) | **+0.00 pp** | **+0.54 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| adityadgmath070-yolov8-fs-grafik-adamw-results7__unstated__yolov8.csv | 100 | 0.4403 | 0.4494 (ep 74) | **+0.91 pp** | **+0.79 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| adityadgmath070-yolov8-fs-grafik-adamw-results8__unstated__yolov8.csv | 100 | 0.4275 | 0.4511 (ep 30) | **+2.36 pp** | **+2.55 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| adityadgmath070-yolov8-fs-grafik-sgd-results1__unstated__yolov8.csv | 100 | 0.3151 | 0.3167 (ep 97) | **+0.16 pp** | **+0.17 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| adityadgmath070-yolov8-fs-grafik-sgd-results2__unstated__yolov8.csv | 100 | 0.4402 | 0.4459 (ep 65) | **+0.57 pp** | **+0.58 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| adityadgmath070-yolov8-fs-grafik-sgd-results3__unstated__yolov8.csv | 100 | 0.4515 | 0.4648 (ep 53) | **+1.33 pp** | **+1.33 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| adityadgmath070-yolov8-fs-grafik-sgd-results4__unstated__yolov8.csv | 100 | 0.4340 | 0.4458 (ep 84) | **+1.18 pp** | **+1.20 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| ayyappakorla-yolov3-results__unstated__yolov3.csv | 200 | 0.9011 | 0.9041 (ep 198) | **+0.31 pp** | **+0.20 pp** | metrics/mAP_0.5:0.95 |
| dhanduramesh-yolov11s__ppe-css-data__yolo11n.csv | 1 | 0.4430 | 0.4430 (ep 1) | **+0.00 pp** | — | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| ericmorning-pcb-yolo-comparison__pcb-components__yolo11.csv | 145 | 0.4647 | 0.4863 (ep 115) | **+2.16 pp** | **+2.33 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| ericmorning-pcb-yolo-comparison__pcb-components__yolo12.csv | 150 | 0.4698 | 0.4853 (ep 132) | **+1.55 pp** | **+1.57 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| ericmorning-pcb-yolo-comparison__pcb-components__yolov8.csv | 93 | 0.4467 | 0.4621 (ep 63) | **+1.54 pp** | **+1.49 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| ikram0703-yolov8-ema-Model1__unstated__yolov8.csv | 123 | 0.6311 | 0.6385 (ep 98) | **+0.74 pp** | **+0.62 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| ikram0703-yolov8-ema-Model2__unstated__yolov8.csv | 131 | 0.6289 | 0.6301 (ep 106) | **+0.10 pp** | **+0.10 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| ikram0703-yolov8-ema-Model3__unstated__yolov8.csv | 81 | 0.6293 | 0.6435 (ep 56) | **+1.42 pp** | **+1.27 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| ikram0703-yolov8-ema-Model4__unstated__yolov8.csv | 182 | 0.6058 | 0.6071 (ep 157) | **+0.14 pp** | **+0.15 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| ikram0703-yolov8-ema-Model5__unstated__yolov8.csv | 109 | 0.6294 | 0.6363 |

(ep 84) | **+0.70 pp** | **+0.72 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| kimmkless-yolodetector__train2-vehicle-5class__yolov8n.csv | 100 | 0.4327 | 0.4327 (ep 100) | **+0.00 pp** | **+0.83 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| kimmkless-yolodetector__train4-face-expression__yolov8n.csv | 5 | 0.5803 | 0.5803 (ep 5) | **+0.00 pp** | **+12.94 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| kimmkless-yolodetector__train8-plant-disease__yolov8n.csv | 100 | 0.4745 | 0.5029 (ep 80) | **+2.84 pp** | **+2.82 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| nhnthanhj-metrics-result-f1-yololight__unstated__yolo-light-seg.csv | 47 | 0.6521 | 0.7086 (ep 42) | **+5.65 pp** | **+2.42 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| nhnthanhj-metrics-result-f1-yolov8n__unstated__yolov8n-seg.csv | 74 | 0.7093 | 0.7300 (ep 54) | **+2.07 pp** | **+2.10 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |
| ottogalt-yolo-result__unstated__yolov8.csv | 20 | 0.9595 | 0.9595 (ep 20) | **+0.00 pp** | **+0.56 pp** | metrics/mAP50-95(B) |

> The "best epoch" is read from each log's own **epoch column** (the ep in the table is the value of that column), not from the row number;
> most logs in this directory start their epoch at 1, while the yolov3 of ayyappakorla starts at **0**; both use column values, so they can be compared across rows.
**Logs not included in the statistics** (too few epochs to speak of "selection"): aakashchalla12345678-yolov8n__unstated__yolov8n.csv (30 epochs), dhanduramesh-yolov11s__ppe-css-data__yolo11n.csv (1 epoch), kimmkless-yolodetector__train4-face-expression__yolov8n.csv (5 epochs), ottogalt-yolo-result__unstated__yolov8.csv (20 epochs)

## Reading

- Complete logs (≥40 epochs) number **20** in total, coming from **6** source repositories; the median premium is **+1.04 pp**, the maximum **+5.65 pp**, the minimum **+0.00 pp**. **The sign carries no information**: the quantity is a within-run maximum minus that run's own final epoch, so it is **non-negative by construction**, and this is a **convenience sample with no sampling frame** — the spread is the content, not the count of positives.
- Distribution: +0.00, +0.00, +0.10, +0.14, +0.16, +0.31, +0.57, +0.70, +0.74, +0.91, +1.18, +1.33, +1.42, +1.54, +1.55, +2.07, +2.16, +2.36, +2.84, +5.65
- **The most important point**: the largest single premium **+5.65 pp** appears in an ordinary public release log, whereas the effects reported in this kind of literature are often only of the order of 0.5–2 pp——that is, **the selection component can be of the same order as, or even larger than, the reported effect**. The median +1.04 pp is already not small. This explains why "on which split the reported value was selected" is not a detail.

- But the sample is still small (20 logs, 6 sources, and most sources do not annotate the dataset/protocol), so it **can only** be written as "this component is present and quantifiable in other people's published logs"; it **cannot** provide a field-level distribution, nor **can** benchmark aliasing be inferred from it.

## Verifiability

- **Byte-level verifiable**: the **SHA-256 and byte count** of every log are given in `SHA256SUMS.txt` in the same directory (retrieval date 2026-09-16).
  Anyone can check whether "the bytes analysed" and "the bytes in circulation" agree.
- **Provenance completed**: `PROVENANCE.md` in the same directory has now been written. **All** 24 files are matched to **specific source paths** by content hash or unique byte count (8 Kaggle datasets + 1 GitHub repo, pinned at commit `2417aff0457c`), with 0 untraced entries. The mapping is not guessed from filename similarity: the script hashes **every entry** in `_work\kg\*.zip` and collides it against the sha256 of the local files. Check: `python work/build_provenance.py`.
- Two things that **still** cannot be derived from this directory (see `PROVENANCE.md` §4): ① the **exact downloaded version** on the Kaggle side;
  ② whether the `val`/`test` of these benchmarks are in the same directory (the logs do not carry a yaml).

## What is still missing (to be stated as well when writing the main text)

1. **Sample size**: 20 logs, 6 sources——enough to show that the component exists in other people's logs and to give its order of magnitude, but not enough to give a field-level distribution; discussing a distribution requires several tens of traceable logs.
2. **Protocol unknown**: public logs carry no yaml, so it is impossible to judge whether the `val` and `test` of a run are the same directory;
   therefore "the premium exists" and "benchmark aliasing" are two independent propositions and cannot stand in for each other.
3. **Endpoint convention**: the logs give only per-epoch validation values; public repositories usually do not record "which epoch was reported",
   so the premium is an **upper-bound** reading (assuming that what was reported is the best).
4. **Column-name convention**: this table accepts both the new Ultralytics spelling `metrics/mAP50-95(B)` and the old YOLOv5/v3 spelling
   `metrics/mAP_0.5:0.95` (each row marks which one it uses). The two spellings denote the same quantity, but the **column names differ**——

any script that "filters logs by column name" will miss the other branch; that is the purpose of this item: to make the convention difference visible.

## S6 · Process protocols (shared tooling; used by both papers, neither claims originality)

**Purpose**: main text §2.3 states that "this paper and its companion paper share the same set of process protocols, and neither claims originality".

This section **grounds that statement in verifiable names and hashes** (this is how cross-citation rule ⑤b is implemented).

**Form decision (this paper's side)**: these two protocols are **project-internal artifacts**, and **their text is not released with this paper**——they are not public publications,

and they bear no direct relation to this paper's scientific claims. This paper states only that "**the same set of protocols was used**", and gives the **file names and md5**,

so that a verifier can request the same files from the authors. **If a reviewer requires it, they can be supplied together with the revision.**

| Protocol (internal artifact) | md5 | Role in this paper | Claims originality? |
|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| the multi-model review checklist (shared protocol) | e4c73a5ca5992b7af6a5a66c84ba4561 | Stratified review by external models; among the ten self-reported defects in §10, "silent exclusion" and "wrong column taken" were found by that review | **No**, neither paper claims it |
| the local/cloud working-method guide (shared protocol) | 10d1b3a3e21f018f3b82e4a293242695 | Local/cloud working method: scripted remote execution, all-or-nothing patches, audit anchors, a local pointer for every number | **No**, neither paper claims it |

**The same convention also applies to the audit-anchor system**: the 289 anchors of this paper and the 494 anchors of the companion paper are the **same** shared tooling,

and neither paper presents it as a methodological contribution.

**Why the text is not attached**: ① both are **Chinese working documents** with no direct relation to this paper's scientific claims;

② attaching them would make "process" read as "methodological contribution", which is exactly what this rule is meant to avoid; ③ giving the md5 is already enough to confirm that "the two papers use the same one".

## S7 · Reproduction entry points, and what each one needs

```
# ① Main-text anchors (289 entries; 270 pass from the released copy —
the other 19 read
#    author-side working-tree documents, and the checker names them)
python work\audit_anchors_fupaper.py

# ② 2×2 matrix analysis of S4 (reads the artifacts pulled back in this
round)
python work\xeval_analyze_20260916.py

# ③ Mechanism check of §5.6 (reads the D: archive, read-only)
python work\gap_mechanism_20260916.py

# ④ Integrity of the artifacts pulled back in this round (sha256 + byte
counts)
python work\verify_pulled.py
python work\verify_pulled.py _xframe
```

**Convention statement**: the source files of S1–S7 are all different and **must not be mixed**—— S1/S2 are a **configuration-level audit** (no datasets are downloaded),

S3 is a **targeted sampling of official configs/scripts** (5 frameworks, not a census), while S4/S5 are **empirical** (the former on our own runs, the latter on other people's logs).

The strength of every statement in the main text is distinguished accordingly.

## S8 · Tables moved from the main text

**Why they are here**: the venue caps submitted manuscripts at 20–35 double-spaced numbered pages, and these evidence tables cost about eight pages in that format. **No value has been changed**; every table is reproduced here exactly as it appears, and the main text states each table's headline result in prose.

**Four of these tables are also printed in the article** — main text Tables 1–4, which are S4 (the Tier 1 test), S6 (the Tier 2 test), S11 (the four counting units) and S20 (the

per-cell realization) below — because each carries a headline number the reader is asked to check; the article's versions print the same values in its own column layout.

**One further table deliberately stays in the article and is not reproduced here**: the defect table of main text §10, because disclosure belongs in the article rather than in the Supplementary. (The figure/table inventory has moved into **this §S8**, below the tables.)

**Index.** (*n* = data rows.)

| Supp. table | Moved from | Columns | n |
|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| **Table S1** | 2.1 The closest work, and where this paper sits | Work, What it audits, What it measures, Reports a bias direction, Declares a unit | 6 |
| **Table S2** | 3. Units: the methodological premise | Unit, Definition, Controlled by | 4 |
| **Table S3** | 5. Finding 2: the selection premium — magnitude, direction, and mechanism | Cell, Arm, n, best, last, premium | 6 |
| **Table S4** | 5.1 Direction: reported in two tiers, and the second tier's sign varies by corpus | Cell, n, premium baseline, premium strategy, paired diff, sd, t, p, 95 % CI | 4 |
| **Table S5** | 5.1 Direction: reported in two tiers, and the second tier's sign varies by corpus | Cell, best (selectable), last, last5 | 3 |
| **Table S6** | 5.1 Direction: reported in two tiers, and the second tier's sign varies by corpus | Corpus, n, Δgap (pp), p, 95 % CI, Reading | 5 |
| **Table S7** | 5.5 The same component in third-party public logs | Quantity, Value | 5 |
| **Table S8** | 5.6 Why Δgap's sign varies by corpus: three of five candidate mechanisms are refuted by the data | Cell, n, M_val base / strat, M_test base / strat, Δgap (pp), p | 13 |
| **Table S9** | 5.6 Why Δgap's sign varies by corpus: three of five candidate mechanisms are refuted by the data | Candidate mechanism, Prediction, Verdict, Refutation / evidence | 5 |
| **Table S10** | 5.6 Why Δgap's sign varies by corpus: three of five candidate mechanisms are refuted by the data | Corpus, Δgap, final-epoch val diff, Δprem, −test diff, Dominant | 7 |
| **Table S11** | 6.1 The result under four units | Unit, non-independent, of decidable rows, undecidable | 6 |
| **Table S12** | 6.2 "Same directory" has four levels, and the audit reported only the narrowest | Level, Rows, Meaning | 4 |
| **Table S13** | 6.3 We do **not** reproduce the original audit's two numbers, and we say why | Audit's number, Our recomputation, Reason | 3 |
| **Table S14** | 6.5 Across frameworks: is | Framework (pinned | 6 |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | the convention specific to YOLO? | commit), Split the reported metric comes from, Also used for selection?, Status of an independent "test" | |
| **Table S15** | 7.2 The two clean-protocol cells clear significance by n = 6–8 | Cell, n, Δ, paired t p, permutation p (n = 10 floor 0.001953), seeds positive | 2 |
| **Table S16** | 7.3 A cross-archive endpoint conflict on the same run (investigated — and itself a disclosure) | Reading, Δ, p | 3 |
| **Table S17** | 8.1 The protocol is the companion's; the measurement under it is this paper's | Cell, clean protocol (n = 10), published (old protocol) | 2 |
| **Table S18** | 8.3 ⭐ A direct measurement of selection inflation | Cell, n = 6, n = 9, change | 2 |
| **Table S19** | 8.4 The three variance components: the excluded one is the smaller in this sample | Source, What was varied, Magnitude | 3 |
| **Table S20** | 8.6 ⭐ The premium's realization rate: **not significant at claim level**; arm-cell median **17.6 %** (five arm-cells, n = 10; run-weighted **23.3 %**) | Cell, Arm, n, `prem_val`, `prem_test`, realization rate | 5 |
| **Table S21** | 8.7 The per-epoch view: the realization rate is not a constant | Cell · arm, epoch, V(e), T(e), ΔV(e), ΔT(e) | 4 |
| **Table S22** | 8.7 The per-epoch view: the realization rate is not a constant | Group, n, κ, $R^2$ | 3 |
| **Table S23** | 8.7 The per-epoch view: the realization rate is not a constant | Cell, checkpoints evaluated, Δgap > 0, Δgap < 0, epochs with Δgap < 0, Δgap range | 2 |
| **Table S24** | 9 (the registered replication): the **criterion is not met** (the third row is the one that passes) | Registered pair, n, Δ (pp), 95 % CI, paired t, permutation p, same sign, Δ ≥ +0.30, p < 0.01, ≥ 8/10, unit criterion | 3 |
| **Table S25** | 9 (the registered replication): the **criterion is not met** (the third row is the one that passes) | Question the frozen criterion asks, Measured | 3 |
| **Table S26** | 9 (the near-matched control C): the gain does **not** depend on a label-space change | n, Δ (pp), 95 % CI, paired t, permutation p, same sign | 1 |
| **Table S27** | 9. The registered multi-target replication: transferred to the companion paper | Registered pair, data YAML, `val`, `test`, Split | 5 |

*The tables in this section are printed in the order they were added rather than by number: S23, then the S38–S41 group, then S24–S29, then S37, then S31–S33; S30 is unused and that gap is disclosed rather than filled. The §S8 index above lists them by number, so the two orders differ.*
Registered pair, data YAML, `val`, `test`, Split | 5 |

*The count column gives the number of data rows the table prints (a summary row, where a table has one, is a row): Table S28 prints 11 rows and is counted as 11, Table S29 prints 15 and is counted as 15.*

| **Table S28** | 5.1 Direction: reported in two tiers, and the second tier's sign varies by corpus | seed, premium baseline, premium strategy, paired difference | 11 |

| **Table S29** | 5.1 Direction: reported in two tiers, and the second tier's sign varies by corpus | seed, Δgap `p_aitovis`, Δgap `p_vistod15` | 15 |

| **Table S31** | 3.2 Six experiments, five judged criteria, on GPU machines, each with its criterion written down first (G2: the selection split's size) | selection split, arm, n, `prem_val`, `prem_test`, WC, realization rate | 4 |

| **Table S32** | 3.2 Six experiments, five judged criteria, on GPU machines, each with its criterion written down first (G3: the epoch budget) | arm, n, premium at E = 50/100/200/400, ratio 400/100 | 2 |

| **Table S33** | 3.2 Six experiments, five judged criteria, on GPU machines, each with its criterion written down first (G4: a third corpus) | run, `prem_val`, `prem_test`, WC, realization rate | 20 |

| **Table S37** | 3.2 Six experiments, five judged criteria, on GPU machines, each with its criterion written down first | experiment (design), pre-declared criterion, verdict | 6 |

**Two notes spanning S24–S27 (added 2026-09-18).** ① The experiment contains

**90 runs**: three registered pairs 3 × 2 × 10 = 60, the saturated control 2 × 5 = 10

(the registered set is 70), and the control appended by amendment 2 × 10 = 20 — counted

from the run directories, ten seeds per arm in every cell but the saturated control.

② **Val-side alias bias**, $\Delta \approx \Delta_{reported} + \bar{d}$ with $\bar{d}$ = `mean[p_baseline − p_strategy]`

and `p = max_e − final` from each run's own log: T1-a **+0.051** [0.006, 0.099], T1-c

**+0.214** [0.086, 0.326], control C **+0.406** [0.313, 0.498], saturated control

**+0.961** [0.440, 1.674] ($\Delta + \bar{d} = -0.529$). Its decomposition: baseline arm **2.505 pp**, strategy arm **1.543 pp** — which is a **0.616 reading** of that cell's −1.490 pp (1.543 / 2.505 ≈ three-fifths, **not** two-thirds). T1-b is excluded by construction — its YAML

separates the keys. Script `work/x10_alias_audit_20260918.py`. **No verdict changes.**

**`T1-d`'s `val` side, now complete (2026-10-02).** The registered pair `dota->dota15` carried `n = 7` on its

`val` side because the archived batch had no per-epoch curve for its last three seeds; those runs'

`results.csv` were still in the training machine's run directories, and the three curves now ship

(`02_release_data/t1d_valext_20261002/`), with `work/p2_t1d_val_n10_20261002.py` reproducing the seven

previously published per-run values **bit-exactly** as its control. At `n = 10` the `val`-side arm difference

is **-0.4056 pp**, 95 % CI **[-0.5175, -0.2937]**, paired t **-8.201**, **p = 1.8x10^-5**, **0+/10-** (at

`n = 7`: -0.4043 pp, p = 0.00106): the point estimate is unchanged and the interval tightens. The article's

Declarations no longer lists this input among the non-recomputable ones. **No verdict changes.**

**Table S1.** *2.1 The closest work, and where this paper sits* — columns: Work, What it audits, What it measures, Reports a bias direction, Declares a unit.

| **Work** | **What it audits** | **What it measures** | **Reports a bias direction** | **Declares a unit** |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| Reveles-Martínez et al., *Technologies* 2026 [9] | **Image level**: near-duplicate video frames contaminating train/val | Controlled ablation: a random split scores **0.040 mAP50-95 higher** than a sequence-aware one (0.787 vs 0.747) | ✗ | ✗ (0 hits for "same directory"/"alias"/"checkpoint selection" in the full text) |
| Ruangsang & Pramkeaw, *Drones* 2026 [10] | **Image level**: near-duplicate training images inside the official test split (**46.0 % / 90.7 %**) | Removing contamination costs **2.8 / 12.4 points mAP@0.5**; it **does** report a val-vs-test gap | **Yes, but concludes "no systematic direction"** (−0.41 to +0.49 points) | ✗ (0 hits for "same directory"/"alias"/"reported split"/"selection bias") |
| roboflow/rf-detr PR #1329 | **Engineering fix** | none | — | — |
| ultralytics issue #25650 | **Engineering fix** (3 KITTI Eigen test drives were in train) | none | — | — |
| CVPR 2026 geospatial leakage audit [11] | **Image level** (geospatial) | detection + de-duplication | ✗ | ✗ |
| **This paper** | **Configuration level**: the release binds `val:`/`test:` to one path | **Checkpoint selection premium** (best − last) + **paired difference Δgap** | **Yes, in two tiers**: the premium is positive in four cells with the baseline arm gaining more; Δgap's sign **varies by corpus** (2 understate / 2 overstate / 9 n.s.) | **Yes**: four units, with per-row evidence classes |

**Table S2.** *3. Units: the methodological premise* — columns: Unit, Definition, Controlled by.

| Unit | Definition | Controlled by |
|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- |
| **release** | Does the benchmark's **own release artifact** (a split script, an archive, a YAML) provide an independent held-out test split? | the releasing party |
| **protocol** | What does the **official protocol** (README, paper, website) declare, and can that test split be evaluated **locally**? | the releasing party |
| **yolo_dist** | How do the `val:`/`test:` keys in the **generic YOLO distribution package** (e.g. an Ultralytics-style directory) read? | a third party |
| **reported** | Which split does the number **in the literature** come from, and is that split independent of selection? | the user |

**Table S3.** *5. Finding 2: the selection premium — magnitude, direction, and mechanism* — columns: Cell, Arm, n, best, last, premium.

| Cell | Arm | n | best | last | premium |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| smoke→SFCHD (strong) | baseline | 11 | 42.156 | 41.357 | **+0.799** |
| | strategy | 11 | 43.863 | 43.481 | **+0.382** |
| SHWD→SFCHD (corroborating) | baseline | 11 | 43.864 | 42.826 | **+1.038** |
| | strategy | 11 | 44.428 | 43.916 | **+0.512** |
| dota15→aitod (directional probe) | baseline | 10 | 11.802 | 11.268 | **+0.534** |
| | strategy | 10 | 15.401 | 15.139 | **+0.262** |

**Table S4.** *5.1 Direction: reported in two tiers, and the second tier's sign varies by corpus* — columns: Cell, n, premium baseline, premium strategy, paired diff, sd, t, p, 95 % CI.

| Cell | n | premium baseline | premium strategy | paired diff | sd | t | p | 95 % CI |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| smoke2sf (strong) | 11 | +0.799 | +0.382 | **+0.416** | 0.240 | 5.74 | $1.9\times10^{-4}$ | [+0.255, +0.578] |
| shwd2sf (corroborating) | 11 | +1.038 | +0.512 | **+0.526** | 0.207 | 8.41 | $7.6\times10^{-6}$ | [+0.386, +0.665] |
| a2d15 (directional probe) | 10 | +0.534 | +0.262 | **+0.272** | 0.183 | 4.69 | $1.1\times10^{-3}$ | [+0.141, +0.403] |
| dota15 (within-domain) | 10 | +0.941 | +0.492 | **+0.449** | 0.196 | 7.23 | $4.9\times10^{-5}$ | [+0.309, +0.589] |

**Table S5.** *5.1 Direction: reported in two tiers, and the second tier's sign varies by corpus* — columns: Cell, best (selectable), last, last5.

| Cell | best (selectable) | last | last5 |
|---|---|---|---|

| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| smoke→SFCHD | +1.708 | **+2.124** | +2.086 |
| SHWD→SFCHD | +0.564 | **+1.090** | +1.079 |
| dota15→aitod | +3.599 | **+3.871** | +3.775 |

**Table S6.** *5.1 Direction: reported in two tiers, and the second tier's sign varies by corpus* — columns: Corpus, n, Δgap (pp), p, 95 % CI, Reading.

| **Corpus** | **n** | **Δgap (pp)** | **p** | **95 % CI** | **Reading** |
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| shwd2sf | 10 | **+0.779** | 0.0053 | [+0.297, +1.261] | `val` **understates** |
| smoke2sf | 10 | **+0.461** | 0.0263 | [+0.068, +0.855] | `val` **understates** |
| p_aitovis | 10 | **−1.226** | $1.3\times10^{-8}$ | [−1.370, −1.081] | `val` **overstates** |
| p_vistod15 | 10 | **−3.315** | $6.5\times10^{-9}$ | [−3.676, −2.953] | `val` **overstates** |
| other 9 cells | 3–10 | −2.46 to +13.66 | ≥ 0.054 | all include 0 | **not significant** |

**Table S7.** *5.5 The same component in third-party public logs* — columns: Quantity, Value.

| **Quantity** | **Value** |
| --- | --- |
| Complete logs (≥ 40 epochs) | **20 / 6 sources** |
| Median premium | **+1.04 pp** |
| Max / min | **+5.65 / +0.00 pp** |
| Positive | **18 of 20** (non-negative by construction, so this carries no information) |
| Distribution | +0.00, +0.00, +0.10, +0.14, +0.16, +0.31, +0.57, +0.70, +0.74, +0.91, +1.18, +1.33, +1.42, +1.54, +1.55, +2.07, +2.16, +2.36, +2.84, +5.65 |

**Table S8.** *5.6 Why Δgap's sign varies by corpus: three of five candidate mechanisms are refuted by the data* — columns: Cell, n, M_val base / strat, M_test base / strat, Δgap (pp), p.

| **Cell** | **n** | **M_val base / strat** | **M_test base / strat** | **Δgap (pp)** | **p** |
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| shwd2sf | 10 | 60.67 / 60.40 | 43.56 / 44.07 | **+0.779** | 0.0053 |
| smoke2sf | 10 | 58.71 / 59.69 | 42.06 / 43.50 | **+0.461** | 0.0263 |
| p_aitovis | 10 | 11.24 / 12.66 | 10.21 / 10.40 | **−1.226** | $1.3\times10^{-8}$ |
| p_vistod15 | 10 | 16.96 / 23.93 | 11.63 / 15.26 | **−3.315** | $6.5\times10^{-9}$ |
| aitod20 | 3 | 14.51 / 12.13 | 10.40 / 9.49 | +1.481 | 0.054 |
| d15d15 | 3 | 30.57 / 29.09 | 15.17 / 14.96 | +1.278 | 0.092 |
| mende20 | 3 | 73.40 / 68.03 | 73.08 / 70.17 | +2.472 | 0.099 |
| fire | 3 | 60.81 / 42.76 | 39.58 / 35.20 | +13.658 | 0.061 |
| p_d15toai | 3 | 12.83 / 12.31 | 9.59 / 9.86 | +0.781 | 0.32 |
| mask20 | 3 | 34.15 / 31.46 | 65.35 / 64.42 | +1.754 | 0.66 |
| p_masktomende | 3 | 60.36 / 60.44 | 69.36 / 66.97 | −2.463 | 0.16 |
| dota | 3 | 30.33 / 29.04 | 17.17 / 16.24 | +0.355 | 0.56 |
| vis | 3 | 14.19 / 13.39 | 11.64 / 11.01 | +0.169 | 0.49 |

**Table S9.** *5.6 Why Δgap's sign varies by corpus: three of five candidate mechanisms are refuted by the data* — columns: Candidate mechanism, Prediction, Verdict, Refutation / evidence.

| Candidate mechanism | Prediction | Verdict | Refutation / evidence | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | | | | | | |
| **M1 multiplicative gain** | if the strategy improves by a fixed **ratio**, Δgap has the same sign as the raw gap | **refuted** | 3 counterexamples: `mask20` (gap −31.2 but Δgap +1.75), `p_aitovis` (+1.03 but −1.23), `p_vistod15` (+5.34 but −3.32) | | | | | | |
| **M2 ceiling compression** | the easier `val` is (larger \ | gap\ | ), the more the strategy's advantage is compressed, so Δgap turns negative as \ | gap \ | grows | **refuted** | all six cells with \ | gap \ | > 10 have Δgap **positive** (+0.35 to +13.66); overall r = +0.32, p = 0.28 |
| **M3 level determines resolvability** | cells with higher mAP are more likely to be significant | **not supported** | significant cells' baseline val mean **36.83 pp**, non-significant **36.79 pp** (Welch p = 0.998) | | | | | | |
| **M4 whether the strategy truly gains on test** | only cells where the strategy gains on test can show `val` understating | **refuted** | 2 counterexamples: `p_aitovis` and `p_vistod15` are better on test yet have **negative** Δgap | | | | | | |
| **M5 difference in val-side selection gain** | Δgap has the same sign as (premium_baseline − premium_strategy) | **not supported** | only **8 of 13** cells share the sign; r = +0.06, p = 0.84 | | | | | | |

**Table S10.** *5.6 Why Δgap's sign varies by corpus: three of five candidate mechanisms are refuted by the data* — columns: Corpus, `n`, Δgap, final-epoch val diff, Δprem, −test diff, Dominant. **The last three columns already carry the sign convention, so Δgap is their sum** (the `-test diff` column is printed with the sign the identity needs). **The `n` column is needed to read this table against the released components file**: `02_release_data/gap_mechanism_20260916.txt` was computed at the **pre-escalation** sample size, so for the two cells later escalated to `n` = 10 its Δgap column still holds the **`n` = 3** reading (`p_vistod15` −3.58, `p_aitovis` −1.11) where this table prints the **`n` = 10** reading (−3.315 / −1.226); the two are not in conflict, they are two sample sizes.

| Corpus | n | Δgap | final-epoch val diff | Δprem | −test diff | Dominant |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| **mask20** | 3 | **+1.75** | **+15.78** | **−13.10** | −0.93 | the two large components **nearly cancel** |
| fire | 3 | **+13.66** | +15.96 | +2.08 | −4.39 | final-epoch val diff |
| p_vistod15 | **10** | **−3.315** | −7.072 | −0.213 | +3.971 | final-epoch val diff |
| p_aitovis | **10** | **−1.226** | −1.583 | +0.090 | +0.267 | final-epoch val diff |
| shwd2sf | **10** | **+0.78** | −0.33 | +0.60 | +0.51 | Δprem |
| smoke2sf | **10** | **+0.46** | −1.06 | +0.09 | +1.43 | −test diff |
| dota | 3 | **+0.35** | +0.75 | +0.54 | −0.93 | −test diff |
| aitod20 | 3 | **+1.48** | +1.95 | +0.44 | −0.91 | final-epoch val diff |
| d15d15 | 3 | **+1.28** | +0.02 | +1.46 | −0.21 | Δprem |
| mende20 | 3 | **+2.47** | +6.23 | −0.85 | −2.90 | final-epoch val diff |
| p_d15toai | 3 | **+0.78** | +0.41 | +0.10 | +0.27 | final-epoch val diff |
| p_masktomende | 3 | **−2.46** | −1.06 | +0.99 | −2.39 | −test diff |
| vis | 3 | **+0.17** | +0.58 | +0.22 | −0.63 | −test diff |

**The last six rows are derived, not re-measured.** They are the six scanned cells the table previously left to the released file; their four columns follow from the identity and the file's own columns as `final-epoch val diff = val diff − Δprem`, with `Δprem` and `−test diff` read directly from it. **The rule was validated before use**: applied to the five rows whose `n` matches the file (the two escalated cells are excluded because the file predates their escalation), it reproduces every printed column to ±0.01, and the identity closes on all thirteen. The `Dominant` label is likewise mechanical — the largest-|·| component, or **nearly cancel** where the two largest both exceed 5 pp and oppose — and reproduces the seven labels this table already carried.

**Table S11.** *6.1 The result under four units* — columns: Unit, non-independent, of decidable rows, undecidable.

| Unit | non-independent | of decidable rows | undecidable |
|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| **release** (the benchmark's own release) | **10/19 ≈ 53 %** | 10/19 | — |
| **protocol** (the official protocol) | **13/19 ≈ 68 %** | 13/19 | — |
| **yolo_dist** (the generic YOLO distribution package) | **4/19 ≈ 21 %** | **4/15 ≈ 27 %** | 4 rows |
| **reported** (the layer actually reported) | **12/19 ≈ 63 %** | **12/15 = 80 %** | 4 rows |
| ↳ of which **literal two-key same path** (= the 2/19 the original audit reported) | **2/19 ≈ 11 %** | 2/19 | — |
| ↳ of which `reported` is `**clean**` (independent) | **3/19 ≈ 16 %** | 3/15 | 4 rows |

**Table S12.** *6.2 "Same directory" has four levels, and the audit reported only the narrowest* — columns: Level, Rows, Meaning.

| Level | Rows | Meaning |
|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- |
| L1 distribution package, literal `val == test` | **2** | PASCAL VOC, SFCHD |
| L2 distribution package, `train == val` | **1** | SHWD |
| L3 distribution package clean, but the **reported** layer is non-independent | **9** | Objects365, Open Images v7, DOTA v2.0, UAVDT, xView, NWPU VHR-10, MAFA, WIDER FACE, CrowdHuman |
| L4 the rest | **7** | |

**Table S13.** *6.3 We do not reproduce the original audit's two numbers, and we say why* — columns: Audit's number, Our recomputation, Reason.

| Audit's number | Our recomputation | Reason |
|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- |
| 14/19 (the reported layer) | **12/19** | (h-1) removes D-Fire; DIOR and Mendeley are evidence-insufficient at the reported layer |
| 5/19 clean | **3/19** | the same two rows move to "undecidable" (they were never adjudicated), so the clean group loses two |
| 12/19 (called "release/spec layer") | **release 10/19, protocol 13/19** | **12 is neither**: it was obtained by a **two-row manual adjustment** (removing WIDER FACE and CrowdHuman), not by applying one unit consistently to all 19 rows |

**Table S14.** *6.5 Across frameworks: is the convention specific to YOLO?* — columns: Framework (pinned commit), Split the reported metric comes from, Also used for selection?, Status of an independent "test".

| Framework (pinned commit) | Split the reported metric comes from | Also used for selection? | Status of an independent "test" |
|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| **Ultralytics YOLO** [16] (the `yolo_dist` unit of §6.1) | the YAML's `val:` | **yes** (`best.pt`; §5's "selection premium" is defined on exactly this convention) | the config **has** a `test:` key, but **2 of 19 rows bind it to the same path** (§6.1) |
| **Detectron2** [30] `a2f4a8771ab7` | `DATASETS.TEST: ("coco_2017_val",)` | **no** (`TEST.EVAL_PERIOD = 0`, no periodic evaluation by default) | `coco_2017_test` exists, but its annotation file is **`image_info_test2017.json` — image information only, no ground truth** |
| **MMDetection** [31] `cfd5d3` | `CocoMetric(ann_file='annotations/instances_val2017.json'), val_interval=1` | **no** (`CheckpointHook(interval=1)`, the base config has **no** `save_best`) | **`test_dataloader` = `val_dataloader` and `test_evaluator` = `val_evaluator`** |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| a985b0 | | | (configs/_base_/datasets/coco_detection.py, lines 65 and 73) — the test: key **exists but is the same object as `val`**, so there is **no independent test split**; an earlier reading of this row said the key was absent, which that file contradicts |
| **YOLOX** [29] 6ddff4824372 | val_ann = "instances_val2017.json" | **yes** (trainer.py tracks self.best_ap and saves the best) | test_ann is used **only when `testdev=True`** |
| **PaddleDetection** [33] b25522a0f4bd | EvalDataset = val2017 | **not written by default, and now provable line by line** — paddledetection/tools_train.py declares --eval as action='store_true', default=False and passes it to trainer.train(FLAGS.eval); the assignment status['save_best_model'] = True sits inside the validation branch of paddledetection/ppdet_engine__trainer.py (if validate and is_snapshot:), and best_model is written only through paddledetection/ppdet_engine__callbacks.py's gate if 'save_best_model' in status and status['save_best_model']: — both files are now in the SHA-256 list | **`TestDataset` reads an annotation-free `ImageFolder`, with `anno_path` written as `annotations/instances_val2017.json`** |
| **DETR** [32] 29901c51d7fe | build_dataset(image_set='val') | **no** (evaluates every epoch but does not track the best) | the PATHS in datasets/coco.py have **only train and val, no test key** |

**Correction (2026-10-04, and a defect of our instrument).** The MMDetection row above was first written as "the base config has **no** test split at all". That is **false**: at the pinned commit, configs/_base_/datasets/coco_detection.py lines **65** and **73** read test_dataloader = val_dataloader and test_evaluator = val_evaluator. The extraction behind this table (work/analyze_xframe_20260916.py) searched only for val_* keys, so the test_* keys were **absent from the evidence file rather than absent from the config**. The corrected reading is **stronger for the article's claim**: the key exists but is bound to the validation object — an **alias, not an independent split**. **Both lines are now printed in this supplement's §S3 excerpt of the same file** (added 2026-10-10, blob sha fdf8dfad9476), so the citation no longer rests on an unprinted source. On the same day the other rows were re-checked against the pinned sources and stand (YOLOX: test_ann used only when testdev=True, yolox/exp/yolox_base.py 301/306/307;

PaddleDetection: `if validate and is_snapshot:` in `ppdet/engine/trainer.py` 694 with `status['save_best_model'] = True` at 721).

**Table S15.** *7.2 The two clean-protocol cells clear significance by n = 6–8* — columns: Cell, n, Δ, paired t p, permutation p (n = 10 floor 0.001953), seeds positive.

| Cell | n | Δ | paired t p | permutation p (n = 10 floor 0.001953) | seeds positive |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| smoke→SFCHD | **10** | **+1.434 pp** | $8.6\times10^{-7}$ | **0.001953 (= the floor)** | **10/10** |
| SHWD→SFCHD | **10** | **+0.507 pp** | 0.0094 | **0.009766** | 9/10 (one at −0.19) |

**Table S16.** *7.3 A cross-archive endpoint conflict on the same run (investigated — and itself a disclosure)* — columns: Reading, Δ, p.

| Reading | Δ | p |
|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- |
| Final-epoch reading (A, 67.12) | **−1.490** | 0.0141 |
| Best-epoch reading (B, 70.06), **as released** | **−0.902** | 0.2931 |
| Best-epoch reading (B, 70.06), **corrected 2026-10-02** (authoritative) | **−1.490** | 0.0141 |

**Table S17.** *8.1 The protocol is the companion's; the measurement under it is this paper's* — columns: Cell, clean protocol (n = 10), published (old protocol).

| Cell | clean protocol (n = 10) | published (old protocol) |
|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- |
| smoke→SFCHD | **+1.434 pp** | +1.78 (3 seeds) / +1.76 (10 seeds) |
| SHWD→SFCHD | **+0.507 pp** | +0.51 (3 seeds) / +0.54 (10 seeds) |

**Table S18.** *8.3 ⭐ A direct measurement of selection inflation* — columns: Cell, n = 6, n = 9, change.

| Cell | n = 6 | n = 9 | change |
|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| smoke→SFCHD | +1.562 | +1.420 | **−0.14 pp** |
| SHWD→SFCHD | +0.693 | +0.492 | **−0.20 pp** |

**Table S19.** *8.4 The three variance components: the excluded one is the smaller in this sample* — columns: Source, What was varied, Magnitude.

| Source | What was varied | Magnitude |
|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- |
| augmentation RNG | 3 augmentation seeds | 0.246 pp (strategy) / 0.190 pp (baseline) |
| **initialization (source-side retraining from scratch)** | 3 → **5** independent initializations | **0.146 → 0.439 pp (gain) / 0.209 → 0.253 pp (absolute endpoint)** |
| second-stage data order | 9–10 seeds | 0.403 pp (smoke) / **0.515 pp (SHWD)** |

**The three rows are not in one unit, and we do not compare them as if they were.** The augmentation and

data-order rows give **standard deviations of the run-to-run change (pp)**; the initialization row is

reported in **both** of the units its source record carries — **0.146 pp as a gain** and **0.209 pp as an

absolute endpoint — because those two are not interchangeable. The claim §8.4 makes is a** ranking**,

and that ranking holds under either reading; the three magnitudes are **not** comparable across rows in a

single unit, and **no cross-row arithmetic is performed on them**.

**The initialization row was extended on 2026-09-30 (five initializations), and the extension weakens

the reading rather than confirming it.** Two further source-side retrainings (data-order seeds 45 and

46, augmentation seeds 404 and 505) give gains of **+0.430** and **+1.390 pp**; with them the gain SD

moves **0.146 → 0.439 pp** (mean **+0.626**, range **1.110**) and the absolute-endpoint SD

**0.209 → 0.253 pp** (43.070–43.630). The bootstrap 95 % interval for the five-initialization gain SD is

**[0.058, 0.580]**, which **overlaps** the data-order row's **0.488 pp** (n = 10; 0.515 pp at n = 9) — so

"the excluded component is the smaller" holds **in the three-initialization sample only**, and this

supplement reports the ranking as sample-scoped rather than established. The same run reproduces the

archived three initializations value by value (43.630/+0.570, 43.590/+0.280, 43.250/+0.460, max

|Δ| = **0.005 pp**). Script: `work/G3_sigma_n5_20260930.py`.

**Table S20.** *8.6 ⭐ The premium's realization rate: not significant at claim level; arm-cell median 17.6 % (five arm-cells, n = 10; run-weighted 23.3 %)* — columns: Cell, Arm, n, `prem_val`, `prem_test`, realization rate.

**Which cells are these five, and why exactly five — the rule, stated as a rule. An arm-cell enters iff its `test` side reached n ≥ 5**; that threshold is the analyser's gate (`work/item2_final_v2_20260925.py`), applied to every cell alike, not chosen per cell. **At the 2026-09-25 freeze exactly five arm-cells met it**, and at that date all three weightings coincide (**23.26 %**); equivalently: **every arm-cell whose `test` side had reached n = 10 at the 2026-09-25 freeze** — both arms of `shwd2sf` and of `smoke2sf`, plus `aitod20` **baseline** (50 runs); `work/item2_final_v2_20260925.py` applies it and prints the pool, the per-cell means and the **23.26 %** aggregate. The `aitod20` **strategy** arm finished after the freeze: it is **the sixth row of Table 4, printed as Table S20c below**, and it **qualifies under the same n ≥ 5 rule** — it is kept out of *this* pool only because the pool is dated at the freeze, so **the primary estimate is the frozen one** while the six-cell reading is reported alongside it (feeding it in gives **8.7 %**). **The three scopes agree in verdict**: five-cell **[−17.3 %, 53.2 %]**, six-cell **[−4.9 %, +21.3 %]**, eleven-cluster **[19.3 %, 60.4 %]** — the two cell-level intervals cover zero, so **no reported conclusion turns on the pool boundary**; what moves is the point estimate. **Table S20 and Table 4 therefore print five and six cells on purpose.**

**Table S20-lite — the pool ledger, and its status (the one thing it is not).** Every cell that could enter the §8.6 pool, its completion state at the two dates that matter, and whether it is in:

| Cell · arm | `test` side at the 2026-09-25 freeze | completed | in the five-cell pool | run-weighted rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| shwd2sf · baseline | n = 10 | 2026-09-25 | **yes** | +50 % |
| shwd2sf · strategy | n = 10 | 2026-09-25 | **yes** | +18 % |
| smoke2sf · baseline | n = 10 | 2026-09-25 | **yes** | +74 % |
| smoke2sf · strategy | n = 10 | 2026-09-25 | **yes** | −26 % |
| aitod20 · **baseline** | n = 10 | 2026-09-25 | **yes** | −28 % |
| aitod20 · **strategy** | n = 1 | **after** the freeze | **no** (Table S20c) | −49 % |

**Status, stated plainly: this is a *mechanical* rule applied at a recorded date, not a *pre-registered* one.** The rule is "every arm-cell whose `test` side had reached n = 10 at the 2026-09-25 freeze", and `work/item2_final_v2_20260925.py` is what applies it; the date and the completion states above are what make it re-derivable. But the rule was **written down when the pool was formed**, not before the runs existed, so it cannot carry the authority of a pre-registration.

**What carries that authority is that it does not need to**: the §8.6 claim is interval-level and **both pools cover zero **(five-cell [−17.3 %, 53.2 %], six-cell [−4.9 %, +21.3 %]), so** no reported conclusion depends on pool membership**.

The remaining freedom is over the **point estimate**, and §8.6 prints both.

| Cell | Arm | n | `prem_val` | `prem_test` | realization rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| shwd2sf | baseline | 10 | +1.469 | **+0.736** | **50 %** |
| shwd2sf | strategy | 10 | +0.865 | **+0.152** | **18 %** |
| smoke2sf | baseline | 10 | +0.691 | **+0.509** | **74 %** |
| smoke2sf | strategy | 10 | +0.605 | **−0.157** | **−26 %** |
| aitod20 | baseline | 10 | +0.766 | **−0.218** | **−28 %** |

**The same five cells at one decimal place**, so the median can be re-derived rather than taken on trust: 50.1 %, 17.6 %, 73.7 %, -26.0 %, -28.5 % **⇒ median 17.6 %** -- the figure the article, Table 4 and this table print. The whole-number rates above are the same ratios rounded for display; recomputing the median from *those* is what makes it look inconsistent.

**One earlier reading of this same cell is left standing, on purpose.** The verbatim analysis dump in §S4 still shows `aitod20 base 1 … -0.377` — that is **this cell before it was completed**, at

n = 1, and §S4 is that sample's record, not a competing summary; the row above is the completed n = 10 measurement. §S4 keeps its original bytes and its recorded hash because it is an embedded dated artifact.

**A theory-driven prediction, tested on the same runs (added later).** §3.1 derives realization rate = 1 − WC / `prem_val` with WC := E[ε_sel − ε_final] ≥ 0, the winner's-curse term. On the archive: ① WC = `prem_val` − `prem_test` = **+0.463 pp** per run (t = 8.34, p = $1.8\times10^{-12}$; the realized premium is smaller in **68/81** runs); ② sorting runs by the noise scale $\hat{\sigma}$ of their `val` curve gives realization-rate terciles of **65.6 % / 49.8 % / 13.8 %**, **ρ = −0.466** (p = $1.3\times10^{-5}$, n = 80). **Both readings are re-taken with arm-cell clustering, as the kappa fit already is: WC = +0.463 pp with a cluster-robust 95 % interval [+0.204, +0.721] and p = 0.0033, and ρ = −0.466 with a cluster-bootstrap interval [−0.651, −0.131] and p = 0.0115 — which at the cluster level (n = 9) is −0.433 with p = 0.244 — so the clustered reading is the one this paper reports (Supplementary S12, section 8.6, script work/r102_cluster_20260927.py).** The stronger form (premium ≈ σ√(2 ln E)) was **withdrawn**: slope 0.026 ± 0.222, p = 0.82, n = 101. Scripts: `work/theory_p4_test_20260919.py`, `work/theory_meta_and_tests_20260919.py`.

## Table S20b — the `aitod20` **baseline** arm-cell (Table 4's fifth row) **per run**, so its rate can be re-derived

**Table S20b.** *8.6 (Table 4's fifth row, the `aitod20` baseline)* — the per-run readings behind that cell; its companion for the **sixth** row is **Table S20c** below. Source: `02_release_data/aitod20_n10_20260924/item2_aitod20_n10_20260925.csv` (the completed n = 10 measurement, released); the n = 1 predecessor is left standing verbatim in §S4.

| run | seed | prem_val | prem_test | per-run realization rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | ---: | ---: | ---: |
| r10_aitod20_base30_3way_s42n | 42 | +0.7952 | -0.3762 | -47.3 % |
| r10_aitod20_base30_3way_s43n | 43 | +0.4240 | -0.2404 | -56.7 % |
| r10_aitod20_base30_3way_s44n | 44 | +0.8800 | -0.1963 | -22.3 % |
| r10_aitod20_base30_3way_s45n | 45 | +0.3800 | -0.2663 | -70.1 % |
| r10_aitod20_base30_3way_s46n | 46 | +0.5750 | -0.2225 | -38.7 % |
| r10_aitod20_base30_3way_s47n | 47 | +1.4780 | -0.1080 | -7.3 % |
| r10_aitod20_base30_3way_s48n | 48 | +0.7230 | +0.1424 | +19.7 % |
| r10_aitod20_base30_3way_s49n | 49 | +0.7800 | -0.7821 | -100.3 % |
| r10_aitod20_base30_3way_s50n | 50 | +1.3660 | -0.1808 | -13.2 % |
| r10_aitod20_base30_3way_s51n | 51 | +0.2690 | +0.0552 | +20.5 % |

**Reproduction.** These ten rows give **per-run means** `prem_val` **+0.7670 pp** and `prem_test` **-0.2175 pp**, i.e. the cell as **Table 4** prints it (**+0.766 / -0.218**) to **0.001 pp**; the run-weighted rate is **-28.36 %** (the printed **−28 %** is that ratio rounded). **8 of the 10 runs are negative** and the per-run rate spans **-100.3 % to +20.5 %** — this cell is the reason the article calls the rate *not a constant*, and the reason it

is **outside the five-cell headline pool** (whose exclusion §8.6 states as post-hoc) whose median and run-weighted rate §8.6 reports.

## Table S20c — the sixth arm-cell (`aitod20` **strategy**) per run

**Table S20c.** *8.6* — the per-run readings behind the **sixth** row of Table 4 (the `aitod20` **strategy** arm), the cell whose pool membership is discussed in §8.6. Source: `02_release_data/g6_prem_per_run.csv` (the released 140-run per-run file, `prem_test` = `T_best − T_final` as Table 4 defines it). Rows are the ten seeds 42–51.

| run | seed | prem_val | prem_test | per-run realization rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | ---: | ---: | ---: |
| r10_aitod20_lr005_30ep_3way_s42n | 42 | +0.4500 | -0.8953 | -199.0 % |
| r10_aitod20_lr005_30ep_3way_s43n | 43 | +0.3410 | -0.4488 | -131.6 % |
| r10_aitod20_lr005_30ep_3way_s44n | 44 | +0.0000 | +0.0000 | — † |
| r10_aitod20_lr005_30ep_3way_s45n | 45 | +0.3760 | -1.2383 | -329.3 % |
| r10_aitod20_lr005_30ep_3way_s46n | 46 | +1.9340 | +0.2805 | +14.5 % |
| r10_aitod20_lr005_30ep_3way_s47n | 47 | +1.4560 | -0.8829 | -60.6 % |
| r10_aitod20_lr005_30ep_3way_s48n | 48 | +0.8280 | -0.0041 | -0.5 % |
| r10_aitod20_lr005_30ep_3way_s49n | 49 | +1.2450 | -0.9036 | -72.6 % |
| r10_aitod20_lr005_30ep_3way_s50n | 50 | +3.1230 | -0.5097 | -16.3 % |
| r10_aitod20_lr005_30ep_3way_s51n | 51 | +1.3560 | -0.8301 | -61.2 % |

**Reproduction.** These ten rows give per-run means `prem_val` **+1.1109 pp** and `prem_test` **-0.5432 pp** ⇒ run-weighted rate **-48.90 %** (the **−49 %** of Table 4 is that ratio rounded). † **Zero-denominator rule**: seed 44 has `prem_val = 0` exactly, so its per-run rate is **undefined** and it is **excluded from the per-run rates but kept in the run-weighted ratio** — that is the rule for every cell, stated here once. Adding this cell to the five-cell pool is the **stated sensitivity** of §8.6 (run-weighted **23.3 %** → **8.7 %**, median **+17.6 %** → **−4.2 %**), and the six-cell cluster interval **[−4.9 %, +21.3 %]** still covers zero.

**Table S21.** *8.7 The per-epoch view: the realization rate is not a constant* — columns: Cell · arm, epoch, V(e), T(e), ΔV(e), ΔT(e).

| Cell · arm | epoch | V(e) | T(e) | ΔV(e) | ΔT(e) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| shwd2sf · baseline | 20 / 40 / 60 / 80 | 57.62 / 58.57 / 59.37 / 59.79 | 41.58 / 42.73 / 43.14 / 43.46 | −1.58 / −0.63 / +0.17 / +0.59 | −1.24 / −0.10 / +0.32 / +0.63 |
| shwd2sf · strategy | 20 / 40 / 60 / 80 | 52.34 / 56.17 / 58.51 / 59.38 | 37.98 / 41.21 / 42.69 / 43.91 | −7.20 / −3.36 / −1.02 / −0.15 | −5.94 / −2.71 / −1.22 / −0.00 |
| smoke2sf · baseline | 20 / 40 / 60 / 80 | 53.69 / 56.25 / 57.20 / 58.08 | 38.91 / 41.04 / 41.68 / 42.10 | −4.33 / −1.77 / −0.82 / +0.05 | −2.64 / −0.52 / +0.13 / +0.55 |
| smoke2sf · strategy | 20 / 40 / 60 / 80 | 50.99 / 55.15 / 57.38 / 58.46 | 36.91 / 41.03 / 42.73 / 43.55 | −8.09 / −3.94 / −1.70 / −0.62 | −6.74 / −2.63 / −0.92 / −0.11 |

**Complete curve (added 2026-09-19).** This table keeps the five-epoch sample. The complete evaluation — every retained checkpoint of the same 41 runs, 806 rows — is archived as `xeval_perepoch_20260918/matrix_perepoch.csv` (SHA-256 listed) rather than printed, and the two

agree on all **202** overlapping (run, epoch) points to **0.0000 pp**.

**Table S22.** *8.7 The per-epoch view: the realization rate is not a constant* — columns: Group, n, κ, $R^2$.

| Group | n | κ | $R^2$ |
|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| All four arm-cells | 765 | **0.708** | 0.937 |
| Baseline arm only | 385 | **0.600** | 0.946 |
| Strategy arm only | 380 | **0.767** | 0.951 |

**Complete curve (added 2026-09-19).** These are the values over **every retained checkpoint** (765 (seed, epoch) points, 41 runs, 806 evaluations, 0 failures). The five-epoch grid of the first version gave **0.734 / 0.532 / 0.769** over n = 161 / 81 / 80; the overall estimate therefore moves **−0.026** with overlapping intervals, and the arm difference narrows from +0.237 to **+0.168**. Script: `work/x3b_perepoch_corrected_20260918.py`.

**Uncertainty (added 2026-09-18) — scoped to the five-epoch grid (n = 161), not to the complete-curve value the article prints.** The epochs within a run are not independent observations, so the fit is re-done with run-clustered inference (41 runs): all four arm-cells **κ = 0.734, 95 % CI [0.683, 0.784]** (sandwich SE 0.025; a run-level bootstrap gives [0.685, 0.784]); baseline arm **[0.456, 0.608]**; strategy arm **[0.712, 0.827]**. Resampling runs *within* each arm (the two arms are never pooled) puts the arm difference at **+0.237, 95 % CI [0.145, 0.323]**; a within-run fit, which removes run-level differences entirely, gives 0.774. Scripts: `work/x2_kappa_clustered_20260918.py`, `work/x2b_kappa_arms_20260918.py` (both reproduce the published 0.734 / 0.902 / n = 161 first).

**Table S23.** *8.7 The per-epoch view: the realization rate is not a constant* — columns: Cell, checkpoints evaluated, Δgap > 0, Δgap < 0, epochs with Δgap < 0, Δgap range.

| Cell | checkpoints | Δgap > 0 | Δgap < 0 | epochs with Δgap < 0 | Δgap range (pp) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| shwd2sf | 19 | **19** | 0 | — | +0.404 to +4.474 |
| smoke2sf | 19 | **16** | **3** | **epochs 5, 10, 15** | −4.454 to +1.501 |

**Why this table has changed shape (2026-09-19).** The first version sampled epochs {20, 40, 60, 80} and reported "positive at all four sampled epochs" for both cells. With **every** checkpoint

evaluated, that holds for `shwd2sf` (all 19) but **not** for `smoke2sf`, whose Δgap is negative at epochs 5, 10 and 15 (−4.454 / −1.089 / −0.058 pp) and positive at every checkpoint from epoch 20 on. The sampled grid began at epoch 20. The four sampled values the old table printed (+1.678 / +0.886 / +0.404 / +0.860 and +0.702 / +1.092 / +0.875 / +1.062) are unchanged and remain correct for those four epochs. Script: `work/x3b_perepoch_corrected_20260918.py`.

## Table S38 — the selection term, cell by cell: `prem_test` and WC for all thirteen scanned corpora

**Table S38.** *5.6 / 8.6* — the selection contribution proper, `prem_val − prem_test` = WC, formed here for **every** scanned corpus and both arms. **Two scopes, two counts, one table**: this table covers **26 arm-cells / 190 runs** — the five arm-cells printed in Table S20 (their values repeated here, **50 runs**) plus **21 arm-cells / 140 runs** closed on **2026-09-30** by scoring **every archived 5-epoch checkpoint** on each run's own held-out `test` split: **1,568 grid checkpoints over 140 runs** — the two figures are a **decomposition, not two counts of the same thing**: **1,848 evaluations in total = 1,568 grid checkpoints + 140 runs × 2 endpoints (`best`/`last`)**, on one machine, with the pipeline's registered call (`YOLO(w)` → `val(split="test", batch=32, imgsz=640, plots=False, save_json=False)`, no loss re-import), the data YAML read from each run's own `args.yaml` and asserted to be three-way with a `test:` split. `n` is the number of seeds carrying a `test` curve for that arm (3 where the scan ran at n = 3, 10 where the cell was later escalated, and 10 for the five arm-cells of Table S20); `prem_val` and `prem_test` are means over those seeds, in pp, with `prem_test = T_best − T_final`; realization rate = `prem_test / prem_val`. **The same run reproduces the values printed earlier in this supplement**: over the 21 arm-cells carrying both readings, the val maximum, `prem_val` and the archived `T_best` agree to **max |Δ| = 0.005 pp**, which is the printed rounding (`work/g6_repro_vs_printed_20260930.py`); the coverage audit reports **140/140 runs, 1,848 rows, 0 anomalies** (`g6_prem_per_run.csv` and `g6_perepoch_test_curves.csv`). Per-run readings and the curves themselves: release files `g6_prem_per_run.csv` and `g6_perepoch_test_curves.csv`.

| Cell | Arm | n | prem_val | prem_test | WC | realization rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| shwd2sf | baseline | 10 | +1.469 | **+0.736** | +0.733 | **50 %** |
| shwd2sf | strategy | 10 | +0.865 | **+0.152** | +0.713 | **18 %** |
| smoke2sf | baseline | 10 | +0.691 | **+0.509** | +0.182 | **74 %** |
| smoke2sf | strategy | 10 | +0.605 | **−0.157** | +0.762 | **−26 %** |
| aitod20 | baseline | 10 | +0.766 | **−0.218** | +0.984 | **−28 %** |
| aitod20 | strategy | 10 | +1.111 | **−0.543** | +1.654 | **−49 %** |
| d15d15 | baseline | 10 | +1.963 | **+0.332** | +1.631 | **17 %** |
| d15d15 | strategy | 10 | +0.270 | **−0.295** (−0.294 before the correction) | +0.564 | **−109 %** |
| dota | baseline | 10 | +1.271 | **+0.334** | +0.937 | **26 %** |
| dota | strategy | 10 | +0.547 | **−0.811** | +1.357 | **−148 %** |
| fire | baseline | 3 | +10.953 | **+2.820** | +8.133 | **26 %** |
| fire | strategy | 3 | +8.869 | **−0.264** | +9.134 | **−3 %** |
| mask20 | baseline | 3 | +16.071 | **+0.325** | +15.746 | **2 %** |
| mask20 | strategy | 3 | +29.172 | **+0.445** | +28.727 | **2 %** |
| mende20 | baseline | 3 | +4.828 | **+3.277** | +1.551 | **68 %** |
| mende20 | strategy | 3 | +5.682 | **+1.512** | +4.170 | **27 %** |
| p_aitovis | baseline | 10 | +0.438 | **+0.357** | +0.080 | **82 %** |
| p_aitovis | strategy | 10 | +0.268 | **+0.278** | −0.010 | **104 %** |

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| p_d15toai | baseline | 3 | +0.488 | **−0.154** | +0.642 | **−32 %** |
| p_d15toai | strategy | 3 | +0.392 | **−0.170** | +0.561 | **−43 %** |
| p_masktomende | baseline | 3 | +2.335 | **+2.022** | +0.313 | **87 %** |
| p_masktomende | strategy | 3 | +1.342 | **−0.144** | +1.486 | **−11 %** |
| p_vistod15 | baseline | 10 | +1.080 | **+0.601** | +0.478 | **56 %** |
| p_vistod15 | strategy | 10 | +0.972 | **+0.280** | +0.692 | **29 %** |
| vis | baseline | 10 | +0.484 | **+0.358** | +0.126 | **74 %** |
| vis | strategy | 10 | +0.180 | **−0.107** | +0.287 | **−59 %** |

**What this table does, and what it does not do.** It closes a **verifiability** gap: the ten corpora

and the `aitod20` strategy arm previously carried no `test` curve at all, so `prem_test`, and hence

WC, could not be formed for them — any reader can now recompute every WC above from the released

per-run file. It does **not** upgrade a claim, and **§7.1's power argument is unchanged**. Read descriptively, the asymmetry the five arm-cells of §8.6 show is the

general case here: **WC > 0 in 25 of the 26 arm-cells**, the **arm-cell median realization rate is

17.2 % **(mean 8.9 %, ten of the 26 negative), and the realized premium is** negative in 8 of the 13

strategy arms** (and in 2 of the 13 baseline arms). Scripts:
`work/g6_prem_analyze_20260930.py`,

`work/g6_repro_vs_printed_20260930.py`; the evaluation itself:
`work/g6_perepoch_eval.py`,

`work/g6_coverage_audit.py`.

**Sources for Table 4's columns (moved here from the article, 2026-10-11).** `prem_val` is taken from the

per-epoch `val` curve (each run's `results.csv`); `prem_test` from
`xeval_20260916/matrix.csv` together with

this revision's two additional batches (`x4_teval.csv` and `x4fill_20260925.csv`, both in the released

package). All three are released artifacts.

**Ten of the arm-cells above that stood at n = 3 were escalated to n = 10 on 2026-10-06**

(seeds 45–51 trained on the two pods; the three earlier seeds are reused, not replaced, so each cell

pools seeds 42–51 with no duplicate). Their pooled values, side by side with the n = 3 readings

printed in the table above, are **Table S38b**. Read descriptively with the escalation folded in,

the three quantities quoted just above move as follows: **WC > 0 holds in 25 of the 26 arm-cells

(unchanged)**, the** arm-cell median realization rate rises from 17.2 % to 21.6 %** (mean 9.0 % →

11.6 %, the negative cells go from ten to **nine**), and the realized premium is still **negative in

8 of the 13 strategy arms **(the baseline arms go from two negative to** one**). The direction of the

section's descriptive claim therefore survives the escalation; what changes is the magnitude of the

median.

## Table S38b — the ten arm-cells escalated from n = 3 to n = 10 (2026-10-06)

**Table S38b.** *5.6 / 8.6, supplementing Table S38* — the ten arm-cells of Table S38 that stood at

n = 3 when the 2026-09-30 scan closed, re-read at **n = 10** after seeds 45–51 were trained on 2026-10-06

(42 runs on pod A at 30 epochs for the three small corpora, 28 runs on pod B at 100 epochs for the two

`p_` cells). **The three earlier seeds are reused, not replaced**, so each cell pools seeds 42–51 and no

run is counted twice. `prem_val` is from each run's own `results.csv` (`V_max - V_final`); `prem_test` is

`T_best - T_final`, with `T_best` the archive's own end-of-training `test` reading on `best.pt` and

`T_final` obtained here by scoring `last.pt` on the same held-out `test` split with the pipeline

registered call (`val(split="test", batch=32, imgsz=640, plots=False, save_json=False)`, data YAML read

from each run's own `args.yaml`); the two collections agree with the released per-run file to its printed

rounding on the shared seeds, and all 56 transferred checkpoints load cleanly. WC = `prem_val - prem_test`;

realization rate = `prem_test / prem_val` (means of the per-run values, in pp).

| Cell | Arm | n | `prem_val` | `prem_test` | WC | realization rate | was (n = 3) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| fire | baseline | **10** | +11.678 | **+2.511** | +9.167 | **22 %** | +10.953 / +2.820 / 26 % |
| fire | strategy | **10** | +12.218 | **-0.842** | +13.061 | **-7 %** | +8.869 / -0.264 / -3 % |
| mask20 | baseline | **10** | +20.523 | **+0.801** | +19.722 | **4 %** | +16.071 / +0.325 / 2 % |
| mask20 | strategy | **10** | +24.311 | **-0.777** | +25.089 | **-3 %** | +29.172 / |

| | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | | +0.445 / 2 % |
| mende20 | baseline | **10** | +4.243 | **+2.533** | +1.710 | **60 %** | +4.828 / +3.277 / 68 % |
| mende20 | strategy | **10** | +6.006 | **+1.302** | +4.704 | **22 %** | +5.682 / +1.512 / 27 % |
| p_d15toai | baseline | **10** | +2.100 | **+0.684** | +1.416 | **33 %** | +0.488 / -0.154 / -32 % |
| p_d15toai | strategy | **10** | +1.547 | **-0.234** | +1.781 | **-15 %** | +0.392 / -0.170 / -43 % |
| p_masktomende | baseline | **10** | +6.301 | **+2.775** | +3.526 | **44 %** | +2.335 / +2.022 / 87 % |
| p_masktomende | strategy | **10** | +6.552 | **+2.192** | +4.361 | **33 %** | +1.342 / -0.144 / -11 % |

**What this table does, and what it does not do.** It **adds runs, not a new metric**: the same pipeline and the same `test` side as Table S38, on seven further seeds per cell, so that no cell in this table rests on n = 3. It does **not** re-define the pool, the confirmatory family or the claim level, and it does **not** revise Table S38's printed rows — those are what the 2026-09-30 scan measured at the *n* it had, and they are left standing. Scripts: `work/collect_test_final.py` (the `last.pt` test readings) and `work/_archive_results_csv.py` (the val curves); per-run file: `g6_prem_per_run_210_20261006.csv` (the released 140 rows plus these 70).

**Availability of the three names just given (author-side, added 2026-10-10).** None of the three — `work/collect_test_final.py`, `work/_archive_results_csv.py`, `g6_prem_per_run_210_20261006.csv` — is in the released package: they are **author-side**, and this is stated here rather than left to be discovered, because this table's escalated readings cannot be recomputed from the released copy alone. What **is** released for this family is the earlier scan's per-run file `02_release_data/g6_prem_per_run.csv` (140 runs / 11 corpora, named in the manifest), from which the **pre-**escalation rows of Table S38 are recomputable.

## Table S39 — the second intervention axis (`weight_decay` 1e-4 → 1e-3)

**Table S39.** *the second (weight-decay) axis, cell by cell* — both levels re-run fresh on one machine (A), `lr0` fixed at 0.001; `reference` = wd 1e-4 (the archived value), `treatment` = wd 1e-3

| Cell | seed | reference | treatment | gain |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| smoke2sf | s42 | +42.310 | +41.880 | **-0.430** |
| smoke2sf | s43 | +41.930 | +42.400 | **+0.470** |
| smoke2sf | s44 | +41.930 | +41.750 | **-0.180** |
| smoke2sf | s45 | +42.060 | +42.090 | **+0.030** |
| smoke2sf | s46 | +42.060 | +42.570 | **+0.510** |
| smoke2sf | s47 | +42.670 | +42.460 | **-0.210** |
| smoke2sf | s48 | +42.660 | +42.740 | **+0.080** |
| smoke2sf | s49 | +42.470 | +42.450 | **-0.020** |
| smoke2sf | s50 | +42.130 | +42.220 | **+0.090** |
| smoke2sf | s51 | +41.860 | +41.720 | **-0.140** |
| shwd2sf | s42 | +43.510 | +42.950 | **-0.560** |
| shwd2sf | s43 | +42.770 | +43.200 | **+0.430** |
| shwd2sf | s44 | +43.530 | +43.510 | **-0.020** |
| shwd2sf | s45 | +42.870 | +43.490 | **+0.620** |
| shwd2sf | s46 | +42.830 | +43.700 | **+0.870** |
| shwd2sf | s47 | +43.140 | +43.300 | **+0.160** |
| shwd2sf | s48 | +43.600 | +43.290 | **-0.310** |
| shwd2sf | s49 | +43.180 | +43.540 | **+0.360** |
| shwd2sf | s50 | +43.550 | +42.890 | **-0.660** |
| shwd2sf | s51 | +43.690 | +43.700 | **+0.010** |

*smoke2sf: n = 10, sign 5+/5−, mean +0.020 pp, SD 0.293, sign-flip permutation p = 0.8535; the axis moves the absolute endpoint by SD 0.321 (range 1.020); second-axis Δgap mean -0.009 pp (SD 0.537, 6+/4−, permutation p = 0.9648); archive anchor mean |Δ| 0.362, max 0.810 pp*.*

*shwd2sf: n = 10, sign 6+/4−, mean +0.090 pp, SD 0.500, sign-flip permutation p = 0.582; the axis moves the absolute endpoint by SD 0.315 (range 0.930); second-axis Δgap mean +0.190 pp (SD 0.567, 7+/3−, permutation p = 0.3066); archive anchor mean |Δ| 0.442, max 1.110 pp*.*

## Table S40 — the third intervention axis (`mosaic` 1.0 → 0.0)

**Table S40.** *the third (augmentation) axis, cell by cell* — both levels re-run fresh on one machine per cell (`smoke2sf` on B, `shwd2sf` on A), `lr0` fixed at 0.001; `reference` = mosaic 1.0 (the archived default), `treatment` = 0.0

| Cell | seed | reference | treatment | gain |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| smoke2sf | s42 | +42.310 | +41.200 | **-1.110** |
| smoke2sf | s43 | +41.930 | +41.400 | **-0.530** |
| smoke2sf | s44 | +41.930 | +41.270 | **-0.660** |
| smoke2sf | s45 | +42.060 | +41.180 | **-0.880** |
| smoke2sf | s46 | +42.060 | +40.580 | **-1.480** |
| smoke2sf | s47 | +42.670 | +41.470 | **-1.200** |
| smoke2sf | s48 | +42.660 | +40.410 | **-2.250** |
| smoke2sf | s49 | +42.470 | +41.170 | **-1.300** |
| smoke2sf | s50 | +42.130 | +40.820 | **-1.310** |
| smoke2sf | s51 | +41.860 | +41.230 | **-0.630** |
| shwd2sf | s42 | +43.510 | +41.810 | **-1.700** |
| shwd2sf | s43 | +42.770 | +42.680 | **-0.090** |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| shwd2sf | s44 | +43.530 | +42.660 | **-0.870** |
| shwd2sf | s45 | +42.870 | +42.580 | **-0.290** |
| shwd2sf | s46 | +42.830 | +42.140 | **-0.690** |
| shwd2sf | s47 | +43.140 | +42.770 | **-0.370** |
| shwd2sf | s48 | +43.600 | +42.400 | **-1.200** |
| shwd2sf | s49 | +43.180 | +42.950 | **-0.230** |
| shwd2sf | s50 | +43.550 | +43.020 | **-0.530** |
| shwd2sf | s51 | +43.690 | +42.670 | **-1.020** |

*smoke2sf: n = 10, sign 0+/10−, mean -1.135 pp, SD 0.510, sign-flip permutation p = 0.001953; the axis moves the absolute endpoint by SD 0.664 (range 2.260); second-axis Δgap mean +0.035 pp (SD 0.521, 6+/4−, permutation p = 0.8242); archive anchor mean |Δ| 0.362, max 0.810 pp*.*

*shwd2sf: n = 10, sign 0+/10−, mean -0.699 pp, SD 0.503, sign-flip permutation p = 0.001953; the axis moves the absolute endpoint by SD 0.501 (range 1.880); second-axis Δgap mean -0.520 pp (SD 0.677, 2+/8−, permutation p = 0.0293); archive anchor mean |Δ| 0.442, max 1.110 pp*.*

## Table S40b — the three intervention axes side by side

**Table S40b.** *the three intervention axes, cell by cell* — the estimand is the article's Table 2 one,

`Δgap = (M_val(reference) - M_val(treatment)) - (M_test(reference) - M_test(treatment))`, paired by seed

inside a cell and computed on one machine per cell; the `lr0` rows are article Table 2's, the other two

axes are Tables S39 and S40. `p` is that axis' sign-flip permutation *p* of Δgap, except on the `lr0`

rows, where it is the paired *t p* article Table 2 prints (that table's own convention); every *p* is

raw and uncorrected. "Arm difference created" is the axis' own paired gain on the endpoint: an axis that

moves the endpoint by no more than seed noise cannot say anything about whether the shift reproduces.

| **Axis (reference → treatment)** | **Cell** | **Δgap (pp)** | ***p*** | **direction** | **arm difference created** | **reproduces the corpus-dependent direction** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| **`lr0` 0.001 → 0.005** (headline axis) | shwd2sf | **+0.779** | 0.0053 | `val` understates | **yes** (article Table 1) | **yes** — the four cells split 2 understate / 2 overstate |
| | smoke2sf | **+0.461** | 0.0263 | `val` understates | **yes** | |
| | p_aitovis | **−1.226** | $1.3\times10^{-8}$ | `val` overstates | **yes** | |
| | p_vistod15 | **−3.315** | $6.5\times10^{-9}$ | `val` overstates | **yes** | |
| `weight_decay` 1e-4 → 1e-3 | smoke2sf | −0.009 | 0.9648 | 6+/4− | **no** (+0.020 pp, *p* = | **uninformative** |

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | 0.8535) | |
| | shwd2sf | +0.190 | 0.3066 | 7+/3− | **no** (+0.090 pp, $p$ = 0.582) | **uninformative** |
| `mosaic` 1.0 → 0.0 | smoke2sf | +0.035 | 0.8242 | 6+/4− | **yes** (−1.135 pp, $p$ = 0.001953) | no |
| | shwd2sf | **−0.520** | **0.0293** | **2+/8−** | **yes** (−0.699 pp, $p$ = 0.001953) | **yes** — one cell at zero, one significantly negative |

**Which axis reproduces, and which one cannot say.** Of the two intervention axes run besides the headline

`lr0` one, `weight_decay` **never produced a comparable arm difference** — its own paired gain is +0.020

and +0.090 pp, the same order as seed noise — so its non-reproduction is **uninformative**, and the paper

does not read "the phenomenon fails to cross axes" off it. `mosaic` did produce one (**0+/10−** in both

cells, −1.135 and −0.699 pp) and its Δgap has the **same form as the `lr0` axis'**: one cell at zero, one

significantly negative. The systematic shift is therefore **not specific to the learning-rate axis**, which

is what section 12 of the article states and what this table now lets a reader check in one place.

## Table S41 — the `p_vistod15` clean re-run, and what it does to the memory-pressure bound

**Table S41.** *10 (defect 10)* — the cell defect 10 flags, re-run on one machine with ample VRAM (one training lane per GPU), with the **archived script and the recorded configuration**: four `(arm, seed)` pairs, each **twice** (the clean re-run `clean1` and an independent replicate `clean2`). Test endpoints are mAP50-95 (pp). `|archive − clean1|` is the quantity a bound would be about (the article now reports it as **0.000 / 0.020 / 0.150 / 0.000 pp** and writes the event effect **unidentified** where there is no no-event control); `|clean2 − clean1|` is what an identical configuration reproduces at, on the same machine, the same day — the **observation-level reproduction residual**. Source: `work/G2_jitter_20260930.py`; per-run logs screened for the two defect-10 fingerprints (`work/g2_screen_20260930.py`) — **no hits**.

| **arm** | **seed** | **archive** | **clean1** | **clean2** | \ | **archive − clean1** | | ****** | **clean2 − clean1** | ** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | | | | |
| base100 | s42 | 11.450 | 11.450 | 11.450 | +0.000 | **+0.000** | | | | |
| base100 | s43 | 11.680 | 11.700 | 11.700 | +0.020 | **+0.000** | | | | |
| lr005_100ep | s42 | 15.190 | 15.040 | 15.040 | +0.150 | **+0.000** | | | | |
| lr005_100ep | s43 | 15.280 | 15.280 | 15.280 | +0.000 | **+0.000** | | | | |

**Table S24.** *§9: the registered replication (the criterion is not met — the third row is the one that passes)* — columns: Registered pair, n, Δ (pp), 95 % CI, paired t, permutation p, same sign, Δ ≥ +0.30, p < 0.01, ≥ 8/10, unit criterion.

| Registered pair | n | Δ (pp) | 95 % CI | paired t | permutation p | same sign | Δ ≥ +0.30 | p < 0.01 | ≥ 8/10 | unit criterion |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| T1-a dota15→aitod | 10 | **+0.147** | [−0.036, +0.330] | 1.816 (p = 0.1027) | 0.123 | 6+/4− | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ | **FAIL** |
| T1-b aitod→visdrone | 10 | **+0.168** | [+0.083, +0.253] | 4.455 (p = 0.0016) | **0.001953** | **10+/0−** | ✗ | ✓ | ✓ | **FAIL** |
| T1-c visdrone→dota15 | 10 | **+3.727** | [+3.534, +3.920] | 43.774 (p = $8.5\times10^{-12}$) | **0.001953** | **10+/0−** | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | **PASS** |

**Table S25.** *§9: the registered replication (the criterion is not met — the third row is the one that passes)* — columns: Question the frozen criterion asks, Measured.

| Question the frozen criterion asks | Measured | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | | |
| \ | Δ\ | < 0.15 pp? (a saturated domain should be ≈ 0) | **no** (T2 mask→mendeley **−1.490 pp**) |
| p > 0.1? (should be non-significant) | **no** (paired t = −4.164, **p = 0.0141**, 0+/5−) | | |
| A **positive** gain ≥ +0.30 pp with p < 0.01? (if present, the narrative collapses) | **no** | | |

**Endpoint and floor (added 2026-10-01; corrected 2026-10-04).** Every value in the Measured column above is the

**`final`-epoch** reading of the archive-A row (§7.3, Table S16). The frozen endpoint convention of §5 is

the **`best`** reading, and the **released** `test_best_epoch` entry for this cell read **Δ = −0.902 pp**

(**p = 0.2931**); that cell was corrected on **2026-10-02** (§S12): the entry had used one run's **`last`** reading in

place of its `best` reading, and the corrected value is **Δ = −1.490 pp, p = 0.0141**. **So all three

questions get the same answer under both endpoints** (|−1.490| ≫ 0.15 pp; p ≪ 0.1; a negative reading

cannot be a positive gain): the table is **endpoint-independent** and the criterion **not met** either way. The p values here come from the paired **t** test; at n = 5 the

permutation floor is **$2/2^5 = 0.0625$**, which is *above* the printed p = 0.0141 and is printed here as §11

recommendation ③ requires.

**Table S26.** *§9: the near-matched control C (the gain does not depend on a label-space change)* — columns: n, Δ (pp), 95 % CI, paired t, permutation p, same sign.

| n | Δ (pp) | 95 % CI | paired t | permutation p | same sign |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 10 | **+0.727** | [+0.640, +0.814] | 18.854 (p = **$1.53\times10^{-8}$**) | **0.001953** (= the n = 10 floor) | **10+/0−** |

**Table S27.** *9. The registered multi-target replication: transferred to the companion paper* — columns: Registered pair, data YAML, `val`, `test`, Split.

| Registered pair | data YAML | `val` | `test` | Split |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| T1-b aitod→visdrone | `visdrone_20p.yaml` | `images/val` | `images/test` | **separated** ✓ |
| T1-a dota15→aitod | `aitod_20p.yaml` | `images/val` | `images/val` | **same directory** ✗ |
| T1-c visdrone→dota15 | `dota15_20p.yaml` | `images/val` | `images/val` | **same directory** ✗ |
| T2 mask→mendeley | `mende_20p.yaml` | `images/val` | `images/val` | **same directory** ✗ |
| C dota→dota15 (control) | `dota15_20p.yaml` | `images/val` | `images/val` | **same directory** ✗ |

**Where these configurations live.** The four per-pair configs named above are archived under `eval_validity/yamls/`, each copy named after the path it had on its pod (for example `A__root__datasets__AI-TOD_yolo__aitod_20p.yaml`); that directory also carries a `MANIFEST.md` listing all 28 archived configs and, for each, whether `val` and `test` point at the same directory. The table above is a recomputation from those files, not a restatement.

**Table S28.** *5.1 (the dota15 escalation, X8)* — columns: seed, premium baseline, premium strategy, paired difference. Ten seeds, from n = 3 to n = 10. Premium = best-epoch minus final-epoch mAP50-95 on the run's own monitored split; source: the twenty run directories in `x8_dota15_20260918/runs/` (10 seeds x 2 arms; **16 of them trained for this round**, the seeds-43/44 pairs pre-existing).

| seed | premium baseline | premium strategy | paired difference |
|---|---|---|---|
| 42 | +0.997 | +0.370 | **+0.627** |
| 43 | +1.004 | +0.183 | **+0.821** |
| 44 | +0.841 | +0.317 | **+0.524** |
| 45 | +0.775 | +0.585 | **+0.190** |
| 46 | +0.997 | +0.740 | **+0.257** |
| 47 | +1.027 | +0.658 | **+0.369** |
| 48 | +0.986 | +0.492 | **+0.494** |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 49 | +0.952 | +0.407 | **+0.545** |
| 50 | +0.941 | +0.715 | **+0.226** |
| 51 | +0.891 | +0.454 | **+0.437** |
| **mean (n = 10)** | **+0.941** (sd 0.082) | **+0.492** (sd 0.182) | **+0.449** (sd 0.196, t = 7.23, p = 4.924e-05) |

**The criterion was fixed before the runs existed**: a ten-seed paired difference failing to be positive with **≥ 8/10 same-sign** and a **95 % CI excluding zero** would remove `dota15` from the four-cell headline and force the abstract and Tier 1 to be rewritten. Measured: **+0.449 pp**, **10+/0−**, CI **[+0.309, +0.589]** — met as stated.

**Recipe identity.** All twenty `args.yaml` files of the cell (the sixteen new runs plus the two pre-existing seeds, both arms) are identical in every recipe field: same pretrain (`dota15_pretrain.pt`), same data YAML (`dota15_20p.yaml`), 100 epochs, `patience` 100, batch 32, imgsz 640, `save_period` 5, SGD, `lr0` 0.001 (baseline) versus 0.005 (strategy). Old and new runs are therefore poolable, and the seed is recorded in every directory name.

**GPU-memory fallback, and its sensitivity.** 10 of the 16 newly trained runs printed `CUDA OutOfMemoryError in TaskAlignedAssigner, using CPU` (92 events; 79 of them in `dota15_lr005_100ep_s51n`), while the per-epoch sweep of §8.7 shared the GPU. This is an implementation-level fallback inside one batch, not a change of objective, and it is reported rather than smoothed: dropping each seed pair in turn leaves the criterion satisfied in all ten subsets (worst lower bound **+0.277**), and dropping the two most affected pairs (s51: 79 events, s42: 7) gives **+0.428 pp**, CI **[+0.252, +0.605]**, 8+/0−. Scripts: `work/x8_dota15_analysis_20260918.py`, `work/x8_oom_counts_20260918.py`, `work/x8_oom_sensitivity_20260918.py`.

**Table S29.** *5.1 (the two `val`-overstating cells, X1)* — columns: seed, Δgap for `p_aitovis`, Δgap for `p_vistod15`. Ten seeds per cell, from n = 3 to n = 10. Δgap = (arm difference on `val`, at each run's own val-curve maximum) − (arm difference on `test`, at `best.pt`); paired within seed. Sources: `x1_tier2_20260918/runs/` (40 run records) and `teval.csv` (80 test evaluations, SHA-256 verified against the machine that produced them).

| seed | Δgap p_aitovis | Δgap p_vistod15 |
|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- |
| 42 | -1.127 | -3.131 |
| 43 | -0.843 | -4.563 |
| 44 | -1.358 | -3.058 |
| 45 | -1.495 | -2.819 |
| 46 | -1.267 | -3.468 |
| 47 | -0.960 | -3.453 |
| 48 | -1.280 | -2.952 |
| 49 | -1.341 | -3.590 |
| 50 | -1.404 | -2.995 |
| 51 | -1.182 | -3.118 |
| **mean (n = 10)** | **-1.226** | **-3.315** |
| 95 % CI | [-1.370, -1.081] | [-3.676, -2.953] |
| paired t / p | -19.17 / 1.3e-08 | -20.76 / 6.5e-09 |
| sign | 0+/10− | 0+/10− |
| **sign-flip permutation p** | **0.001953** | **0.001953** |

The `paired t / p` row is **raw** (no multiplicity adjustment); the permutation p is exact at this cell size and is printed as its attainable floor. The two are separate tests and are not combined.

**What the comparison is, exactly.** The plan fixed before the runs: 40 training runs (seeds 42–51 × 2 arms × 2 cells), paired *and* sign-flip tests, `{best, last} × {val, test}`, and a prespecified correction; the strong branch of the pre-declared outcome rule was *"both remaining negative and significant with permutation $p \leq 0.002$"*, the weak branch being that the abstract's "direction is not single-valued" must be withdrawn or limited. All ten seeds of each cell are negative and the permutation p is $2/2^{10}$ = **0.001953**, the smallest value attainable at n = 10 (§7.1), so the strong branch applies. **Holm across the two targets** (the prespecified correction) multiplies the larger p by 2 and the smaller by 1: $2.6\times10^{-8}$ and $6.5\times10^{-9}$, both $\leq 0.05$.

**The endpoint was identified, not assumed.** The archived `sio_b_results.csv` that the published Table 2 used for the n = 3 values carries no endpoint convention (§7.3, disclosed defect 3). Our own evaluation of `best.pt` on `test` reproduces its values for the twelve runs it covers to **0.0046 pp** (median 0.0023) — so that archive records **the best checkpoint evaluated on `test`**, and the n = 3 → n = 10 comparison is like-for-like rather than a change of measurement. Under the same construction restricted to seeds 42–44 the two cells give −1.110 and −3.584 against the published −1.114 and −3.580.

**Both arms and all four quantities.** Per cell (baseline / strategy means, n = 10): `val`-curve maximum 11.242 / 12.657 and 16.963 / 23.927; `best.pt` on `test` 10.210 / 10.396 and 11.626 / 15.263.

The cells' realization rates (§8.6's quantity, computed the same way) are **82 % / 104 %** and **56 % / 29 %**, pooled **55 %** — the opposite end from §8.6's aggregate realization rate, which is why the article says the realization rate is not a constant across corpora. The exact three-component decomposition of each Δgap is in Tables S10's conventions: for `p_aitovis` −1.226 = (−1.583) + (+0.090) + (+0.267) and for `p_vistod15` −3.315 = (−7.072) + (−0.213) + (+3.971); both identities check to the printed digit. Scripts: `work/x1_gap_analysis_20260918.py`, `work/x1_aux_20260918.py`.

**Table S37.** *3.2* — the six pre-registered experiments and the criterion each was judged against. **G1 is void** (design confounded), so no verdict is entered for it; **two of the five judged experiments are negative — G1′ and G2** — and one design had to be redone, all reported as such. Counts are over experiments, not criteria. The values behind every verdict are in Tables S31–S33 (the G1 family in S12).

| Experiment (design) | Pre-declared criterion | Verdict |
|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- |
| **G1** aliasing calibration, disjoint split | none entered: design confounded | **void** — the pair differed by 14.7 pp in difficulty; redone as G1′ (§S12) |
| **G1″** three-way carve levels | the paired levels differ by ≤ 3 pp | **met** (−0.122 pp; §S12) |
| **G1′** aliasing, level-matched pair | WC > 0, paired t, $p < 0.05$ | **not met** ($p = 0.83$, n = 10; §S12) |
| **G2** selection-split size, 30 vs 90 | the rate rises with size; `WC_small/WC_large` ∈ [1.4, 2.1] | **direction met, magnitude not met** (pooled ratio 1.19; Table S31) |
| **G3** epoch budget `E` | C1 rise in `E`; C2 the σ√(2 ln E) form in [0.86, 1.43]; C3 shape; C4 WC on a disjoint readout | **revised** (§3.1, S32 · S34b, **clean re-run**): C1 met, C2 out of band, so the scaling stays withdrawn; C3 passes on the mean only; C4 not met · cross-lineage direction also probed on a **second detector family** (RetinaNet, two corpora): S34e |
| **G4** third corpus, `mende20_3way` | identity value by value; WC > 0 | **met** (WC = +5.21 pp, CI [+4.82, +5.66], 20/20; Table S33) |

**Table S31.** *3.2 (G2)* — the selection split's **size** is the only thing that changes: two nested validation splits drawn from one verified-disjoint pool (30 and 90 images), the same training set, and an identical test side. Columns: selection split, arm, n, `prem_val`, `prem_test`, WC, realization rate. Source: `g2_valsize_20260919_runs/`, `g2t_g1p_20260919/g2_test.csv`.

| selection split | arm | n | `prem_val` | `prem_test` | WC | realization rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| small (30) | base100 | 5 | +2.747 | +0.646 | +2.101 | **23.5 %** |
| small (30) | lr005_100ep | 5 | +1.258 | +0.064 | +1.194 | **5.1 %** |
| large (90) | base100 | 5 | +2.549 | +0.688 | +1.861 | **27.0 %** |
| large (90) | lr005_100ep | 5 | +1.062 | +0.165 | +0.897 | **15.6 %** |

**Pre-declared criteria.** Direction: the realization rate rises with the selection split's size — **met** (the two arms move the same way). Magnitude: `WC_small / WC_large` within [1.4, 2.1] (√3 ≈ 1.73) — **not met** (measured 1.19, pooled over the two arms), so the 1/√n step is a scale estimate, not a law.

**Table S32.** *3.2 (G3)* — the epoch budget is the only thing that changes (four budgets, E = 50–400, same corpus, recipe and validation split). Columns: arm, n, premium at E = 50, at E = 100, at E = 200, at E = 400, ratio 400/100. Source: `g3_epochs_runs/`. **Two bases appear in this table and its note, and they are labelled:** the E = 400 and ratio columns report the **six full runs** at that budget, while the C2 ratio **1.329** and the all-runs C1 verdict use the **ten runs** at E = 400 (arm-equal mean **+0.907 pp**); four of the ten stopped early under the protocol's own `patience`. **n = 5 seeds per arm at E = 50–200**; the E = 400 and ratio columns report the **six full runs** of the ten at that budget, which is why the table row and the note's all-ten arithmetic are both stated.

| arm | n | premium (E = 50) | premium (E = 100) | premium (E = 200) | premium (E = 400; six full runs) | ratio 400/100 (six full runs) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| base | 5 | +0.724 | +0.897 | +1.187 | +1.315 | ×1.47 |
| lr005 | 5 | +0.163 | +0.468 | +0.756 | +1.241 | ×2.65 |

**Pre-declared criteria (C1–C3, fixed before the runs). C1 — monotone rise of the premium with E — is not met**: **on all ten runs** the four-budget series peaks at E = 200 and falls at E = 400 (four of the ten E = 400 runs stopped early at effective budgets 388/318/362/375; on the six full runs the E = 400 mean is +1.278 pp, which is the column this table prints). The ln E regression over E = 50–200 gives slope **+0.3990** (se 0.0592), **p = 9.466e-08**. **C2 — the σ√(2 ln E) form — is not rejected**: premium(400)/premium(100) = **1.329** (the E = 400 arm-equal mean over all ten runs is **+0.907 pp**) against the predicted 1.141, **inside** the pre-declared band [0.86, 1.43]. **C3 — the shape control — passes** (ê/E 0.833 → 0.815). The extension (E = 50 and 400) was added for this revision; it uses the same corpus, recipe, seeds and arms as the E = 100/200 runs, and only `--epochs` differs. **The early-stopped runs decide the outcome**: the four E = 400 runs that stopped under the protocol's own `patience` (effective budgets 388/318/362/375) are what makes the series non-monotone; dropping them flips **both** criteria — the six full E = 400 runs run to a mean of +1.278 pp on a monotone series (C1 met) and move the ratio outside the band (C2 rejected). Both readings are conditional on that restriction and are reported as such; the pre-declared verdict above is the one computed on **all** runs. **This note supersedes an earlier reading of the two-budget series, which reported only three budgets and mislabelled them as monotone; the four-budget verdict is in S11 and §3.2. The table below is the with-early-stopping reading; the same four budgets re-run** on one machine **with early stopping disabled** satisfy C1**, put** C2 outside its band **and** pass C3 on the pre-declared mean reading **(only the lr005 arm exceeds it) — see Table S34b.**

**Secondary criterion C4 (WC on a disjoint readout) — not met, and systematically so.** With ê selected on `val` and read out on the disjoint third C3 (100 images; `C3 ∩ val = 0` and `C3 ∩ train = 0` verified programmatically), WC = `prem_val` − `prem_C3` is **negative in all 16 readouts** (mean **-0.616 pp**): the peak-to-endpoint gap is *larger* on the small disjoint split than on `val`. That is consistent with the shape reading above — the premium is largely the split's own curve shape, and a 100-image split has a steeper curve — and it means Proposition 4's inequality **cannot be tested by reading out on a small disjoint carve**. Two limitations are stated with the result: the readout split has 100 images only, and the four early-stopped E = 400 runs are excluded, leaving n = 6 at that budget.

**Table S33.** *3.2 (G4)* — replication on a third corpus (`mende20_3way`, 2 arms × 10 seeds, test side evaluated separately, 40 evaluations). Columns: run, `prem_val`, `prem_test`, WC, realization rate. Source: `g4_mende3way_runs/`, `g4_mende3way_20260919_g4_test.csv`.

| run | prem_val | prem_test | WC | realization rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| base100_s42n | +8.873 | +3.384 | +5.489 | 38.1 % |
| base100_s43n | +8.309 | +2.701 | +5.608 | 32.5 % |
| base100_s44n | +7.731 | +3.783 | +3.948 | 48.9 % |
| base100_s45n | +7.818 | +2.796 | +5.022 | 35.8 % |
| base100_s46n | +7.257 | +2.481 | +4.776 | 34.2 % |
| base100_s47n | +7.608 | +3.666 | +3.942 | 48.2 % |
| base100_s48n | +7.534 | +3.046 | +4.488 | 40.4 % |
| base100_s49n | +8.185 | +4.312 | +3.873 | 52.7 % |
| base100_s50n | +8.456 | +3.834 | +4.622 | 45.3 % |
| base100_s51n | +7.671 | +2.930 | +4.741 | 38.2 % |
| lr005_100ep_s42n | +9.613 | +4.893 | +4.720 | 50.9 % |
| lr005_100ep_s43n | +9.450 | +3.434 | +6.016 | 36.3 % |
| lr005_100ep_s44n | +6.249 | +0.416 | +5.833 | 6.7 % |
| lr005_100ep_s45n | +8.592 | +2.205 | +6.387 | 25.7 % |
| lr005_100ep_s46n | +8.528 | +1.960 | +6.568 | 23.0 % |
| lr005_100ep_s47n | +9.957 | +5.044 | +4.913 | 50.7 % |
| lr005_100ep_s48n | +7.300 | +1.684 | +5.616 | 23.1 % |
| lr005_100ep_s49n | +12.210 | +4.314 | +7.896 | 35.3 % |
| lr005_100ep_s50n | +7.976 | +2.983 | +4.993 | 37.4 % |
| lr005_100ep_s51n | +7.355 | +2.563 | +4.792 | 34.8 % |

> **Result.** WC = **+5.212 pp**, 95 % bootstrap CI [+4.822, +5.655], positive in **20 of 20** runs — the same direction as the 81 runs of §8.6 and the 40 of §5.1. No pass/fail is set for the rate itself (Proposition 4 bounds only its expectation).

## Table S34 — cross-lineage realization test (non-YOLO detector)

**Table S34.** *6.5* — the mechanism outside the YOLO lineage. A **Faster R-CNN (ResNet-50 FPN)** detector

(torchvision `fasterrcnn_resnet50_fpn`), a family that **reports the final epoch by default** (the

cross-framework audit above), trained from COCO-initialised weights on the same **three-way protocol** as

the rest of this paper: train = a 20 % subset (1,294 images), selection (`val`) = a **verified-disjoint

carve** (500), readout (`test`) = the corpus's held-out split (1,610). 40 epochs, batch 8, SGD lr 0.005

with a 1,000-iteration warmup, 640-px input, **six seeds**. `best` is chosen by the **`val`** curve's

argmax; `test` is inferred **once** for `best` and once for `last`, and evaluated with the

**same** COCO implementation used on the YOLO side (IoU 0.50:0.95, 101-point interpolation).

Source: `nonyolo_realization.json` (the original run; **author-side, not part of the released package**) and `nonyolo_settle_20260925/` (`settle_all.json`,

`nonyolo_n6_aggregate.json`; the five added seeds are aggregated by `work/aggregate_nonyolo_n6_20260925.py`).

The per-epoch `val` predictions kept by the training run are written one file per epoch under the run's prediction directory, from epoch 1 to epoch 40.

| maxDets | n | prem_val mean | prem_test mean | realization rate (ratio of means) | 95 % CI |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| 100 | 6 | **+0.0809** | **+0.0551** | **68.2 %** | [26.9 %, 123.5 %] |
| 300 | 6 | +0.0809 | +0.0551 | 68.2 % | [26.9 %, 123.5 %] |
| 1000 | 6 | +0.0809 | +0.0551 | 68.2 % | [26.9 %, 123.5 %] |

Per-run detail (seed 42 is the run reported in the previous version; it is the *first* of the six, not a

separate experiment). Rates are `prem_test / prem_val` per run, so they vary far more than the aggregate:

| run | best ep | prem_val | prem_test | per-run rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| original (seed 42) | 30 | +0.0932 | +0.0641 | 68.8 % |
| seed 43 | 27 | +0.0753 | +0.0422 | 56.1 % |
| seed 44 | 33 | +0.0670 | +0.0147 | 22.0 % |
| seed 45 | 24 | +0.1017 | +0.1777 | **174.8 %** |
| seed 46 | 28 | +0.0315 | +0.0009 | 2.8 % |
| seed 47 | 21 | +0.1165 | +0.0310 | 26.6 % |

## Table S34b — the G3 clean re-run (early stopping disabled, four budgets, one stack)

**Table S34b.** *3.2 (G3, clean re-run)* — the four-budget experiment re-run with the protocol's early

stopping **disabled** (injected at the call site; the training script is byte-identical, md5

`316e074050dde23cde33e4a223ec46a8`). Same corpus, recipe, two arms and five seeds as G3; only the

`patience` setting differs. The whole four-budget series was run **on one stack**: in the

earlier clean batch one of its runs was silently degraded under memory pressure, which is why the series was

repeated rather than patched. **40/40 runs completed**, each to its configured budget. The E = 50/100/200 rows

coincide with the published budget series because no run early-stopped at those budgets; only E = 400

changes.

Source: `g3cleanb_20260925/` (per-run `results.csv`; recomputation `work/clean_series_b_20260925.py`,

output `work/_clean_series_b_20260925.txt`).

| E | arm | n | premium mean (pp) | seed sd | bootstrap 95 % CI | ê/E |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| 50 | base | 5 | **+0.724** | 0.094 | [+0.663, +0.806] | 0.760 |
| 50 | lr005 | 5 | **+0.163** | 0.176 | [+0.030, +0.298] | 0.876 |
| 100 | base | 5 | **+0.897** | 0.101 | [+0.820, +0.974] | 0.788 |
| 100 | lr005 | 5 | **+0.468** | 0.220 | [+0.290, +0.633] | 0.878 |
| 200 | base | 5 | **+1.187** | 0.084 | [+1.119, +1.250] | 0.813 |
| 200 | lr005 | 5 | **+0.756** | 0.163 | [+0.628, +0.900] | 0.909 |
| 400 | base | 5 | **+1.295** | 0.083 | [+1.222, +1.349] | 0.760 |
| 400 | lr005 | 5 | **+1.248** | 0.085 | [+1.180, +1.317] | 0.814 |

**Verdict under the pre-declared criteria, on the clean re-run series.** The arm-equal means are **+0.4439 / +0.6824 / +0.9712 / +1.2717**, i.e. **monotone non-decreasing ⇒ C1 is *met*** (per-run regression on ln E: slope **+0.3999**, se **0.0503**, t = **7.950**, p = **$1.325\times10^{-9}$**, n = 40), where the with-early-stopping reading scored **not met**. **C2 is out of band**: premium(400)/premium(100) = **1.8636** against the predicted 1.141, outside the pre-declared [0.86, 1.43] ⇒ the σ√(2 ln E) scaling **stays withdrawn** and the level reads as shape-driven. **C3 — the shape control — passes on the pre-declared *mean* reading** (ê/E **0.833 → 0.787**, |Δ| = **0.046** ≤ 0.05) and **fails per arm** (lr005 |Δ| = **0.065**; base |Δ| = **0.028**); the pre-registered criterion names the mean, so both readings are reported side by side and neither is dropped. **The registered criteria still forbid reporting the rise as an `E` effect**: the peak's relative position moves **in one arm and not the other** across budgets (base 0.760 → 0.760, lr005 0.876 → 0.814), which is the movement C3 exists to catch.

**Superseded reading, kept on the record (first clean batch).** That batch carried only E = 50 and E = 400 and was split across two hosts; its per-arm values were

| E | arm | n | premium mean (pp) | seed sd | bootstrap 95 % CI | ê/E |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| 50 | base | 5 | **+0.672** | 0.180 | [+0.526, +0.820] | 0.744 |
| 50 | lr005 | 5 | +0.094 | 0.110 | [+0.013, +0.185] | 0.928 |
| 400 | base | 5 | **+1.298** | 0.082 | [+1.223, +1.343] | 0.836 |
| 400 | lr005 | 5 | **+1.211** | 0.284 | [+1.058, +1.469] | 0.725 |

and its verdict read: *using the published E = 100 and 200 means (0.682, 0.971), the four-budget series is **monotone** (0.383 / 0.682 / 0.971 / **1.255**) and the ln E regression gives slope **+0.419** (se 0.060), **t = 7.03, p ≈ 2×10⁻¹²** ⇒ the monotone-rise criterion **met**, where the with-early-stopping readings scored **not met**. The **shape control fails**: `max_arm |ê/E(400) − ê/E(50)| = 0.203` against the pre-declared 0.05, and the movement is **opposite in the two arms** (lr005 falls 0.928 → 0.725, base rises 0.744 → 0.836). *Those values are replaced** by the single-machine table above; they are retained so that the earlier reading can be checked against its replacement. Two things about that batch are the reason for the re-run, and both are on the record: one of its runs was **silently degraded under memory pressure** (the training path changed without a marker, recorded in this revision's run audit), and its comparison points were mismatched. **Its being split over two hosts is *not* among the reasons** — the A and B machines calibrated as equivalent. Its shape control

also compared **E = 400 with E = 50**, because that batch had no E = 100 point — a mismatch of comparison points against the pre-declared `ê/E(400) − ê/E(100)`, and the reason its "failure" and the single-machine "pass on the mean" are not in conflict.

**Result.** The `val`-selected premium is **partly realized** outside the YOLO lineage (`prem_test` = **+0.0551 pp** against `prem_val` = **+0.0809 pp**, **68.2 %**, 95 % CI **[26.9 %, 123.5 %]**), in the **same direction** as the five arm-cells of §8.6 — and in the same direction in **all six runs** (`prem_val > 0` and `prem_test > 0` in 6/6; no run has a negative rate). All three `maxDets` conventions give **identical** numbers, confirming (for this corpus) that the parameter is not binding here.

**Pre-declared criteria for this escalation** (fixed before the five added seeds were run):

① same direction as the original single run; ② a 95 % interval reported; ③ *if that interval contains zero*, *the wording stays "an anecdote". ① met, ② met, ③ not triggered** — the interval excludes zero — so this table is upgraded from an anecdote to an estimate **with** an interval.

**Limits. One detector, one corpus**, six seeds — so the result establishes that the mechanism is **not confined to the YOLO lineage**, and **not** that non-YOLO pipelines realize ~68 % generally. The aggregate's agreement with the single-run value (68.8 %) is a **coincidence of a wide per-run spread**: individual rates run from** 2.8 % to 174.8 %**, one of them above 100 %. The realization rate also has a **small denominator** (mean `prem_val` = +0.0809 pp; the original run's was +0.0932 pp), so the ratio is far more sensitive to single-run variation than the directional statement `prem_test > 0`. The absolute premium is an order of magnitude below the YOLO-side cells of §8.6 (+0.865 … +1.469 pp) and **must not be compared with them**: the detector, corpus, dataset scale and absolute mAP level all differ. The evaluation-side self-test (`ground truth as predictions` = **0.990099** at `maxDets = 1000`, 0.962854 **at 100) is reported in the project log for that pass (2026-09-16).** Why it is not exactly 1.0.** Feeding the ground truth back in is not capped by the interpolation grid: measured locally (`work/c23_eval_ceiling_20261001.py`, `pycocotools`, gt = predictions, score 1.0), a **one-box self-test reads exactly 1.000000 **at both `maxDets` settings. The 101-point grid turns a** recall cap** `r` into `round(101 r)/101` -- a self-test with 100 detections against 150 ground-truth boxes reads **67/101 = 0.663366 **(measured) -- so the logged** 0.990099 = 100/101** says this pass's maximum recall was **100/101 ~ 0.9901**: one ground-truth box went unmatched. It is a **shortfall to investigate, not the evaluator's ceiling**; the lower reading at `maxDets = 100` is the evaluator's own cap truncating a crowded image's boxes. Neither figure is evidence about the detector — it is a check on the evaluation stack, and it is **1.0 up to that

ceiling**.

**Figure and table inventory** (moved here from the article, B3, 2026-09-26). The article carries its argument, its four headline tables and its disclosure; this is the map of which tables and figures are printed there and which live here. It sits at the end of §S8 so that it directly follows the moved tables it indexes.

**Where the evidence lives.** The article keeps its claims, argument, **four headline tables** and its disclosure; the other tables are in the Supplementary **unchanged**, and **four of the six figures are printed in the article** — §6.1 (Fig. 1), §8.6 (Figs. 2 and 3) and §8.7 (Fig. 4) — with the remaining two in §S9, **and the printed numbers map to the deposited files as `Fig. 1` = `fig3_four_units.png`, `Fig. 2` = `fig2_realization_rate.png`, `Fig. 3` = `fig6_sigma_vs_rate.png`, `Fig. 4` = `fig5_epoch_curve.png`, `Fig. S1` = `fig1_dgap_decomposition.png`, `Fig. S2` = `fig4_public_logs.png`**, so a reader can pair every caption with its file,

every number backed by an artifact pointer. Four tables are printed **in the article**

too, each carrying a headline number to check:

| In this article | §S8 counterpart | What it settles |
|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- |
| **Table 1** | Table S4 | **Tier 1** — premium per arm and the paired difference |
| **Table 2** | Table S6 | **Tier 2** — Δgap by corpus, with its reading |
| **Table 3** | Table S11 | the four counting units over the 19 audited benchmarks |
| **Table 4** | Table S20 | the premium selected on `val`, and what it realizes on `test` |

**Everything else is in §S8–§S9**, keyed by section, including **S24–S27** (the registration, now the companion's), plus **three tables this revision adds in §S12 rather than moves from the article** — **Table S35** (the estimand and scope map) and **Table S36** (the analysis-status ledger), and **Table S37** (the article's former Table 5: the six pre-registered experiments, their criteria and their verdicts, moved here in this revision) — **S35 and S36 are not rows of the §S8 index** (which lists the tables moved from the article); **S37 is**, having been moved from the article in this revision. The six figures are:

| Figure | Main-text section |
|---|---|
| --- | --- |
| **Fig. 1** | **this article**, §6.1 |
| **Fig. 2** | **this article**, §8.6 |
| **Fig. 3** | **this article**, §8.6 |
| **Fig. 4** | **this article**, §8.7 |
| **Fig. S1** | Supplementary §S9, §5.6 |
| **Fig. S2** | Supplementary §S9, §5.5 |

**Not in the index above.** Nine tables in this section were not moved from the article and are therefore

not rows of the index: **S34** (cross-lineage realization test, non-YOLO detector), **S34b** (the G3 clean

re-run, early stopping disabled, one machine, four budgets), **S34c** (the cross-lineage test on a second

corpus, SFCHD, and the carve that gives it a disjoint selection set), **S34e** (the cross-lineage test on a

**second detector family**, RetinaNet, run on both corpora, added 2026-10-06), **S38** (the selection term, cell by cell,

for all thirteen scanned corpora), **S39** and **S40** (the second and third intervention axes,

`weight_decay` and `mosaic`), **S40b** (the three intervention axes side by side, added 2026-10-01) and **S41** (the `p_vistod15` clean re-run, and what it does to the

memory-pressure bound). Two further tables of the same kind live in §S12: **S35** (the estimand and scope

map) and **S36** (the analysis-status ledger).

**Numbering.** Two numbers are not used anywhere in this supplement: section **§S10** and **Table S30**.

The numbering is not contiguous, and nothing is missing from the file under either number.

§10's defect table is **kept in the article**, deliberately: disclosure belongs in the article, as do

first-report attribution and methodological premises. The Supplementary's §S6 records the **shared

process protocols** — the same set of protocols used by this paper and its companion — with their file

hashes.

## Table S34c — cross-lineage realization test, **second corpus** (SFCHD, non-YOLO detector)

**Table S34c.** *6.5* — the same question as S34, asked of a **second corpus**, so that the cross-lineage

reading rests on direction agreement across two corpora rather than on one. Detector, recipe and evaluation

are held fixed: torchvision `fasterrcnn_resnet50_fpn`, COCO-initialised, 640-px input, batch 8, SGD lr 0.005

with a 1,000-iteration warmup, cosine schedule, 40 epochs, **one run per GPU**, `best` by the `val` curve's

argmax, `test` inferred **once** for `best` and once for `last`. The probe lineage is our own

`run_3way_v2.py` (a seed-carrying variant of the S34 script); the two differ in warmup and in the final-epoch

endpoint, so the two tables are **direction-comparable, not magnitude-comparable** — consistent with the

S34 column being no basis for a cross-detector comparison either.

Corpus: **SFCHD** (two classes, `hat` / `person`). SFCHD is one of the six corpora whose released

configuration gives `val` and `test` the **same directory** (**S1**, row 13) — that is, one of the corpora

this article counts as lacking an independent held-out split. Rather than inherit that, we **carved a

verified-disjoint selection set **from its 20 % training pool (2,413 images) by a** fixed permutation seed**

(`SEED=20261002`, written into the carve script; first 400 images), leaving train 2,013 and keeping the

readout split (6,033) **read-only**; the three sets are pairwise disjoint (asserted in the script). The

corpus was carved **twice, independently, on the two hosts** with that same script and seed (they calibrated

as equivalent, so this is a **positive control**, not a confound), and the two

carve manifests are **identical line by line** (md5 `8be82f1f1bfb41a0cd5b4f96cbaa356c`), so the 12 runs are

one corpus, not two. Positive control: with ground truth as predictions, every checkpoint reaches

**0.990099** (ideal 1/1.01) at `maxDets=1000` — the caliper used in S34 — and no reading is written if it

fails. Per-image detections do not reach the `maxDets` cap on this corpus, which is why all three tiers

agree.

| maxDets | corpus | n | prem_val mean (SD) | prem_test mean (SD) | sign, val / test |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| 100 | SFCHD | 12 | +0.5216 (0.1544) | +0.1233 (0.1144) | 12/0 · 11/1 |
| **300** | **SFCHD** | **12** | **+0.5216** (0.1544) | **+0.1282** (0.1150) | **12/0 · 11/1** |
| 1000 | SFCHD | 12 | +0.5216 (0.1544) | +0.1233 (0.1144) | 12/0 · 11/1 |
| 300 | VisDrone (S34, for direction only) | 6 | +0.0807 (0.0390) | +0.0383 (0.0868) | 6/0 · 5/1 |

**Pre-declared reading** (fixed before the runs). **C3 — direction agreement — is met**: both corpora have a

positive `prem_val` mean and a positive `prem_test` mean, and each corpus is same-signed in at least five of

its six runs (VisDrone 6/6 and 5/6; SFCHD 12/12 and 11/12). **Wording cap**: this licenses "two-corpus

cross-lineage probe" and nothing stronger; the detector is still one.

**Limits.** Direction only: the corpora differ by an order of magnitude in absolute mAP50-95 (≈8 versus

≈35), so their premiums are not comparable. The VisDrone `prem_test` interval **includes zero**

(**[−0.022, +0.103]**, bootstrap), so the directional verdict rests on the **sign counts** and on SFCHD; the

per-run spread is wide (individual `prem_test` **−0.0853 … +0.3097 pp**), no host effect is present (`prem_val`

correlation **+0.040** across the two hosts, n = 6 shared seeds — consistent with the A/B equivalence finding), and removing any single run leaves every

corpus/arm mean same-signed. Two runs differ between S34 and S34c that are worth naming: S34's six runs are

the original run plus five seeds aggregated at the time, whereas S34c's twelve runs were all run under

`run_3way_v2.py`; the two VisDrone `prem_val` means (+0.0809 and +0.0807) agree to **0.0002 pp**, which we

report as consistency, not as replication.

## Table S34e — cross-lineage realization test, **second detector family** (RetinaNet, two corpora)

**Table S34e.** *6.5* — S34 and S34c hold the detector fixed at `fasterrcnn_resnet50_fpn` and vary the corpus;

this table does the converse, holding **both corpora** and the three-way protocol fixed while changing the

detector to a **different family**: torchvision `retinanet_resnet50_fpn_v2` (anchor-based one-stage with FPN,

COCO-initialised). Recipe held to the S34c probe: 640-px input, batch 8, SGD lr 0.005, 1,000-iteration warmup,

cosine schedule, 40 epochs, **one run per GPU**, `best` by the `val` curve argmax, `test` inferred once for

`best` and once for `last`; `maxDets = 300`, the script default used by S34c. Twelve seeds per corpus (42–53).

The pre-flight caliper is applied unchanged: ground truth as predictions must reach **0.990099** (ideal 1/1.01),

and no reading is written if it fails. Source: our `work/run_3way_family.py`, results `family_out/*.json`,

aggregated by `work/collect_optionC.py`; `prem = V_max − V_final` / `T_best − T_final` in pp, and the rate is a

**ratio of means** with a 2,000-draw bootstrap interval on that ratio (the S34 convention).

| corpus | n | prem_val mean (SD) | prem_test mean (SD) | realization rate | 95 % CI | sign, val / test |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| VisDrone | 12 | +0.0630 (0.0510) | +0.0710 (0.0786) | **112.6 %** | [48.8 %, 211.9 %] | 10/2 · 8/4 |
| SFCHD | 12 | +0.2887 (0.2761) | +0.0566 (0.1190) | **19.6 %** | [−3.7 %, +41.6 %] | 11/1 · 7/5 |

**Reading, and the wording cap.** The sign pattern of S34/S34c reappears on **SFCHD**: a positive

`prem_val` mean with a **smaller** `prem_test` mean, i.e. the selection gain does not fully carry to the disjoint

readout. **On VisDrone it does not** — there `prem_test` (mean **+0.0710**) exceeds `prem_val` (**+0.0630**). **The two corpora do not agree on strength**: on VisDrone the realized premium is *not* discounted

(rate **112.6 %**, interval excluding zero), whereas on SFCHD the rate is **19.6 %** and its interval

**includes zero** — so on this family the discount is visible on one corpus and not on the other. That is a

weaker statement than S34c's, and it is the statement the data support: **the cross-family reading here is

direction, not magnitude, and not a replication.** As in S34c, the corpora differ by an order of magnitude in

absolute mAP50-95 (≈6 versus ≈34), so their premiums are not comparable to each other or to S34/S34c's.

> **Placement in the S34 series.** S34 = one detector, first corpus; S34c = same detector, second corpus; **S34e = second detector family, both corpora**. Read together the three tables say: the direction (a positive `val` premium that a disjoint readout realizes only in part) survives a corpus change and a **detector-family change**, while the **strength** of the discount does not — it is corpus-dependent in S34/S34c and corpus-dependent again here.

**Per-run detail** (`prem` in pp; two runs per corpus peak at the final epoch, so their `prem_val` is

exactly 0 and their per-run rate is undefined — they are counted in the means and excluded only from the

per-run rate column):

| corpus | seed | best ep | prem_val | prem_test | per-run rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| VisDrone | 42 | 31 | +0.0723 | +0.0609 | +84.2 % |
| VisDrone | 43 | 34 | +0.1412 | -0.0071 | -5.0 % |
| VisDrone | 44 | 38 | +0.1115 | +0.0183 | +16.4 % |
| VisDrone | 45 | 28 | +0.1351 | +0.2283 | +169.0 % |
| VisDrone | 46 | 30 | +0.0650 | +0.1206 | +185.5 % |
| VisDrone | 47 | 40 | +0.0000 | +0.0000 | — (peaks at final epoch) |
| VisDrone | 48 | 23 | +0.0147 | +0.1870 | +1272.1 % |
| VisDrone | 49 | 25 | +0.0848 | +0.1057 | +124.6 % |
| VisDrone | 50 | 26 | +0.0314 | +0.0917 | +292.0 % |
| VisDrone | 51 | 40 | +0.0000 | +0.0000 | — (peaks at final epoch) |
| VisDrone | 52 | 38 | +0.0132 | -0.0082 | -62.1 % |
| VisDrone | 53 | 29 | +0.0871 | +0.0543 | +62.3 % |
| SFCHD | 42 | 35 | +0.2961 | -0.0733 | -24.8 % |
| SFCHD | 43 | 33 | +0.0070 | -0.1474 | -2105.7 % |
| SFCHD | 44 | 35 | +0.6023 | +0.1639 | +27.2 % |
| SFCHD | 45 | 34 | +0.1870 | +0.1006 | +53.8 % |
| SFCHD | 46 | 34 | +0.3541 | +0.2131 | +60.2 % |
| SFCHD | 47 | 37 | +0.0750 | -0.0651 | -86.8 % |
| SFCHD | 48 | 40 | +0.0000 | +0.0000 | — (peaks at final epoch) |
| SFCHD | 49 | 30 | +0.6915 | +0.1913 | +27.7 % |
| SFCHD | 50 | 39 | +0.4042 | +0.1024 | +25.3 % |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| SFCHD | 51 | 34 | +0.7597 | +0.0466 | +6.1 % |
| SFCHD | 52 | 36 | +0.0392 | -0.0272 | -69.4 % |
| SFCHD | 53 | 36 | +0.0486 | +0.1747 | +359.5 % |

**What this table does, and what it does not do.** It **adds a detector family, not a claim level**: the two corpora, the protocol, the caliper and the aggregation convention are S34c's. It does **not** support any cross-detector magnitude comparison — the two families differ in warmup, in the final-epoch endpoint and in backbone, exactly the reason S34c already gives for not reading its column as a cross-detector comparison. It does **not** change the article's §6.5 sentence, which rests on S34 and S34c.

## S9 · Figures moved from the main text

Same reason as §S8. Captions are unchanged apart from the `S` in the figure number.

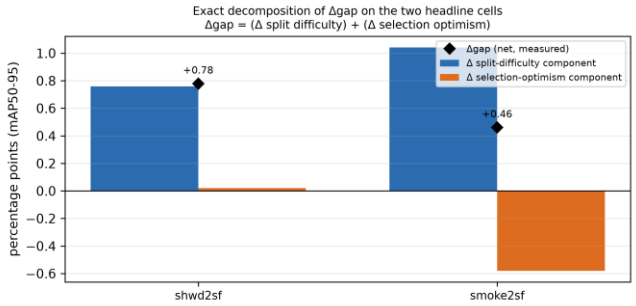



**Fig. S1.** Exact decomposition of Δgap into a split-difficulty component and a selection-optimism component on the two headline cells. The split-difficulty component dominates (+0.759 of +0.779 for shwd2sf; +1.041 against −0.580 for smoke2sf, where the two components partly cancel). This is an identity, not a fit: the three components sum to Δgap for all 13 cells. Source: `gap_mechanism_20260916.txt`, `xeval_analysis_20260916.txt`.

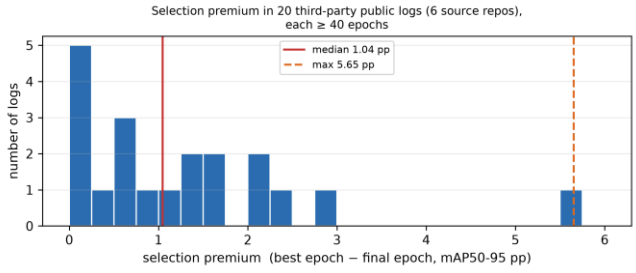



**Fig. S2.** Selection premium (best − final epoch, mAP50-95 pp) in the 20 complete third-party logs (≥ 40 epochs, 6 source repositories). Median +1.04 pp, maximum +5.65 pp, minimum +0.00. **The quantity is non-negative by construction** (a within-run maximum minus that run's own final epoch), so the sign is uninformative and the spread is the content; **a convenience sample with no sampling frame**. The same component measured on our own runs (main text §5.1) is present in logs we did not produce. Source: main text §5.5; `figures/FIGURES.md`.

## S11 · Formalisation: propositions and proofs (companion to §3.1 of the article)

Notation as in §3.1 of the article: V(e) = M_{S_val}(W(e)), T(e) = M_{S_test}(W(e)), ê = argmax_e V(e),

e_f = the final checkpoint, premium_val = V(ê) − V(e_f), premium_test = T(ê) − T(e_f).

### Proposition 1 (non-identifiability of the raw gap)

**Statement.** V(ê) − T(ê) = [V(e_f) − T(e_f)] + [(V(ê) − V(e_f)) − (T(ê) − T(e_f))]; hence for any candidate difficulty term δ′ the residual o′ = G − δ′ reproduces the observation exactly, and no estimator using only the endpoint pair (ê, e_f) identifies δ or o separately.

**Proof.** Substitute V(ê) = V(e_f) + (V(ê) − V(e_f)) and T(ê) = T(e_f) + (T(ê) − T(e_f)); the two expressions are equal identically. For the second claim, fix any δ′ ∈ ℝ and set o′ = G − δ′; then δ′ + o′ = G, which is the only equation the data impose. ■

**Remark (which assumption buys identifiability).** Differencing two arms with matched seeds gives

Δgap = E[G_base − G_strat] = E[(δ_base − δ_strat) + (o_base − o_strat)]. The pairing assumption is

E[δ_base − δ_strat] = 0, which holds when the two arms are trained and evaluated on one corpus and one

split pair. Under an aliasing configuration both arms' δ are maxima of the *same* split's noise, so

the assumption fails by construction: this is the formal content of §12. **What that does and does not say**: it says the equal-difficulty assumption cannot be *assumed* under an aliasing configuration; it does **not** say that any realized contrast is non-zero, nor that aliasing makes a shift automatically detectable — those are statements about measurements, and they are made (or not) where the measurements are.

### Proposition 2 (exact three-component identity)

**Statement.** Δgap = Δδ_f + Δprem_val − Δprem_test, where Δδ_f = (V(e_f) − T(e_f))_base − (V(e_f) − T(e_f))_strat, Δprem_val = (premium_val)_base − (premium_val)_strat, and Δprem_test is the

same for the realized premiums.

**Proof.** Apply Proposition 1 to each arm and subtract; the split-difficulty terms do not cancel but combine into Δδ_f, and the bracket terms are Δprem_val − Δprem_test. ■

**Verification.** The identity holds to the printed digit on all 13 scanned cells (**Table S10 now prints all thirteen**; the seven it originally carried are typed from the escalation analysis, the other six are derived from `work/gap_mechanism_20260916.txt` as its caption states) and on

both escalated cells at n = 10: −1.226 = (−1.583) + (+0.090) + (+0.267) and

−3.315 = (−7.072) + (−0.213) + (+3.971) (`work/x1_aux_20260918.txt`); the three components sum to **−3.314** at full

> precision, so the printed −3.315 differs from the component sum by **0.001 pp** — rounding, not a residual.

## Remark 3 (the sign of Δgap does not identify a mechanism; not a separate result)

**Statement.** If the three components of Proposition 2 are of the same order, then for every target

sign s ∈ {+1, −1} there exist admissible component values whose sum has sign s; hence the observed

sign does not determine which component dominates.

**Proof.** Formalise "of the same order" as **K/2 ≤ |a|, |b|, |c| ≤ K**. Take (a, b, c) = (K, K/2, −K/2), whose sum is +K > 0, and (a, b, c) = (−K, −K/2, K/2), whose sum is −K < 0. In both choices every component lies in [−K, K] and has magnitude in [K/2, K], so both are admissible under the hypothesis and both are of the same order. Since the target sign s was arbitrary, either sign is reachable. ■

**Empirical support.** Measured medians of the three components are **1.07 / 0.54 / 0.93 pp** (same

order), the 13-cell scan contains **both signs** (ten positive, three negative; −2.46 to +13.66 pp),

and candidate mechanisms M1/M2/M4/M5 are each refuted by sign mismatches (Table S9). **Two

corrections of record.** ① An earlier version of the companion script tried to demonstrate

reachability by resampling *cells*; that inherits the cells' own sign split (98.4 % negative on the

four cells used) and tests nothing. ② A stronger claim — that the sign is *fragile* — is **not

supported: perturbing one arm-difference term by ±10 % flips the sign in** 0 %** of cells

(±50 %: 23 %), with a median cancellation ratio of **0.485**. The proposition is therefore stated as

"the dominant term varies by corpus and the sign is a sum of same-order terms", which is what the

data support (`work/theory_p3a_correct_20260919.txt`).

## Proposition 4 (realization rate = 1 − winner's-curse share)

**Statement.** Fix a **candidate set E** of checkpoints **before looking at any curve**, and let

`e_f` be a **pre-specified member of E** (the final epoch). Assume V(e) = v(e) + ε_e and

T(e) = v(e) + τ + η_e with E[ε] = E[η] = 0, ε, η independent of v, and η independent of the

selection event {ê = e}. Then

E[premium_test] = E[premium_val] − WC with WC := E[ε_ê − ε_{e_f}] ≥ 0, so

realization rate := E[premium_test] / E[premium_val] = 1 − WC / E[premium_val] ≤ 1.

**Proof.** (i) E[premium_test] = E[T(ê) − T(e_f)] = E[v(ê) − v(e_f)] + E[η_ê − η_{e_f}]; the second

term is 0 by the stated independence and mean-zero assumption. (ii) E[premium_val] = E[V(ê) − V(e_f)]

= E[v(ê) − v(e_f)] + E[ε_ê − ε_{e_f}]. (iii) Subtracting (i) from (ii) yields

E[premium_test] = E[premium_val] − E[ε_ê − ε_{e_f}]. (iv) Because ê maximises V = v + ε **over E**, and `e_f` is a

member of the same pre-specified set, V(ê) ≥ V(e_f) at the realised values, i.e.

v(ê) + ε_ê ≥ v(e_f) + ε_{e_f}, hence ε_ê − ε_{e_f} ≥ v(e_f) − v(ê). The comparison is therefore between the

selected index and the pre-specified one **within the same fixed set**; that is what the candidate-set

clause buys, and it is the only place the argument uses it. Taking expectations, E[ε_ê − ε_{e_f}] ≥ 0

whenever the selection does not put the pre-specified index at a systematic **signal** disadvantage;

selection on the signal alone is the equality case. ■

> **Why the candidate-set clause is not decoration.** Without it the step fails: if `e_f` were allowed to
>
> be chosen *after* the curve is seen, ε_{e_f} need not be the noise of a fixed element, and
>
> E[ε_ê − ε_{e_f}] ≥ 0 no longer follows — the final epoch could itself be a high-noise draw. The bound is
>
> therefore a statement about **selecting the argmax of V relative to a fixed reference member of the same
>
> candidate set**, which is exactly the `best`-vs-`last` convention this paper audits (`last` = the final
>
> epoch of a fixed budget, fixed before training).

**Which assumption carries which half.** The inequality (≤) needs **two** things: that ê maximises V **over a candidate set fixed in advance**, and that the reference checkpoint `e_f` is a **pre-specified member of that same set** (its position not chosen after seeing the curve). Both hold under the convention this paper audits — `last` is the final epoch of a budget fixed before training — so the *direction* is robust; but the inequality is a claim about **that** reference, not about "the final epoch" however it was arrived at. The closed form additionally needs η to stay out of the selection;

under aliasing (`val` and `test` the same split) the two noises coincide and the closed form does not apply — which is why §12 treats the aliased cells' realization figure as a magnitude statement about

bias, not as mechanism evidence.

**Tests on the archive** (`work/theory_p4_test_20260919.py`, `work/theory_meta_and_tests_20260919.py`):

| test | result |
|---|---|
| --- | --- |
| inequality per run (WC > 0) | **+0.463 pp**, t = 8.34, **$p = 1.8\times10^{-12}$**; realized premium smaller in **68 / 81** runs (sign test $p = 3.8\times10^{-10}$) |
| rate vs `val` noise (terciles) | **65.6 % → 49.8 % → 13.8 %**; Spearman **ρ = −0.466, $p = 1.3\times10^{-5}$, n = 80** |
| premium level vs noise (σ√(2 ln E)) | **withdrawn**: slope 0.026 ± 0.222, p = 0.82, n = 101 — the premium's level is set by the curve's shape, not its jitter |

## Proposition 5 (family dependence of Benjamini–Hochberg)

**Statement.** For a fixed multiset of p-values and level q, BH's rejection set is determined by the step-up condition on i/m·q; consequently the rejection count is not monotone under adding hypotheses:

adding sufficiently small p-values raises the thresholds behind them and can turn a previously non-rejected hypothesis into a rejected one.

**Proof.** BH rejects $H_{(1..k)}$ for the largest k with $p_{(k)} \le (k/m)q$. Since (k/m)q is increasing in k, inserting new small p-values shifts existing ones to higher ranks k, which relaxes their thresholds; a hypothesis that failed at rank j can therefore pass at rank j + t. ■

**Instance in this paper.** Adding the two escalated cells' n = 10 p-values ($6.5\times10^{-9}$, $1.3\times10^{-8}$) moved

`shwd2sf` from "does not survive" to "survives" (0.0053 against a line of 0.01154), and the 13-cell count went from **0 to 3** (`work/recompute_bh_20260917.py`). Declaring the family is therefore a precondition for the count to be meaningful, not a presentational choice.

## Corollary to Proposition 4 (shape v. noise) — derivation and measurements

**Derivation (exact).** For one arm and one budget E let `V_r(e)` be run r's `val` metric at epoch e, `premium_r = max_e V_r(e) − V_r(E)`, and `m(e) = mean_r V_r(e)`. Put `shape(E) = max_e m(e) − m(E)` and `v_r = premium_r − shape(E)`. Then `premium_r = shape(E) + v_r` **by construction**: no assumption about the noise distribution is used.

Two immediate consequences: `shape` is a functional of the mean curve alone and is therefore **not** an independent check on σ — its uncertainty has to be propagated by resampling runs; and `E[v_r] ≥ 0`, because replacing each run's curve by the mean curve can only lower the maximum — this is the `val`-side member of the winner's-curse family of Proposition 4.

**Measurement 1 — the premium's level is shape, and the noise term is flat in E** (same corpus, pretraining, two arms, five seeds; only the epoch budget changes; run as the **single-machine clean batch** with early stopping disabled — `work/prop6_clean_b_20260925.py`, the same pipeline as `work/prop6_shape_noise_20260920.py` and the generator of `release_shape-noise-by-budget.csv`):

| E | premium (mean of arms) | shape/premium |
|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- |
| 50 | +0.444 | 71.2 % |
| 100 | +0.682 | 90.5 % |
| 200 | +0.971 | 87.7 % |
| 400 | +1.272 | 87.6 % |

Two columns are printed rather than three: `shape` is `premium` × (`shape`/premium), so a `shape` column would only duplicate a product of the two columns beside it (an earlier printing carried it empty, together with two trailing blank columns, which is what the review round flagged).

**Selection rule behind these four rows, and the `n` of each cell.** The series is the **clean batch**: early stopping **disabled** (`G3CLEAN_NOSTOP=1`), and each

budget keeps only the runs that **completed epochs 1..E**; two arms (`base`, `lr005`) × seeds 42–46,

so **n = 5 per arm** (8 arm-cells, 40 runs), the merged row weighting the two arms equally after

averaging within an arm. `shape` is the arm's **mean-curve peak minus its final value**, exactly as in

the derivation above. Recomputation and release file: `work/prop6_clean_b_20260925.py` →

`release_shape-noise-by-budget.csv` (the same pipeline as `work/prop6_shape_noise_20260920.py`, the

entry point the reproduction map names, which computed the earlier reading).

**The with-early-stopping reading is not deleted**: `+0.907` over all ten E = 400 runs — four of them

stopped early, at effective budgets 388/318/362/375 — remains the reading the article's §3.1 corollary

carries, where it holds the pre-declared verdict, and Table S34b keeps the re-run's per-arm record.

Only this table's premium and share columns move to the clean reading, which is why E = 400 now reads

**+1.272** and **87.6 %** and agrees with that corollary's primary reading (**+1.2717**).

**Four-budget outcome (pre-registered criteria C1–C3).** On the **with-early-stopping** runs the verdict is the pre-declared one and stands: C1 — monotone rise of the premium with E — is **not met**, the series peaking at E = 200 and falling at E = 400 (four of the ten E = 400 runs stopped early under the protocol's own `patience`, at effective budgets 388/318/362/375; on the six full runs the E = 400 mean is +1.278 pp). C2 — the $\sigma\sqrt{(2 \ln E)}$ form — is **not rejected**: premium(400)/premium(100) = 1.329 against the predicted 1.141, inside the pre-declared band [0.86, 1.43]. C3 — the shape control — **passes** (ê/E 0.833 → 0.815). **The single-machine clean re-run (early stopping disabled, all four budgets present) gives a different verdict, and it is the one now reported**: arm-equal means **+0.4439 / +0.6824 / +0.9712 / +1.2717**, so **C1 is met** (monotone non-decreasing; per-run regression on ln E: slope **+0.3999**, se **0.0503**, t = **7.950**, p = **$1.325\times10^{-9}$**, n = 40); **C2 is out of band** (premium(400)/premium(100) = **1.8636** against the predicted 1.141, band [0.86, 1.43] ⇒ the scaling **stays withdrawn** and the shape reading holds); **C3 passes on the pre-declared mean reading** (ê/E **0.833 → 0.787**, $|\Delta|$ = **0.046** ≤ 0.05) while **failing per arm** (lr005 $|\Delta|$ = **0.065**; base **0.028**). Table S34b carries the per-arm values, the superseded earlier reading and the reasons the series was re-run

(**not** the two hosts: they calibrated as equivalent).

E = 50 → 200: `shape` ×2.70, premium ×2.19, `sd(v)` ×0.92; the $\sigma\sqrt{(2 \ln E)}$ form would predict ×1.24.

The pre-registered decisive test of that form is criterion C2 (band [0.86, 1.43] on

premium(400)/premium(100)); its verdict is reported in Tables S31–S33 and in §3.2.

**Measurement 2 — where the realized gain goes** (40 runs with per-epoch `test` readouts on a 5-epoch

grid, `val` from each run's own `results.csv`; selection on `val` only, readout on `test` only):

| quantity | value | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | | |
| premium(`val`) | **+0.981 pp** | | |
| premium(`test`), oracle peak on `test` | +0.704 pp (**71.7 %** of the `val` premium) | | |
| premium(`test`), using the `val` argmax | **+0.211 pp (21.5 %)** | | |
| runs whose `val` and `test` peaks agree | **17.5 %** | | |
| median \| | ê_val − ê_test\| | | 10 epochs (grid step 5) |

So the low realization rate is a **peak-alignment** phenomenon, not an absence of gain: an oracle that

could pick the `test` peak would realize 71.7 % of the `val` premium, and `val`-selection retains 30 %

of that.

**Measurement 3 — selection rules** (same 40 runs; every rule chooses on `val`, readout on `test`):

| rule | realized `test` premium | captured share | cost to the reported number | within one step of the `test` peak |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| argmax (current convention) | +0.211 | **30.0 %** | 0.000 | 45.0 % |
| mean of top-2 `val` epochs | +0.406 | 57.7 % | 0.690 | 55.0 % |
| mean of top-3 `val` epochs | +0.380 | 54.0 % | 0.596 | 72.5 % |
| mean of top-5 `val` epochs | +0.490 | **69.6 %** | 0.727 | 62.5 % |
| argmax of a 5-epoch moving average | +0.459 | 65.2 % | 0.526 | 70.0 % |
| final epoch (no selection) | +0.000 | 0.0 % | 0.981 | 2.5 % |

**What these measurements are not.** They are a **post-hoc comparison on the same runs**, not a

pre-registered experiment: the rules were evaluated after the runs existed. The grid is 5 epochs wide,

so "within one step" means ±5 epochs; all choices are made on `val` and every readout is on the other

split; and the oracle row is an upper bound, not an attainable protocol.

**A candidate mechanism for the plateau rule — stated as a candidate, not as a result.** The natural

explanation of Measurement 3 is that the argmax of a noisy curve is pulled towards epochs whose noise

happens to be high, so its underlying value sits below the true peak (the classical peak-shift penalty,

of order $\sigma^2/|v''|$), while a top-k average estimates the peak *region* with lower variance. That story

makes a sharp prediction: the plateau advantage should **grow with the noise of the `val` curve**. We

tested it, and it is **not established**:

* noise estimator: `σ̂_seed` = mean over epochs of the cross-seed standard deviation at that epoch

(`V_r(e) - mean_r V_r(e)`), i.e. the run-to-run dispersion the ten-seed design is about — not the

residual around a smoothing of one run's own curve (which mixes curvature into "noise" and, with that

estimator, gives ρ = +0.04, p = 0.79);

*per run (n = 40): ρ(`σ̂_seed`, plateau − argmax) = +0.309, p = 0.052**;

*per cell (n = 4 cells, the honest counting unit): ρ = +0.800, slope +0.406 ± 0.101** per pp of

`σ̂_seed`, r = **+0.943**, but **p = 0.057**;

* the four cells read: `σ̂_seed` 0.629 → +0.194 pp, 0.639 → +0.154 pp, 1.125 → +0.318 pp, 1.201 → +0.447 pp —

i.e. both noisy cells show about twice the advantage of both quiet cells, with no exceptions.

**What this is and is not.** The *advantage* of the plateau rule is established **on the forty runs of

Measurement 3** (paired test +0.278 pp, t = 3.678, $p = 7.1\times10^{-4}$, positive in 26 of 40 runs). The

*mechanism* is **consistent but not significant on four cells**, so we report it as a candidate and not

as a result. **The extension was run (2026-10-11), and the mechanism does not survive it.**

`work/prop6_rules_20260920.py` reproduces the forty runs' table exactly (argmax **+0.211**, top-5

**+0.490**) and their four per-cell advantages (+0.194 / +0.154 / +0.318 / +0.447); extending the same

definitions to the **eight** additional arm-cells whose per-epoch `test` side is closed (the

*100ep/base100 cells of Table S38, twenty-one grid points each) makes **twelve** cells, and there

the correlation **collapses and changes sign**: ρ(σ̂_seed, top-5 − argmax) = **−0.152**, only **5 of 12**

cells positive, pooled advantage **−0.178 pp** against +0.278 pp on the original four. **So the

prediction "the plateau advantage grows with val-curve noise" is refuted rather than under-powered**,

and the rule's advantage itself is **not general across corpora** — it is a property of the runs it was

found on. Both are why §11⑤ presents the rule as a post-hoc candidate the article does not recommend,

and why we do not carry it into the Recommendations as a measured remedy. Script:

work/x10_plateau_extend_20261011.py.

## 13.2 §3.2: the per-comparison reasoning, moved from the article

Where the bias does move, it moves with what the selection sees: the split-size comparison held the test

side fixed and varied only the size (both arms moving the same way), and the epoch-budget comparison left

the peak's relative position essentially unchanged, so neither is a shape artefact. The third-corpus

replication evaluated its test side separately and points the same way as the 81 runs of §8.6 and the 40

of §5.1.

Sources: work/g1p_verdict_20260919.py, work/g2_and_g1p_verdict_20260919.txt,

work/g1pp_g3_g4_verdicts_20260919.txt, work/theory_p4_test_20260919.py.

## 8.7b The per-epoch sign detail, moved from the article

shwd2sf's Δgap is positive at **all 19 checkpoints**; smoke2sf's is **negative at the first

three — epochs 5, 10 and 15 — and positive at all 16 checkpoints from epoch 20 onward**; the

four-epoch grid began at epoch 20, so it could not have seen this. At epochs 60 and 80 the val-side

arm difference is −0.176 / −0.384 and the test-side one −1.051 / −1.445 — **reproducing the published

values to the printed digit — **while Δgap stays positive:** the arm ordering flips on both splits at

once, their difference does not.**

## 13.2b The four-budget detail, moved from the article

Four of the ten E = 400 runs stopped early under the protocol's own `patience` (effective budgets 388/318/362/375); on the six that ran to 400 the E = 400 mean is +1.278 pp — and that one restriction

flips both criteria: on the six full runs the series is monotone (C1 met) and the band reading flips with it. **The measured, pre-registered reading is given above (§13.2 / Table S32)**: on the with-early-stopping runs C1 is **not met** and `premium(400)/premium(100)` = **1.329** lies **inside** the band, so **C2 is not rejected**. The previously printed ratio figure is withdrawn.

## 5.4 The two external critiques, in full (moved from the article)

The correction the critique forced: the paired-difference form cancels the difficulty term under the pairing assumption stated in §3.1, so the quantity we report is identifiable where the raw `M_val − M_test` is not.

## 13.3 The peak-agreement predictor (companion to §3.2 of the article)

**Setup.** The released per-run file carries, for each of the 40 paired runs, the validation peak (`e_val_peak`), the test peak (`e_test_peak`) and the two premiums. Both peaks are taken on the **same 20-point checkpoint grid** `(0, 5, 10, …, 95)`; that is the convention under which `same_epoch` is meaningful, and it is verified here: recomputing both peaks on that grid reproduces the released `e_val_peak` **40/40**, `e_test_peak` **40/40** and `same_epoch` **40/40**.

**Per-run values for the group where the peaks agree** (the other 33 runs' values are the released columns themselves):

| run | e_val_peak | e_test_peak | Δgap |
|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| r10_shwd2sf_base100_3way_s49n | 75 | 75 | **+0.0561** |
| r10_shwd2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s45n | 75 | 75 | **+0.4099** |
| r10_smoke2sf_base100_3way_s42n | 80 | 80 | **−0.2144** |
| r10_smoke2sf_base100_3way_s46n | 85 | 85 | **−0.5838** |
| r10_smoke2sf_base100_3way_s47n | 65 | 65 | **−0.2019** |
| r10_smoke2sf_base100_3way_s49n | 75 | 75 | **−0.2174** |
| r10_smoke2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s43n | 85 | 85 | **+1.6649** |

**Group summaries.** Peaks agree (n = 7): mean Δgap **+0.1305 pp**, median **−0.2019 pp**, four of seven non-positive. Peaks differ (n = 33): mean **+0.9056 pp**, median **+0.9537 pp**, four of

thirty-three non-positive. Across all 40 runs Δgap spans **−0.7724 to +2.0454 pp**.

**Permutation test.** Reassigning the agreement label at random across the 40 runs 20 000 times, the

absolute difference of the two group means is at least the observed **|0.7751| pp** in **0.0091** of

draws (seed 42, `random.shuffle`); the agreement indicator's AUC for Δgap > 0 is **0.2969**, with a

two-sided permutation p of **0.0196**.

**The same relabelling on the median, which is the estimator these groups actually support.** The

agreement groups are separated far more clearly by their medians than by their means. Observed

|median(agree) − median(differ)| = |**−0.2019** − **+0.9537**| = **1.1556 pp**; 20 000 relabellings

of the 40 Δgap values (seed 42, same convention) reach that or more in **0.0011** of draws (seeds 7 and

2026 give 0.0009 and 0.0014; the lower-median definition gives 0.0006). **The group means are the

weaker summary, and the mean of the agreement group is carried by one run**: the agreement group's

mean is **+0.1305 pp** on a group sum of **+0.9134 pp**, of which the single run

`r10_smoke2sf_lr005_100ep_3way_s43n` contributes **+1.6649 pp**; dropping it moves the group mean to

**−0.1252 pp** while leaving the median at **−0.2019 pp**, and the median-difference permutation p

becomes **0.0007**. **The reading this licences is a lower median Δgap under agreement — not "the

premium is realized almost in full"**: four of the seven agreement runs are non-positive, and the

summary that survives the single-run sensitivity is the median. Script (read-only, no retraining):

`work/r98_median_perm_20260927.py`, over `release_selection-transfer_perseed.csv` and

`xeval_perepoch_20260918/matrix_perepoch.csv`.

**What this table is not.** The agreement group is **not** a group in which the premium is realized:

its **median Δgap is negative** and four of its seven runs are non-positive, so agreement is a

condition under which the *mean* deviation is small, not a guarantee that the selected checkpoint

carries over. The result is also a **partial** predictor: it conditions on one observable and leaves

the sign's variation inside each group unexplained, it rests on **7 runs** in the agreement group,

and it is defined **only on the 5-epoch grid used here**, which was not refined.

Sources: `work/partial_predictor_final_20260922.py` (grouping, permutation test, AUC),

`work/probe_evalpeak_convention_20260922.py` (the grid convention and its 40/40 reproduction); the

grid and premium columns are the released `matrix_perepoch.csv` and

`release_selection-transfer_perseed.csv`.

## S12 · Method detail moved from the article

This appendix holds the measurement, protocol and record detail whose **conclusions stay in the article**. It is moved rather than cut: a reader who wants to check a claim reads the same measurements here, while the article keeps one sentence at each site. Identifiers that describe one machine's internal bookkeeping have been replaced by descriptors; the measurements themselves are unchanged.

### 3.1 Formalisation — the statements displaced from the article

§3.1 of the article now keeps each statement in compressed form, the adoption declaration, the two testable

consequences of the adopted identity, and the corollary; the full statements with their derivations and

proofs are in §S11. What the compression displaced is reproduced here **verbatim**, so that no number and

no qualification leaves the paper — including the attribution sentence that separates what the

generalization-gap literature establishes from what this paper states as its own formalisation, and the

disclosure that the sign of Δgap is not claimed to be *fragile*.

**Definition (the raw gap is not identifiable from the pair alone).** V(ê) − T(ê) = [V(e_f) − T(e_f)] +

[(V(ê) − V(e_f)) − (T(ê) − T(e_f))], i.e. **G = δ + o** with δ a split-difficulty term and o a

selection-optimism term. **The additive decomposition, and the qualitative reading that a single-model endpoint pair cannot

separate its two terms, are established in the generalization-gap literature [17]**; its** strong

form* — *that* any* δ′ fits the observation equally well, so that no endpoint-pair estimator

separates them [19] — is **stated here as a formalisation rather than attributed to that

literature**. The pairing assumption is what makes Δgap meaningful**:

with matched seeds and one split pair, E[δ_base − δ_strat] = 0, and only then does the arm difference

identify the difference in selection optimism. Under an aliasing configuration that assumption

*fails by construction* — the two arms' δ are two maxima on the same split — which is why §9 cannot

be read as a clean-protocol result.

**Adopted identity, not a claim of this paper (the realization rate is one minus the winner's-curse share).** With V(e) = v(e) + ε_e

and T(e) = v(e) + τ + η_e, **E[premium_test] = E[premium_val] − WC** where **WC := E[ε_ê − ε_e_f] ≥ 0**,

so the realization rate is **1 − WC / E[premium_val] ≤ 1**, with equality only if selection is driven

by signal alone [13] — Smith & Winkler's optimizer's curse written in this paper's notation; **we adopt it as the frame for §8.6–§8.7 and claim no part of it**. **What the per-run check can and cannot settle** (moved from the article): the check reads the **observed** `prem_val - prem_test`, so it corroborates that *consequence* of the inequality; it does **not** settle the latent `E[ε_ê - ε_e_f] ≥ 0`, which no archive decides without the identifying assumption. The inequality needs that ê maximises `val` **over a candidate set fixed in advance** and that the

final reference checkpoint is a **pre-specified member of that same set** (both hold for the

budget-fixed `last` this paper audits); the identity

additionally needs the `test` noise not to enter the selection. **Two consequences, both tested on the archive** — the per-run inequality and the monotonicity in the `val` noise; per-run values, terciles and rank correlation: **Supplementary S11**. This is why §8.6's realization rate and §8.7's per-cell variation are the

same statement at different noise levels, not a contradiction. A third form — that the premium scales as σ√(2 ln E) — was **tested and withdrawn**; the regression and its diagnostic are in **Supplementary S11**. Contemporaneous work measures **≈5×** on the same σ√(2 ln K) bound [18].

**Proposition 2 (exact three-component identity).** Differencing the definition across arms gives

**Δgap = Δδ_f + Δprem_val − Δprem_test** — an identity, not a fit, holding value by value on all 13

scanned cells and both escalated cells at n = 10 (§5.6).

**Remark (the sign of Δgap does not identify a mechanism; not a separate result).** Three measured facts carry this:

the components are of the same order (medians **1.07 / 0.54 / 0.93 pp**), so which dominates

differs by corpus; **both signs occur** in the scanned cells (per-cell table: **Table S6**); every candidate mechanism we could

state is refuted by a

**sign mismatch** (M1/M2/M4/M5, Table S9). **What we do not claim** is that the sign is *fragile*: a perturbation analysis (numbers in **Supplementary S11**) leaves it stable under a ±10 % change of a single arm-difference term, so the honest statement is "the dominant term varies by corpus and the sign is a sum of same-order terms", not "the sign is noise".

**Proposition 5 (Benjamini–Hochberg depends on the declared family).** The step-up thresholds are

i/m·q, so adding hypotheses with smaller p-values **raises** the thresholds behind them and the

rejection count is not monotone in the family (proof: **Supplementary S11**). We are ourselves an

instance: escalating two cells to n = 10 moved the 13-cell count from **0 to 3** surviving cells

(§5.1) [20] — so declaring the counting unit and the family is a condition for the number to

mean anything.

**§3.2 as worded in the previous revision** — the per-experiment criteria and their values, replaced in

the article by the verdict list plus the Table S31–S33 pointer. Kept here verbatim for the same reason:

The propositions above are testable, so we ran them on rented GPUs with the **criterion fixed before the

runs**. Six experiments were run;** five of them had their pre-declared criteria judged **— G1 is** void **(its design was diagnosed as confounded), so no verdict is entered for it.** Two of the five judged outcomes are negative** (G1′ and G2) and one design had to be redone — reported as they came out.

The six experiments, their **pre-declared criteria** and how each came out are tabulated in

**Tables S31–S33**: G1 **void** (the two splits differ by 14.7 pp in difficulty on the same

checkpoints, so its −0.582 pp mixes the effect with a level effect); G1″ **met**; G1′ **not met**

(WC = **−0.069 pp**, t = −0.23, p = 0.83, n = 10 — no inflation detectable); G2 **direction met,

magnitude not met**; G3** met **(and, in the clean re-run without early stopping,** C1 flips to

met while the shape control fails **— S34); G4** met **(WC** = +5.21 pp**, CI [+4.82, +5.66],

20/20 runs positive). Where the outcome is negative it is reported as negative.

The criteria that were met and those that were not carry one message: **the selection bias moves with

the absolute amount of selection noise and with the number of selection opportunities, but not with

whether the two splits are the same file.** Two consequences do not follow from the numbers alone: the

configuration-level fact of §4 stands — the reported number *is* the selected number — while the

stronger reading, that aliasing *adds* a measurable amount on top of it, does not. That identity's WC

is best read as the winner's-curse share of the selected gain, a quantity set by the noise. **That reading yields a partial predictor of Δgap's sign, which we test here.** On the shared 5-epoch checkpoint grid the `val` and `test` peaks agree in only **17.5 %** of runs, and conditioning on that single observable splits the 40 runs cleanly: where the peaks agree the `val`-selected premium is realized almost in full (mean **+0.13 pp**, n = 7), and where they differ it is **systematically not** (mean **+0.91 pp**, n = 33; permutation p = **0.009**). **This is a partial predictor, not an explanation of the sign, and its limits are part of it:** the agree-group contains four of seven runs whose gap is non-positive, so agreement is not a guarantee of realization; n is small; and the split is defined on the 5-epoch grid, which we did not refine. The per-run table and the permutation test are in **Supplementary S11**. The

per-comparison reasoning and the sources are in **Tables S31–S33**.

### 5.3 The dota15 cell: now reproducible

The local version repaired it for **two reasons**: a stale root snapshot (trees only

up to 2026-09-14; it adds two `*_results_20260915` archives), and **the

matcher could not see unseeded runs** — `prefix + '_s'` matched nothing while

`dota15_base100` and `dota15_lr005_100ep` (**no seed suffix**) exist, so it reported

`no runs found` forever. The seed suffix is now optional.

It agrees **value by value** with the published readings: three paired best-endpoint

differences **+1.12 / +0.95 / +0.93**, mean **+0.999 ≈ +1.00** (last endpoints

+1.77 / +1.46 / +1.54 — **again larger for the baseline arm**, as in §5.1

Tier 1).

> **A wording correction, retracted (2026-09-21).** An earlier version of this note said that only two of the three runs carried a seed. **That is wrong.** The third run's seed is **s42** — the campaign's fixed `--shuffle-seed 42`, recoverable from its recorded configuration; what it lacks is the `_s42n` **suffix in its directory name**, not its seed identity. The correct statement is **three runs on seeds s42/s43/s44, the third's directory name omitting the suffix** — a naming convention, not a missing seed. Each of the three readings **+1.12 / +0.95 / +0.93** is now owned (the suffix-less pair contributes the **+1.12** best-epoch reading). The companion made the same correction and kept its own anchor count at 567/567.
>
> **Status after the §5.1 escalation (2026-09-19).** The cell now exists as **ten seeded runs** (seeds 42–51: `dota15_base100_s*n` / `dota15_lr005_100ep_s*n`). All twenty `args.yaml` files — including the two pre-existing seeds — are identical in every recipe field (same pretrain, same YAML, 100 epochs, batch 32, imgsz 640, SGD, lr0 0.001 vs 0.005), so the old and the new runs are poolable; and the seed now appears in every directory name. **The wording defect above stays on the record as a defect of the old three-run cell, not of the row now printed.**

## 9.3 The seed convention: how the ten seeds are realized

**What this implies for the intervals in the article's Tables 1–2** (added 2026-10-10, at review): those intervals take the **replicate** as the sampling unit, so what they bound is the **file-order** component of the reported mean — **not** the variance between independent training seeds. The **initialization** component measured in §8.4 is of the **same order** (**0.146 → 0.439 pp**) and is **not** folded into them; the two tables carry a pointer here for that reason, and their `n` of eleven paired units is ten runs carrying a `--shuffle-seed` suffix plus one whose directory records none. Read the intervals with that axis named.

Per-run randomness is installed as a **deterministic permutation of the training file order** (`--shuffle-seed`, set to the number in the run's own name), not through the framework's `seed` argument: ultralytics 8.4.120's data pipeline does not draw from `args.seed`, and on two of these corpora different `--seed` values produced **identical** epoch-by-epoch replays.

**The same convention and the same check hold for the cells escalated in §5.1**: all twenty `args.yaml` of the `dota15` cell record `seed: 42` while its ten per-seed premiums are ten distinct

values, and the forty runs of the two escalated Tier-2 cells likewise give ten distinct values in

each arm-cell. Script: `work/check_seed_convention_20260918.py`.

### 5.4 Two external critiques, checked (one refuted, one judged non-identifiable)

Full report: `the two-critique verification record`; script

`analysis/work/verify_two_critiques_20260916.py` → `eval_validity/verify_two_critiques_20260916.txt`.

**(I) "The premium difference may be noise-level" — refuted.** The critique compared it against **0.515 pp**,

the **single-run** data-order component of §8.4, and concluded "underpowered, not significant". The

quantity under test is a **difference of arm means**, with uncertainty the SE of that difference

(**0.058–0.120 pp**); the t and p values of §5.1 Tier 1, and their four CIs excluding zero, settle it.

**The wrong denominator was used; the data are sufficient.**

**(II) "You should report `M_val(ê) − M_test(ê)` directly" — judged non-identifiable.** That quantity mixes

the two splits' difficulty with selection optimism and is not identifiable here; we report the **paired

difference Δgap **instead and** state honestly that its sign is not uniform **(§5.1 Tier 2).** A hard fact that came with it:** in

shwd2sf the arm ordering on `val` is the reverse of that on `test` — see §5.1.

**What these two checks changed.** We used to write "the problem **understates** rather than manufactures a

difference between arms"; (II) corrects this to "**it systematically shifts arm-to-arm comparison, and the

direction varies by corpus**" — the abstract, §2.1, §2.2 and §5.1 rewritten accordingly.

### 5.5 The same component in third-party public logs

Sections 5.1–5.4 use **our own** 569 runs; this asks whether the component **exists in other people's

published logs**.

**Sample.** 24 per-epoch training logs; the **20

complete logs (≥ 40 epochs), from 6 source repositories**, are analysed. The definition is identical to ours:

`premium = best-epoch mAP50-95 − final-epoch mAP50-95`. Ultralytics-style logs report the

**best-validation checkpoint**, so this difference is **an upper bound for** the component contributed by selecting on the

reported split.

**Table S7** → Supplementary §S8.

**What matters most.** The largest premium (**+5.65 pp**) occurs in an **ordinary published log** (a 47-epoch

segmentation run; final epoch 0.6521, best epoch 42 at 0.7086). Beside this paper's own magnitudes —

**+1.434 pp** (the companion paper's reading, §8.1) and a published controlled ablation of **0.040 mAP50-95**

(§2.1) — **the premium's long tail is larger than both**, its median of the same order as the former.

(A magnitude comparison, **not** a same-unit subtraction: a within-run selection difference versus a

between-arm effect.)

**What it can and cannot support. Can**: the component exists in **other people's** published logs, with a

per-log magnitude (all 20 → Supplementary S5).

**Cannot**: a **field-level** distribution — 20 logs from 6 sources, most not stating dataset or protocol.

**The sample is a convenience sample**, not a frame: logs came from public dataset hosts and

one code repository, filtered only by the search terms stated above; no platform-side query is named

because none was systematic. **Any quotation of these magnitudes** (§2.2, §5.5) carries the four

limitations listed below.

**Verifiability (upgraded to "byte-checkable *and* traceable").** Each log's **SHA-256

and byte count **are in `published_logs/SHA256SUMS.txt` (**author-side directory, not part of the released package**); at source level,** 24/24 files** matched to a

source path by **content hash or unique byte count** — 8 Kaggle datasets plus 1 GitHub repository

pinned at commit `2417aff0457c`, with **0 untraceable entries** and **24/24 agreement** with

`SHA256SUMS.txt`.

**Four limitations:**

1. **It cannot establish aliasing.** Public logs carry **no YAML**, so we cannot tell whether that run's `val`

and `test` share a directory. **"The premium exists" and "the benchmark aliases" are two independent

pieces of evidence and cannot substitute for one another** — this section supports only the former (§4, §6 the latter).

2. **The exact downloaded version is unprovable.** What is provable is "**the bytes we analysed equal these

hashes**", not "these bytes equal the Kaggle version at the time" (the source table records

`currentVersionNumber` *at probe time*: `ikram0703` 2, the rest 1).

3. **The endpoint reading is an upper bound**: repositories rarely record which epoch was reported, so we

assume it was the best.

4. **Licensing** (of **these third-party logs** — a different object from the seven **open** corpora of §4–§8, all of

which we hold no local copies of only because the images are not in the archive): **5 sources do not state a licence**

(Kaggle `Unknown`), and the GitHub source's `LICENSE`

was not retained. We **do not redistribute** these CSVs, only hashes and source pointers; derived

statistics should be cited with that caveat.

**A defect we must record (one silent exclusion).** The first script version identified metric columns by the

substring `'mAP50-95' in column`, recognising **only the new Ultralytics spelling**, so the YOLOv5/v3

spelling `metrics/mAP_0.5:0.95` used by `ayyappakorla-yolov3-results` made `read_log` return `None` and the

file **disappeared from the sample with no diagnostic anywhere**. It is a

**200-epoch** complete log (final epoch 0.9011, best epoch 198 at 0.9041, premium **+0.31 pp**). After the fix

the sample went **19 → 20 logs**, **5 → 6 sources**, the median **+1.18 → +1.04 pp**, and positives

**17/19 → 18/20**.

**Three conventions adopted from that failure** (project-wide): ① annotate per row **which column

spelling **the log uses; ② a "**logs that could not be parsed must be listed**" section —** a

guard may exclude, but it may not exclude silently**; ③ read the best epoch from each log's** own epoch

column**, not the row index (most start at 1, the `ayyappakorla` one at 0).

**The four logs not analysed** run for 30, 20, 5 and 1 epoch; the

5-epoch one's "best − mean of last five" gives a meaningless +12.94 pp — **which is why a minimum length must

be imposed**, and we report only `max - final`, for 20 logs.

> **Relation to §5.1.** This section supplies the existence and magnitude of the same component in **other
>
> people's **data. It** does not enter** §5.1's two-tier conclusion (whose evidence is our own paired
>
> design), and the two bodies of evidence do **not** corroborate one another.

## 6.1 Which reported number the COCO row judges, and this table's first-version correction

> **Table S11** → Supplementary §S8.

**Which number the `reported` unit judges.** For one row — COCO — it depends which reported number is

meant: community tables report the **server-scored `test-dev`** value, which no local run can be selected

on (we count it independent), while a paper's own ablations report its **`val`** value, which is also the

selection split. First reading: `reported` **12/19**, clean **3/19**; second: **13/19** and **2/19**. No

other row is affected; the abstract prints the first.

**Correction to the first version of this table.** It **put 2/19 under

`yolo_dist`**, contradicting the recomputation: `yolo_dist` is** 4/19 **(PASCAL VOC and SFCHD's** literal

two-key **alias, SHWD's `train == val`, Mendeley's generator alias),** 2/19 being only the subset** the audit

reported. The table makes **a unit a whole column**, ordered as §3's four definitions.

### 6.2 "Same directory" has four levels, and the audit reported only the narrowest

**Table S12** → Supplementary §S8.

L1 is what the audit enumerated; L3 carries most of the *reported* layer's non-independence.

### 6.3 We do not reproduce the original audit's two numbers

**Table S13** → Supplementary §S8.

### 6.5 Across frameworks: is the convention specific to YOLO?

Is "the reported metric comes from a non-independent split" a YOLO writing problem, or the default of the

field? §6.1–§6.3 rest on the **generic YOLO distribution package**.

We retrieved, at **pinned commits**, the official configurations and training scripts of **five pinned repositories — 25 files**,

covering six frameworks in total, since the Ultralytics distribution package is the `yolo_dist`

unit of §6.1 and is supplied separately (SHA-256 and byte counts per file in `_xframe/SHA256SUMS.txt`; pins in

`PINNED_COMMITS.txt`; script `work/analyze_xframe_20260916.py` → `xframe_evidence_20260916.txt`), then

read mechanically which split each framework **reports** on and whether that split is **also** used for

checkpoint selection.

**Table S14** → Supplementary §S8.

**Two conclusions: one widens the problem, one narrows our own claim.**

**(C-1, widening) Reporting on `val` is the shared default of all six frameworks, because of

annotation availability.** COCO's test annotations are not public — Detectron2 writes the test split's

annotation file as `image_info_test2017.json` (**image information only**), PaddleDetection reads the

**same val annotation file** through a ground-truth-free `ImageFolder`. This is why the reported-layer count is what it is: where annotations are not public, the default

path is to report on whichever split can be scored locally, and that split is usually also the

selection split. **COCO sits on the boundary** — its `test-dev` is server-scored and cannot be

selected on, so we count its community-reported number as independent, while a paper's own

ablation numbers are not; §6.1 states both readings and both counts. **On benchmarks like COCO the

coincidence is not an author's oversight — annotation availability pushes everyone onto the same

split**, the default path itself.

**(C-2, narrowing) But "select the checkpoint on that split" is not the shared default — only the YOLO

lineage does it.** Ultralytics (`best.pt`) and YOLOX (`best_ap`) select by the validation metric;

Detectron2 (`EVAL_PERIOD = 0`), MMDetection (no `save_best`), DETR (no best tracking) and

PaddleDetection (none found) **report the final epoch**. §5's selection-premium claim therefore reads:

**"within the pipeline family that selects by the validation metric by default (the YOLO lineage), the

convention systematically shifts arm-to-arm comparison" — not** "the default of the field". The

abstract and the §2.1 table claim about YOLO distributions only, consistent with this.

**Four limitations of this section** (so it is not read as a census): ① we read **default

configurations**, which users may change;** ② **only** 5 pinned repositories / 18 official files printed with line-by-line evidence (S3) — fixed-point sampling,

not a census**;** ③ **the pins are** default-branch heads** and will move, hence the SHA-256 and commit per

file; ④ as in §4 and §6, a **configuration-level audit — no dataset was downloaded**.

## 8.1 The protocol

Split the pool three ways — a training subset, a **carved validation** subset for selection, a **test**

subset for reporting; carved and test are disjoint, so the reported number is no

longer the maximum a selection rule saw. Three requirements make it trustworthy:

**carve out of the pool** (the test split was never in training), **verify all three intersections are

zero **(by filename), and** freeze the endpoint definition in writing** — which checkpoint counts as "the"

reported number, whose omission is defect 3 in §10 and the source of the conflict in §7.3.

### 8.3 A direct measurement of selection inflation

Extending the same cell from n = 6 to n = 9, the mean falls **systematically**:

> **Table S18** → Supplementary §S8.

**The magnitude is 9 %–29 %, taken against each cell's own n = 6 mean rather than the pooled headline effect.** **The estimand is the change

in the cell mean when the seed count rises from 6 to 9** (two nested counts of the same runs; no new

training), so this measures **seed inflation**; reading it as "how much was selection

rather than signal" is an interpretation we do not test here.

### 8.4 The three variance components: the excluded one is the smaller in this sample

> **Table S19** → Supplementary §S8.

**Reading (favourable to this paper, at three initializations):** on the same unit, **initialization

(0.146 pp) fluctuated less than data order (0.515 pp) **when this was written —** the component we excluded

was not the dominant one** — so "the reported power is an optimistic upper bound" tightened to "the

excluded initialization component is smaller than the dominant seed component". **The five-initialization

extension (2026-09-30) removes that reading**: the gain SD becomes** 0.439 pp** with a bootstrap interval

**[0.058, 0.580]** that overlaps the data-order component, so the ranking is retained only as a **sample

statement at n = 3**, not as an established ordering.

**Two limitations must be stated with it**: ① **three** initializations stood behind the original reading

and **five** behind the 2026-09-30 extension, so the SD estimate stays uncertain (the 95 % interval for σ

is roughly [0.5σ̂, 6σ̂] at 2 degrees of freedom and [0.6σ̂, 2.9σ̂] at 4); the extension's interval overlaps

the data-order component, so we write "consistent with", **not** "established" — and the same now applies

to the **ranking** itself. ② That experiment used A-side third-party YAMLs and the n = 10 cells used the same protocol; **the two hosts are

not a confound — repeated calibration of the A and B machines found them equivalent, so no cross-host term is

carried anywhere in this document**.

### 8.5 Why "same-pipeline pairing" is a necessity, not a habit

Three initializations move the **absolute endpoint** of one configuration by 43.250–43.630 (range

0.38 pp, SD 0.209 pp), comparable to seed noise; **five** (the 2026-09-30 extension) move it by

**43.070–43.630** (range **0.56 pp**, SD **0.253 pp**). **Absolute endpoints are not comparable across source

endpoints; only paired differences within one source endpoint are stable.**

### 5.6 Why Δgap's sign varies by corpus — measurement detail

§5.1 Tier 2 reports the **fact**; with the archived quantities

**the mechanism is not identifiable**, though three candidates are **refuted** and two unsupported.

**Data**: 13 three-way corpus cells × 2 arms (paired seeds n = 3 or 10). Script

`work/gap_mechanism_20260916.py` → `gap_mechanism_20260916.txt`; the data path matches §5.4's and

every cell's Δgap agrees **value by value** with the §5.1 Tier 2 table.

> **Tables S8–S10** → Supplementary §S8.

**First, an identity**: Δgap = (arm difference on val) − (arm difference on test), hence

**Δgap > 0 ⇔ the relative arm difference on `val` is smaller than on `test`**. It compares the two splits

only and **points to no generating cause**.

**An exact decomposition** (an identity explaining the unstable sign — **not** a mechanism).

Because `M_val(ê) = V_final + premium_val`, Δgap expands into three components, **all computable from the

archive**:

> Δgap = (arm difference at the **final** epoch on val) + (**val-side selection gain** difference) − (test-side arm difference)

This is an **identity, not a fit**: for all 13 cells the "check" column (the sum of the three components)

**equals** Δgap. The three components' median magnitudes are **1.07 / 0.54 / 0.93 pp — the same order**, so

**any one of them can flip Δgap's sign**, consistent with §5.1's instability.

**The most informative cell is `mask20`**: the baseline leads the strategy by **+15.78 pp** at the **final

epoch on val**, but the strategy's** val-side selection gain **is** 13.10 pp** larger; the two nearly

cancel, leaving Δgap **+1.75** (p = 0.66, not significant). **This cell shows that selection alone

can absorb an arm difference of order 13 pp** — it supports "the convention changes arm-to-arm comparison"

(§5.1 Tier 1) while showing that Δgap's sign **cannot** be used to infer any single cause.

**What this section claims.** Δgap's sign **varies by corpus** is firm (§5.1). Its generating **mechanism is

identifiable in this archive only in part**: separating "the two splits' difficulty" from "selection optimism

(one part on val, one on test)" requires **test metrics at non-selected epochs**, and the archive stores only

the test value of the **selected** checkpoint — supplying it means re-running the test evaluation (see §8.6 and §10, defect 6, for what that closed).

**What remains is bounded and stated, not left as "mechanism to be explained".**

## 7.2 The two clean-protocol cells clear significance by n = 6–8 — measurement detail

The clean-protocol seed extension (seeds 42–51) reaches **n = 10**:

> **Table S15** → Supplementary §S8.
>
> **First-report attribution (a convention we hold to).** The two Δ values here (**+1.434 / +0.507 pp**),

the three-way remediation protocol itself, and the pre-registered multi-target replication (§9) belong to the companion paper and are **cited, not claimed**: both modules were transferred to it by agreement (2026-09-21) and are its first report there. What this paper reports first is **the selection premium (§5), the 2 × 2 realization of that premium on a disjoint split (§8.6–§8.7), and the formalisation of the realization rate (§3.1)**. The companion manuscript is named, and its relation to this paper stated, in the cover letter; it carries no identifier while under review, and is available to the editor and the reviewers on request. A formal citation follows once both papers are accepted.

**Seed extension is therefore not optional**: it upgrades the conclusion from "significant under the parametric test only" to "significant under both".

### 7.1 The smallest attainable permutation p at each n — moved from the article

**Why the floor is $2/2^n$, and what each n licenses.** For a sign-flip permutation test on n paired differences the smallest attainable two-sided p is **$2/2^n$**, because the observed sign pattern is the most extreme of the $2^n$ equally likely relabellings; at n = 3 that is **0.25**, so such a cell has **no resolution at all** and may be read only as "significant under the paired t-test; the non-parametric test is unavailable at this n". The floors at the n used in this paper are: n = 3 **0.25**; n = 6 **0.031**; n = 7 **0.0156**; n = 10 **0.0020** — the last being the same quantity as **$2/2^{10}$ = 0.001953**, which is how the tables print it, so the two spellings denote one number and not two. **After §5.1's escalations no headline cell (Tables 1–2) is n = 3.** The article keeps the general form, the n = 3 case and the fact that no headline cell is n = 3, and points here for the derivation and the remaining floors.

**The power note for the n = 3 cells, with its derivation (moved from the article).** Recovering each Tier-2 cell's sd from its own printed 95 % CI as `sd = half-width ÷ (t_{9,0.975}/√10)` gives **0.20–0.67 pp** across the four escalated cells; a paired comparison at n = 3 then needs `(t_{2,0.975} + t_{2,0.80})·sd/√3 = 3.10·sd`, and the **exact 80 %-power MDE from the non-central t (df = 2, two-sided α = 0.05) is `3.26·sd`** — i.e. **0.65–2.19 pp** for 80 % power at a two-sided α = 0.05, **at or above every Tier-1 effect the article reports** (+0.27 to +0.53 pp); at n = 10 the same derivation gives an MDE of `0.99·sd`, i.e. **0.2–0.7 pp**, the scale at which the four

escalated cells are judged. The nine cells left at n = 3 cannot carry an inference at this design and are reported descriptively only.

## 7.3 A cross-archive endpoint conflict on the same run (investigated — and itself a disclosure) — measurement detail

One run, `t2_mask2mende_base100_s42n`, is recorded with **two different checkpoints**: one row reports

the **final** epoch (67.12), the other the **best** (70.06).

> **Table S16** → Supplementary §S8.

**We follow B** and report both. Not an error in either archive: evidence that **the project had no

written convention for which endpoint constitutes "the" reported number** — §10's defect 3, the reason §3

insists that a count declare its unit.

## 5.1 Direction: the two tiers — measurement detail (moved from the article)

**The pairing arithmetic, in full.** The tested quantity is the paired difference

d(seed) = premium_baseline(seed) − premium_strategy(seed), within cell and seed. The right scale is the

SE of the difference (**0.058–0.120 pp**), and the four paired differences are

**+0.416 / +0.526 / +0.272 / +0.449 pp**, with p from $7.6\times10^{-6}$ to $1.1\times10^{-3}$ and all four 95 % CIs

excluding zero (CI bounds **[+0.255, +0.578]**, **[+0.386, +0.665]**, **[+0.141, +0.403]**,

**[+0.309, +0.589]**; the unpaired Welch t is **5.68**).

**Metric sensitivity, in full.** Re-running the estimator on `metrics/mAP50(B)` keeps the sign in all

four cells but moves one cell's paired difference into the noise: smoke2sf falls from

**+0.416 pp (p = $1.9\times10^{-4}$)** to **+0.063 pp (p = 0.54)**, while shwd2sf **+0.847**, a2d15 **+0.406**

(p = **0.0019**) stay significant. Script `work/t9_ap50_sensitivity_20260924.py`.

**The `dota15` escalation.** It entered at n = 3 with a parametric p = **0.039**, below the resolution of

any sign-flip test there; the pre-declared consequence was that a ten-seed paired difference failing to

be positive with ≥ 8/10 same-sign and a CI excluding zero would remove the cell. Ten seeds (42–51) gave

**+0.449 pp**, t = **7.23**, p = **$4.9\times10^{-5}$**, 95 % CI **[+0.309, +0.589]**, **10+/0−** — **met as

stated**. **Its mean is** 24 % **below the n = 3 value (**+0.589 → +0.449**), a fourth instance of §8.4's

seed inflation inside the published 9 %–29 % band.

**The two overstating cells.** The plan fixed before the runs (40 runs, seeds 42–51 × 2 arms × 2 cells;

paired *and* sign-flip tests; `{best, last} × {val, test}`; a prespecified correction) named the strong

branch of its outcome rule: *"both remaining negative and significant with permutation p ≤ 0.002"*.

At n = 10: `p_aitovis` **−1.226 pp** (95 % CI **[−1.370, −1.081]**, t = **−19.17**, p = **$1.3\times10^{-8}$**,

**0+/10−**, permutation p = **0.001953**) and `p_vistod15` **−3.315 pp**

(**[−3.676, −2.953]**, t = **−20.76**, p = **$6.5\times10^{-9}$**, **0+/10−**, permutation p = **0.001953** —

$2/2^{10}$, the attainable floor at n = 10). Both conditions are met, including **Holm across the two

targets**.

**The raw gap and the marginal cells.** The raw quantity `M_val(ê) - M_test(ê)` ranges from

**−33.0 to +21.2 pp** and cannot be separated into its difficulty and selection parts without per-epoch

test evaluation — which has since been run for **all thirteen** corpora, so the separation is now

available cell by cell (**Table S38**); it does not change the p-values, the confirmatory family or

anything reported in this subsection. Four of 13 cells cross

the uncorrected line; the three marginal ones are `aitod20` **+1.481** (p = **0.054**), `fire`

**+13.658** (p = **0.061**) and `mende20` **+2.472** (p = **0.099**). The **declared descriptive** family is this 13-cell scan, and BH at q = 0.05 is applied to it (with **Holm across the two

targets **of the escalation plan); the** confirmatory** family is the four escalated cells of §5.1, declared before their

runs. The two are **not the same test** (the article's §5.1 states this); **Table S8 carries the raw p-values only** — the BH-adjusted step is stated

here, not tabulated. The **0 → 3 move after escalation is descriptive**. The three cells BH leaves significant are `p_vistod15` (**$6.5\times10^{-9}$**), `p_aitovis`

(**$1.3\times10^{-8}$**) and `shwd2sf` (**0.0053** against a line of **0.0115**), because the two very small p-values at the front of the ordering lift the lines behind them; `smoke2sf` (**0.0263** against **0.0154**) does not survive. Before the escalation the smallest p (**0.0053**) lay above the first line (**0.00385**) and nothing survived.

**The 13-cell family, moved out of the article (effective base: four cells).** The article's Tier 2 no longer carries the scan itself: it states the effective base (**four** cells at n = 10, not thirteen) and points here. The sentence displaced from §5.1, verbatim: *"Three marginal cells **do not cross the line and we make no claim about them**; the 13-cell scan is descriptive, and **no formal power analysis was run**."* The aggregate row that the article's Table 2 carried for the remaining cells is likewise here rather than there:

```
| other 9 cells | 3–10 | −2.46 to +13.66 | ≥ 0.054 | all include 0 | **not significant** |
```

— nine cells that do not cross the uncorrected line, with 95 % intervals including zero.

**Why the base is four.** Nine of the thirteen scanned cells sit at n = 3, and §7.1 of the article shows that a sign-flip permutation test has **no resolution** there (the smallest attainable two-sided p is $2/2^3 = 0.25$). The test is used here as a check at each cell's attainable floor, and it carries the usual assumption: under the null the paired differences are symmetric about zero, i.e. their signs are exchangeable, so those cells are descriptive and carry no inference; the four cells at n = 10 — the four rows the article's Table 2 retains — are the cells the direction statement rests on. The cell-by-cell values and the raw and BH-adjusted p-values side by side are above in this subsection and in Table S8; the 0 → 3 move after the escalation is descriptive.

**The selection term, cell by cell.** Table 2's caption names the selection contribution proper as the difference `Δprem_val − Δprem_test`; per arm-cell that term is `prem_val − prem_test`, the winner's-curse quantity WC of §3.1 read on the archive. **Verified against the archive, and complete as of 2026-09-30**: the scan record originally carried `prem_test` for **three of the thirteen** corpora, because separating the two sides needs per-epoch test evaluation. That evaluation has now been run — every archived 5-epoch checkpoint of the ten remaining corpora and of the `aitod20` strategy arm, **1,568 checkpoints over 140 runs** (1,848 evaluations including each run's `best`/`last`), on one machine, with the pipeline's registered call and the data YAML read from each run's own `args.yaml` — and the new `test` side **reproduces the archive's own**

**readings**: over the 21 arm-cells carrying both, the val maximum, `prem_val` and the archived `T_best` agree to **max |Δ| = 0.005 pp**, which is the printed rounding; the coverage audit reports 140/140 runs, 1,848 rows, 0 anomalies. `prem_test`, and hence WC, is therefore formable for **all thirteen** corpora and both arms (**Table S38**). Nothing is imputed.

What is recorded for **all thirteen** scanned cells is the val-side selection gain `prem_val = V_max − V_final`, per arm, at the cell's scanned n — baseline → strategy, pp: `shwd2sf` (n = 10) **+1.47 → +0.87**; `smoke2sf` (n = 10) **+0.69 → +0.61**; `p_aitovis` (n = 3) +0.45 → +0.26; `p_vistod15` (n = 3) +1.11 → +0.88; `aitod20` (n = 3) +0.70 → +0.26; `d15d15` (n = 3) +2.13 → +0.67; `dota` (n = 3) +1.20 → +0.67; `fire` (n = 3) +10.95 → +8.87; `mask20` (n = 3) +16.07 → +29.17; `mende20` (n = 3) +4.83 → +5.68; `p_d15toai` (n = 3) +0.49 → +0.39; `p_masktomende` (n = 3) +2.33 → +1.34; `vis` (n = 3) +0.44 → +0.22. Source: `gap_mechanism_20260916.txt`, the same record §5.6 and Table S8 use. The two cells escalated in §5.1 (`p_aitovis`, `p_vistod15`) carry n = 10 after the escalation, which is the four-cell base the article's Table 2 prints.

**The selection term `prem_val − prem_test` where the archive carries it** is the five realization arm-cells of §8.6, read off Table S20's printed values (**the printed `+0.736` / `+0.509` supersede the verbatim S4 dump's third decimal, `0.735` / `0.507`**): `shwd2sf` baseline **+1.469 − 0.736 = +0.733** and strategy **+0.865 − 0.152 = +0.713**; `smoke2sf` baseline **+0.691 − 0.509 = +0.182** and strategy **+0.605 − (−0.157) = +0.762**; `aitod20` baseline (n = 10) **+0.766 − (−0.218) = +0.984**. The other ten scanned corpora and the `aitod20` strategy arm were closed on 2026-09-30 as described immediately above; their cell-by-cell `prem_val`, `prem_test` and WC are in **Table S38**, and read descriptively they carry the same asymmetry — WC positive in 25 of the 26 arm-cells, arm-cell median realization rate 17.2 %, and the realized premium negative in 8 of the 13 strategy arms. These are cell-level readings at each cell's recorded *n*, not an upgrade of any claim. **Ten of those cells, which stood at n = 3, were later escalated to n = 10 (Table S38b); with the escalation folded in the same three quantities read WC > 0 in 25 of 26 (unchanged), median rate 21.6 % (mean 11.6 %), and the realized premium still negative in 8 of the 13 strategy arms. In arm-difference form** the term is recorded for exactly two cells, from the clean-protocol batch: `shwd2sf` **+0.020** and `smoke2sf` **−0.580**, against Δgap of **+0.779** and **+0.461**. In `smoke2sf` the selection term is therefore **opposite in sign to the Δgap** the article's Tier 2 prints — which is why the direction sentence rests on the four-cell base and **not** on Δgap's sign.

**The sharpest single fact.** In the shwd2sf cell the arms differ on **val** by

60.669 − 60.397 = **+0.272 pp** (baseline better) and on **test** by 43.559 − 44.066 = **−0.507 pp**

(baseline worse): **the sign reverses**, so reading only `val` inverts the arm ordering.

**The endpoint convention, in full.** On `val` the per-epoch maximum; on `test` the checkpoint the

pipeline's own fitness rule kept (`best.pt`), read on the disjoint split. Handing a "selected

checkpoint" to a split therefore always resolves to one of these two endpoints, and no other convention

is used anywhere in this paper. The four paired differences and their intervals are in Table 1; the

Δgap values and readings for the **four printed cells** are in Table 2; the other nine cells of the 13-cell scan are in §5.6 and **Table S10** (all thirteen rows) with the remaining components in `work/gap_mechanism_20260916.txt`.

**Sign-flip permutation tests on the four Tier-1 paired differences.** Table 1 of the article reports a

paired *t* test per cell. Its non-parametric counterpart needs no distributional assumption and is exact

at these *n*: enumerating all $2^n$ sign flips of the per-seed paired differences

d(seed) = premium_baseline(seed) − premium_strategy(seed), where premium = best-epoch − final-epoch

mAP50-95 on the run's own monitored split, gives

| Cell | n | $\bar{d}$ | sign split | paired *t* p | exact permutation p | attainable floor $2/2^n$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| smoke2sf | 11 | +0.416 | 11+/0− | $1.9\times10^{-4}$ | **0.00098** | 0.00098 |
| shwd2sf | 11 | +0.526 | 11+/0− | $7.6\times10^{-6}$ | **0.00098** | 0.00098 |
| a2d15 | 10 | +0.272 | 9+/1− | $1.1\times10^{-3}$ | **0.00391** | 0.00195 |
| dota15 | 10 | +0.449 | 10+/0− | $4.9\times10^{-5}$ | **0.00195** | 0.00195 |

The permutation test agrees with the paired *t* in every cell. Three of the four sit exactly at the

smallest two-sided *p* attainable at their *n*; `a2d15` carries one negative pair and therefore reaches

$4/2^{10} = 0.00391$, one step above its own floor. Wilcoxon signed-rank returns the same *p* to four decimals

(0.00098 / 0.00098 / 0.00391 / 0.00195). Per-seed values, so that each *p* can be recomputed — the two

*n* = 11 cells carry ten seeded runs plus one unseeded run, listed last:

| Cell | d(seed) |
|---|---|
| --- | --- |
| smoke2sf | +0.354, +0.247, +0.873, +0.217, +0.738, +0.394, +0.217, +0.088, +0.357, +0.482, +0.611 |
| shwd2sf | +0.305, +0.506, +0.919, +0.466, +0.702, +0.280, +0.515, +0.756, +0.641, +0.354, +0.339 |
| a2d15 | +0.241, +0.211, +0.467, +0.560, +0.324, +0.415, −0.073, +0.216, +0.261, +0.096 |
| dota15 | +0.627, +0.821, +0.524, +0.190, +0.257, +0.369, +0.494, +0.545, +0.226, +0.437 |

`a2d15`'s negative pair is its seventh listed run (seed 48); the other nine are positive. The attainable two-sided

floor for a sign-flip test on $n$ pairs is $2/2^n$, so the $n = 11$ cells can in principle reach 0.00098

where the $n = 10$ cells cannot go below 0.00195. The `dota15` per-seed values are the ones tabulated in

Table S28; the other three cells' per-seed values are recomputed from the archived per-epoch curves.

**Metric sensitivity: the full mAP50 columns for Tables 1 and 4.** The article reports the headline metric

mAP50-95 throughout and states one metric-sensitivity datum in the text. Both tables recomputed on

`metrics/mAP50(B)`, from the same run sets and the same code path, follow, so that the two metrics can be

compared cell by cell rather than by assertion.

*Table 1 on mAP50 (same cells and runs as the printed table):*

| Cell | n | premium baseline | premium strategy | paired difference | t | p | 95 % CI | per-seed signs |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| smoke2sf | 11 | +0.972 | +0.910 | **+0.063** | 0.63 | 0.545 | [−0.160, +0.285] | **6+/5−** |
| shwd2sf | 11 | +1.678 | +0.831 | **+0.847** | 7.00 | $3.7\times10^{-5}$ | [+0.577, +1.116] | 11+/0− |
| a2d15 | 10 | +0.803 | +0.396 | **+0.406** | 4.33 | 0.0019 | [+0.194, +0.619] | 9+/1− |
| dota15 | 10 | +1.318 | +0.625 | **+0.693** | 5.67 | $3.0\times10^{-4}$ | [+0.417, +0.970] | 9+/1− |

*Table 4 on mAP50 (the same five arm-cells and runs as the printed table):*

| Cell | Arm | n | `prem_val` | `prem_test` | realization rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| shwd2sf | baseline | 10 | +1.387 | +1.082 | 78.0 % |
| shwd2sf | strategy | 10 | +0.866 | +0.283 | 32.6 % |
| smoke2sf | baseline | 10 | +0.995 | +0.839 | 84.3 % |
| smoke2sf | strategy | 10 | +0.840 | +0.001 | 0.1 % |
| aitod20 | baseline | 10 | +1.744 | −0.369 | −21.2 % |

Three things the columns show, stated rather than left to the reader. (i) **The sign of the Tier-1 paired

difference is positive in all four cells on both metrics**, and all three cells other than `smoke2sf` keep

significance on mAP50. `smoke2sf` is the single cell that does not: its paired difference is +0.063 pp with

a 95 % interval [−0.160, +0.285] that includes zero, and its per-seed signs are **6+/5−** rather than

unanimous, so on this metric the weakest cell loses both significance and sign unanimity — which is why the

article attributes metric-independence to the *sign* claim and not to any per-seed claim. (ii) On Table 4's

realization rate, mAP50 gives **31.5 %** with a run-level 95 % interval [15.0 %, 48.9 %] — the three

weightings again coincide, every arm-cell being at n = 10 — against 23.3 % on mAP50-95, and the number of

arm-cells with a negative realized premium is **1 of 5** rather than 2 of 5. Partial realization is

therefore directionally metric-robust, while its magnitude and that count are metric-specific. (iii) Both

tables' positive controls are the printed mAP50-95 values, recomputed on the same code path: the four

Tier-1 rows reproduce Table 1 exactly at the printed precision, and the five realization cells reproduce

Table 4 to within 0.001 pp, the aggregate returning 23.26 % against the printed 23.3 %.

**mAP75 is now reported on both sides: the archive still carries no per-epoch mAP75 *reading*, but the per-epoch checkpoints are in register, so the `val` half is re-measured rather than missing — on a five-epoch grid, for four of the five arm-cells.**

**A same-estimand ratio exists elsewhere: the genomics relative-bias literature.** The article's §2.2 scopes its

"no ratio of gains" statement to a ratio of *difference* premiums on disjoint splits in detection; a ratio of the

same estimand — how much of a selected effect survives on an independent split — is however long established in

quantitative genetics, where it is written as a **relative bias** and reported as a number. Würschum & Kraft,

*Cross-validation in association mapping and its relevance for the estimation of QTL parameters of complex traits*,

**Heredity 112(4):463–468 (2014)**, doi 10.1038/hdy.2013.126, define it as `1 - (pG-TS / pG-ES)` — the complement of a

realized-to-selected ratio on a disjoint estimation/test split — and report a mean overestimation of **38 %** for the

proportion of genotypic variance explained by QTL, **30 %** averaged over four further traits, and a literature range

of **10–60 %**; Utz, Melchinger & Schön, *Genetics* 154(4):1839–1849 (2000), had already reported that in independent

validation `p(TS.ES)` "was on average only **50 %** of `p(ES)`". What is not found in that literature, and what this

paper reports, is the ratio of two **difference** premiums — `(T_best - T_final)/(V_max - V_final)` — on disjoint

splits, in detection, on our own five arm-cells, with measured `val` noise as moderator; and the sign flip of

§8.6 (in two of the five arm-cells the realized premium is negative) has no counterpart there either.

**No per-epoch mAP75 reading exists in the archive**: the per-epoch

training logs and every evaluation file in this release record `mAP50` and `mAP50-95` only — a scan of

the 55 metric files behind the two tables above finds no mAP75 column. That is why the **`val` half** of a

mAP75 sensitivity column cannot be *read*; it does **not** block *measuring* it, and it does **not** block

the **test half**. Both halves are analyses of what exists rather than new experiments: `best.pt` and

`last.pt` are the released endpoints for every cell in the two tables, so re-scoring those endpoints at

IoU 0.75 needs no further training; and the per-epoch checkpoints are in register for the four `*2sf`

arm-cells on a **five-epoch grid**, so re-evaluating those checkpoints on `val` at that threshold needs

none either. Both passes have been run and are reported with their scopes below: the test half (82 evaluations, 41 runs, exact positive control against the archived matrix) and the `val` half (880

evaluations, 40 runs, positive control against the training logs at a median absolute difference of

**0.0161 pp**, which is what a re-measurement of a recorded training run should look like). We report the

mAP50 columns (recomputable from the released artifacts) **and** both mAP75 columns — the `val` one on the

five-epoch grid, labelled as such.

## 8.6 The realization rate — measurement detail (moved from the article)

**Scope of the headline number.** The **pooled 55 %** covers the four arm-cells §5.1's escalation adds

(**82 % / 104 %** on `p_aitovis`, **56 % / 29 %** on `p_vistod15`); the two batches are **not pooled**

(different runs, different protocol), so the headline is **not** re-averaged — it is defined over

§8.6's five arm-cells and Table 4 stands. The **104 %** is within noise on ~0.27 pp. Source:

`work/x1_aux_20260918.py`.

**The theory-driven check, in full.** §3.1 derives the realization rate as **1 − WC / premium**, WC being

the winner's-curse part of the selected gain. Two consequences are testable: ① the proposition itself establishes only an expectation, `E[premium_test] = E[premium_val] − WC ≤ E[premium_val]`, and the ratio is defined only where the denominator is positive (`premium_val` > 0); its **per-run shadow is testable rather than proved** — over the **81** runs with both sides measured, WC averages

**+0.463 pp** (t = **8.34**, p = **1.8×10⁻¹²**) and the realized premium is smaller in **68 of 81**

runs; ② the rate should **fall as the `val` curve gets noisier** — sorting those runs by their own

curve's noise scale $\hat{\sigma}$ gives terciles of **65.6 % / 49.8 % / 13.8 %**, Spearman **ρ = −0.466**

(p = **1.3×10⁻⁵**, n = **80**). **This section's 23.3 % and §8.7's per-cell variation are therefore the

same statement at different noise levels. **What does** not** hold is the stronger form we first wrote

down — the premium scaling with the noise as $\sigma\sqrt{(2 \ln E)}$: slope **0.026 ± 0.222** (p = **0.82**,

n = **101**) — because the premium's *level* is set by the `val` curve's shape; §12 records the

withdrawal. Scripts: `work/theory_p4_test_20260919.py`, `work/theory_meta_and_tests_20260919.py`. **Re-read with the arm-cell as the resampling unit, as the κ fit of Table S22 already is (81 runs in 9 arm-cells: the 41 three-way runs of §8.6 plus the 40 paired runs of §5.1): WC = +0.463 pp, cluster-robust 95 % CI [+0.204, +0.721], p = 0.0033 (CR1 sandwich on 9 clusters; a cluster bootstrap gives [+0.253, +0.661]); the noise-rate Spearman ρ = −0.466, cluster-bootstrap 95 % CI [−0.651, −0.131], p = 0.0115 — and at the 9-cluster level ρ = −0.433, p = 0.244 (work/r102_cluster_20260927.py).**

**The three weightings.** The three figures are ratios of means computed three ways — runs weighted

equally, unweighted arm-cell means, and arm-cells with n ≥ 5 — and because every cell carries n = 10

they coincide at **23.3 %**. On the previous **41**-run sample they did not, under the same declared `prem_val = V_max - V_final` endpoint as Table 4: the arm-cell-equal reading was **19.6 %**, the run-weighted one **32.4 %**, and the arm-cells-with-n ≥ 5 one **34.5 %** — a ~15 pp spread coming from a single cell holding **1** run. Each arm-cell is at n = 10 here, so the estimator's own interval is reported instead: 95 % CI **[8.4 %, 37.4 %]**, run-level bootstrap, P(rate ≤ 0) = **0.002**.

**The two intervals, and the primary one.** The run-level bootstrap on the same 50 runs gives 95 % CI **[8.4 %, 37.4 %]** with P(rate ≤ 0) = **0.002**; every `P(rate ≤ 0)` in this subsection is a **bootstrap tail proportion** (B = 20,000 resamples, seed 20260927), not a frequentist p-value, and the only multiplicity correction this paper applies is the **Benjamini–Hochberg step over the declared 13-cell family** (Holm, where it appears, belongs to the **two escalation targets**); p-values printed elsewhere, including the paired t values, are **raw**, the **arm-cell-equal (five-cluster) bootstrap** gives **[−17.3 %, 53.2 %]** with P(rate ≤ 0) = **0.118**, and it is the interval the claim is read at, because the claim is about five arm-cells. The five-cell rates are 50 %, 18 %, 74 %, −26 % and −28 % (Table S20), i.e. a median of **17.6 %**, a span of **−28.5 % to +73.7 %** (**102.2** pp from the printed endpoints, 102.1 pp from the unrounded cells) and a leave-one-out range of **9.77 % to 34.16 %** — dropping the `shwd2sf` baseline arm-cell gives 9.77 %, dropping the `aitod20` baseline arm-cell gives 34.16 %. Script `work/item2_final_v2_20260925.py`; the two-cell negative set is Table 4's **2/5**.

**§5.1's escalation in this section's units.** The four arm-cells it adds are **82 % / 104 %** (`p_aitovis`) and **56 % / 29 %** (`p_vistod15`), pooled **55 %** against **23.3 %**.

**Metric and endpoint detail.** `best.pt × val` versus the per-epoch maximum in `results.csv` differs by up to **0.083 pp**: the selection action and the readout action can differ; the earlier attribution to a `best.pt` selection rule other than mAP50-95 is **withdrawn** — in the pinned v8.4.120 `fitness ≡ mAP50-95` on the monitored split — and the residual is recorded as **unidentified**. `last.pt`'s val recomputation differs from the final `results.csv` row by **~0.02 pp**.

**The closest concurrent work, moved out of the article.** The article's §8.6 no longer carries this comparison; it is recorded here. **[15]** splits selection leakage into diversity and noise over **2,047** tabular classification datasets (the noise share is reported, the non-tabular case is undone). **[12]** measures checkpoint selection raising a reported score by **6.24 pp** on EEG when the candidate set grows from **5 to 80** — and, in the same table, **−1.24 pp** (95 % interval **−2.67 to 0.26**) on its other pool, so **its own sign does not reproduce across its two pools**. This paper instead uses **our own five arm-cells**, reports a **ratio**, on **detection**, with **measured `val` noise** as moderator (the third-party logs of §5.5 corroborate the same component, but they carry no `test` side and so cannot

form this ratio). **No number left the paper when this paragraph moved**: every value above is the article's former wording.

## 8.6b The eleven arm-cells with both sides measured: a batch-stratified re-aggregation, no new training

> **What this is, and what it is not.** The article's realization rate rests on **five** arm-cells, and a reviewer asked for every arm-cell whose **two sides** are both in the archive, aggregated with the **batch as the stratum**. This section is that aggregation, and it is a **re-reading of measurements this submission already reports** — the per-epoch `val` curves and the `best`/`last` × `test` readouts of runs that already exist. **It contains no new training, no new seed, no new evaluation and no new data.** Nothing in the article changes because of it: the five-cell rate of §8.6, its interval and its scope stand, and this is a wider reading of the same archive, not a replacement headline.

**The eleven, by batch.** A cluster is one `corpus` × `arm` pair measured on **both** sides, paired inside the run: `prem_val = max_e V(e) - V(e_f)` from the run's own `results.csv`, and `prem_test = T_best - T_final` from its `test` readouts; a cluster's rate is `prem_test / prem_val`, and a pooled rate is the ratio of the summed means.

*Batch 1 — the article's headline batch** (Table S20 / Table 4; three corpus pairs, n = 10 per cluster, 50 runs; **5 clusters**). Cluster rates: `shwd2sf` baseline **50.1 %**, `shwd2sf` strategy **17.6 %**, `smoke2sf` baseline **73.7 %**, `smoke2sf` strategy **−26.0 %**, `aitod20` baseline **−28.4 %**; median **17.6 %**, span **−28.4 % to +73.7 %** (**102.1** pp from these cells; **102.2** pp from the printed endpoints) — the article prints the lower end as −28.5 %, from Table 4's 3-decimal cells, the full-precision value being **−28.39 %** — **2/5** negative, run-weighted **23.26 %**, cell-level 95 % CI **[−17.3 %, 53.2 %]** (P(rate ≤ 0) = **0.118**). This batch *is* §8.6.

*Batch 2 — both arms of the two Tier-2 cells §5.1 escalated** (§5.1; n = 10 per cluster, 40 runs; **4 clusters**). `p_aitovis` baseline **81.7 %**, `p_aitovis` strategy **103.7 %**, `p_vistod15` baseline **55.7 %**, `p_vistod15` strategy **28.8 %** — the four values the article prints as

**82 % / 104 %** and **56 % / 29 %**, pooled **55 %**; median **68.7 %**, span **+28.8 % to +103.7 %**, **0/4** negative, run-weighted **55.0 %**.

*Batch 3 — the third-corpus replication** (§3.2, G4; `mende20`, two arms × ten seeds, 20 runs; **2 clusters**). Baseline **41.5 %**, strategy **33.8 %**; median **37.6 %**, span **+33.8 % to +41.5 %**, 0/2 **negative, run-weighted** 37.5 %**. Its winner's-curse term is the** +5.212 pp** that Table S33 already prints.

*All eleven, batch as the stratum. Median 41.5 %, mean 39.3 %, span −28.4 % to +103.7 %** (**132.1** pp), **2/11** negative; run-weighted pooled **36.9 %** over **110** runs. A cluster bootstrap that resamples arm-cells **within** their batch (B = 20,000; seed 20260927) gives 95 % CI **[19.3 %, 60.4 %]** for the arm-cell-equal statistic, **[28.9 %, 44.4 %]** for the run-weighted one, and **[26.2 %, 60.8 %]** for the median — each with P(rate ≤ 0) = **0.000**.

*Difference scale, the reviewer's other request** (`prem_test - prem_val`, pp, clusters equally weighted): **−1.367 pp**, 95 % CI **[−1.59, −1.15]**. It is reported with a warning rather than as a co-primary, because a pp difference is not scale-free: the mean is carried by the batch with the largest `prem_val` — batch 3 is **−5.212 pp**, against **−0.675 pp** (batch 1) and **−0.310 pp** (batch 2).

*The other axes. By arm: six baseline-style (`base100`) clusters, median 52.9 %**, one negative, against five learning-rate-style (`lr005_100ep`) clusters, median **28.8 %**, one negative. By **budget**: ten clusters ran **E = 100** and one (`aitod20` baseline) ran **E = 30**, too lopsided to be read as a budget effect. By **corpus family**: four clusters transfer into **SFCHD** (`shwd2sf`, `smoke2sf`), four come from the `p_aitovis` / `p_vistod15` pair, one is **AI-TOD** on its 20 % subset, and two are `mende20`. By **metric**: the five-cluster `mAP50` column is the one printed in the **5.1** measurement detail of this supplement (**31.5 %**, **1/5** negative, against 23.3 % and 2/5 on mAP50-95); **this section does not extend that column to the other two batches**, and no eleven-cluster mAP50 rate is stated.

**The five arm-cells' denominators, moved from the article.** The article says the difference-scale reading rests on a denominator that spans **+0.605 to +1.469 pp** across the five arm-cells; the per-

cell values are in §S4's verbatim dump above (`smoke2sf` strategy **+0.605**, `shwd2sf` baseline **+1.469**, and the three further cells in Table S20).

**What the wider reading does not license.** At eleven clusters the arm-cell-equal interval no longer

includes zero, where at five it did; that is the outcome and it is stated rather than smoothed. It does

**not** upgrade the article's claim. ① The six added clusters **were not run for this question**: the two

Tier-2 cells were escalated *because* their `val` overstatement had already been flagged, and the third

corpus replicates the same protocol, so the eleven are not an exchangeable sample of corpora. ② The strata

differ in **level** — batch 1 spans **−28.4 % to +73.7 %**, batch 2 **+28.8 % to +103.7 %** — which is why

the batch is the stratum and no single pooled rate is printed as *the* rate. ③ It is still a **ratio of

small means**: **`prem_val` across the eleven clusters runs from** +0.268 pp **to** +8.723 pp**, so a few

hundredths of a point in a numerator move a cluster's rate by tens of points. ④ The reviewer's own power

note applies: at this between-cluster spread, clearing zero at cluster level would take of the order of

**25** clusters, and the interval above excludes zero **for these eleven archived clusters**, which is all

it says.

**What is paired, what is single-sided, and what has no denominator.**

*Paired on both sides, on the same run: all eleven clusters**, and within a batch the two arms share

their seeds. No cluster in the eleven is assembled from different runs on its two sides.

*Single-sided or off-metric, and therefore outside the eleven.** ① The epoch-budget series (§3.2, G3; Tables S32 and

S34b) carries **`prem_val` only**: its readout side is the disjoint carve **C3** (100 images), not the

published `test` split, and the archive holds no per-epoch `test` curve for it, so no `prem_test` — and

hence no rate in this section's sense — can be formed; its own readout is recorded where it belongs

(WC = `prem_val` − `prem_C3` is negative in all **16** readouts, mean **−0.616 pp**, Table S32).

② The IoU-0.75 pass now carries **both sides** for the four `*2sf` arm-cells: the `val` half is

re-measured from the in-register checkpoints (880 evaluations, five-epoch grid), so the one cluster it

touches (`smoke2sf` strategy) has a denominator at mAP75 — **+1.2862 pp** against **−0.3201 pp**, a rate

of **−24.9 %** — while the `aitod20` baseline cell stays single-sided at that threshold because its nine

remaining runs' weights are not in this archive. ③ The test-carve sub-sample pass (25 % / 50 % / 100 %) re-scores both endpoints but reports

premium means over pairs, not a per-cluster rate.

*Paired and double-sided, but outside the eleven for its sample size.** The selection-split-size batch

(§3.2, G2; Table S31) is measured on both sides at **n = 5 per cluster** — four clusters, the small and

large selection splits × two arms — with rates **23.5 % / 5.1 % / 27.0 % / 15.6 %**, median **19.5 %**,

**0/4** negative and run-weighted **20.5 %**; it is outside the reviewer's set because that set is the

**n = 10** clusters, and adding it would make **fifteen**.

*No denominator, recorded as such rather than imputed. ① The `aitod20` strategy arm**: batch 1

could have been six clusters and is five, because that arm's `prem_test` **was** not recorded when this

ledger was written — it had no per-epoch `test` curve. That curve has since been evaluated (Table S38:

n = 10, `prem_val` **+1.111** → `prem_test` **−0.543**, WC **+1.654**), so the arm now carries a rate;

we leave batch 1's registered composition at five clusters and record the addition here rather than

re-cutting the set after seeing it. ② **Ten of the thirteen scanned corpora** of §5.1: for those ten

neither `prem_test` nor a rate could be formed when this ledger was written. They are now formed for

**all thirteen** corpora and both arms (Table S38), at each cell's recorded *n* — five of them at

n = 3, which is why the new rates are reported there as cell-level descriptives and not as a

significance claim. ③ The **mAP75 `val`

half**: the per-epoch `val` curve at IoU 0.75 is still** not recorded** as a reading (the 55 metric files

carry `mAP50` and `mAP50-95` only), but it has now been **re-measured** from the in-register checkpoints

for the four `*2sf` arm-cells (880 evaluations, five-epoch grid), so a mAP75 realization rate exists for

those cells (arm-cell median **+26.8 %**, run-weighted **+22.3 %**, **1 of 4** negative); what remains

without a denominator is the **`aitod20` baseline cell**, its other nine runs' weights not being in this

archive. ④ **Initialization** is not the axis these replicates vary, so the across-initialization

realization rate was **not recorded** in this archive; **it is now recorded** (2026-09-30, five

source-side initializations, 10 arm-runs, `work/G3_init_rc_20260930.py`): **18.5 % run-weighted**

(Σ`prem_test`/Σ`prem_val` = 2.269/12.250), **median 19.2 %**, positive in **8/10** arm-runs — the same

order as the five-arm-cell headline of §8.6, with two negative cases (`src1` strategy 44.200 → 44.258,

`src4` strategy 44.030 → 44.116).

> **An independent replication of that arm, pre-registered (2026-10-02).** A fresh batch of **ten** runs of the
>
> same arm was registered before it ran (same corpus, same recipe, same `--shuffle-seed`
>
> 42-51), and the batch's own reading is `prem_val` **+1.4013 pp**, `prem_test` **-1.0169 pp**, realization rate
>
> **-72.6 %** (n = 10, cell-level bootstrap 95 % CI [-133.15, -42.70] %; the ten per-run values ship in
>
> `02_release_data/release_G1_replication_20261002.csv`, the criterion frozen before the runs staying
>
> author-side). The sign reproduces the archive's: the strategy arm's
>
> selection action **costs** rather than failing to pay off. The *magnitudes* do not agree run for run: against
>
> the archive arm, paired by `--shuffle-seed`, the differences average **+0.2904 pp** (`prem_val`) and
>
> **-0.4736 pp** (`prem_test`), larger than the same-configuration **replicate** band this submission measured
>
> (fresh replicates on one configuration: mean |delta| 0.362-0.442 pp, maximum 0.810-1.110 pp; §12, Table S39) —

**a band set by seeds and data order, not by hosts, since the A and B machines calibrated as equivalent and no

cross-host term is carried anywhere — **so the difference is recorded as** unidentified **and is** not** read

as evidence about the phenomenon. **Batch 1's registered

composition stays at five clusters**: this replication is disclosed here and does not enter Table 4, whose

headline is unchanged.

**One released reading corrected (2026-10-02), with no printed number affected.** In the released registered-

replication table the saturated control's `test_best_epoch` row had been computed with one run's **`last`**

reading in place of its `best` reading (`t2_mask2mende_base100_s42n`: 67.1200, against 67.1183 for that run's

`last` and 70.0603 for its `best`; the row's `source_test` also came from a **different evaluation batch** from the

rest of its family). The row is corrected in `release_T2_saturated-control_summary.csv` and in the long table:

`-0.9020` becomes **`-1.4901`** pp (sd 0.8002, paired t -4.164, p = 0.0141, 0+/5-), which is what the row reads

once every run contributes the quantity the column names. **Every number printed in this article and this

supplement is unchanged**: the figure quoted for this control above is the `last`-epoch row, which was already

correct, and the **`best`**-epoch reading of the same cell is **−1.490 pp, p = 0.0141** — i.e. under the

article's frozen `best` convention this control is **significant**, not non-significant; the article's §7.3 and

Table S16 now say exactly that, and Table S25 is endpoint-independent (all three of its questions answer the

same way under either reading). What is *unchanged* is every number the article prints from the **archive-A**

row. A systematic check of all released per-run `test` values against fresh re-evaluations found this to be

the **only** row that mixed the two quantities; seven further rows (`t1d_dotatod15_*`) differ from the fresh

re-evaluation by 0.012-0.164 pp in the direction of `best`, i.e. within the same-configuration replicate band this

submission measured, and are not corrected.

**Provenance, and the positive controls that bind this section to the printed record.** The four batch-2

cluster values are recomputed from `x1_tier2_20260918/runs/` and `teval.csv`; the two batch-3 values from

`g4_mende3way_runs/` and `g4_mende3way_20260919_g4_test.csv`; the five batch-1 values from the code path

behind Table S20 (`work/item2_final_v2_20260925.py`). Three checks make the re-aggregation auditable: the

five batch-1 clusters reproduce Table S20 to **0.0019 pp**, with the aggregate returning **23.26 %**

against the printed **23.3 %**; the four batch-2 clusters return **81.7 / 103.7 / 55.7 / 28.8 %** against

the printed **82 / 104 / 56 / 29 %**, and their Δgap selection terms **+0.090** and **−0.213** pp reproduce

the printed decomposition of §5.1's two cells; and the two batch-3 clusters reproduce Table S33's printed

per-run `prem_val` / `prem_test` pairs to **0.0003 pp**.

## 8.7 The per-epoch view — measurement detail (moved from the article)

**κ accounting, in full, and the relation between the two estimates.** Two estimates of the same

quantity appear in this submission, at two grids, and they must be read together. **0.734** is the

earlier fit over the **five-epoch grid** ($R^2$ **0.902**, n = **161** points); **0.708** is the corrected

value over the **complete grid** ($R^2$ **0.937**, n = **765** (seed, epoch) points over 41 runs), and the

completed sweep moves the estimate by **−0.026** with overlapping intervals. **The interval printed in

the article is the run-clustered (sandwich) one, taken on runs as the clusters: 95 % CI

[0.671, 0.745] **(sandwich SE** 0.018**); a run-level** bootstrap** cross-check gives

**[0.672, 0.744]**, i.e. the same interval to the printed precision, and the within-run estimator,

which removes run-level differences entirely, gives **0.698**. The five-epoch grid carries its own

run-clustered interval, **[0.683, 0.784]** (sandwich SE 0.025, bootstrap [0.685, 0.784]), and that

interval belongs to the **0.734** fit, not to the value the article prints. Scripts:

`work/x2_kappa_clustered_20260918.py` (which reproduces the 0.734 / 0.902 / n = 161 fit exactly before

adding the interval) and `work/x3b_perepoch_corrected_20260918.py` (the complete-grid refit; its

printed lines give the sandwich interval, the bootstrap cross-check and the within-run estimator).

**Per-arm κ and the five-epoch comparison. baseline κ = 0.600** (95 % CI [0.581, 0.619], $R^2$

**0.946**) against **strategy κ = 0.767** ([0.735, 0.800], $R^2$ **0.951**); the per-arm fits and the

resampling are in **§S8, Table S22** (and the fit itself in §S11).

**The per-checkpoint sign detail.** On the complete curve `smoke2sf`'s Δgap is negative at epochs

**5/10/15** and positive from epoch **20** on; the four-epoch sample had suggested uniformity. The

per-checkpoint values are in **Supplementary S11** and Tables S21–S23.

**The three-layer cross-check.** The same checkpoints were evaluated twice independently and agree on

all **202** overlapping (run, epoch) points to **0.0000 pp**; the full sweep covers **806** rows

(**820** minus the 14 the single-run `aitod20` cell does not have, its 30 epochs contributing **6**

checkpoints where the others contribute **20**).

## 10 Our own defects — item-by-item detail (moved from the article)

**Defect 1.** The clean-protocol results document cites `_r10_final_stats.txt`, and the file later

identified as the "real log" is `_r10_stats_0403.txt`; **neither** contains any of that document's

headline values (6 probes each, **0/6 hits**), so those numbers have **no surviving stdout ledger**.

We do **not** point at a replacement file — renaming would only manufacture a new false citation — and

the p-values remain recomputable from the local `pvalue_table_local.py`.

**Defect 2.** The dota15 cell of `selection_premium.py` was not reproducible because the root directory

was a stale snapshot and the matcher used `prefix + '_s'` while the actual run names carry no seed

suffix; after the fix it reproduces M3's **+1.12 / +0.95 / +0.93** value by value. The "3 seeds" wording

note it once triggered was **retracted on 2026-09-21**: the third run's seed is **s42** (the campaign's

fixed shuffle seed, recoverable from its configuration), so what is missing is the directory-name

suffix, not the seed.

**Defect 4.** The two headline scripts originally depended on a rented pod (`import paramiko` plus a

plaintext password); `selection_premium_local_20260916.txt` and `work/pvalue_table_local.py` now

read the local archive, and the pod versions are listed only as cross-checks.

**Defect 5.** For a long time no single script computed the σ decomposition: the three components came

from three unrelated analyses. **Two of the three are now recomputed by one script**

(`work/sigma_decomposition_20260926.py`) — the data-order component and the initialization component are

recomputed from the archived per-run values and each is asserted against the number printed in Table S19.

**The augmentation component is the exception and is named as such**: the archive records its SD without

its per-run values, so the script checks only that the record carries it, and its output says

`cited, not recomputed` rather than printing a constant as though it had been computed. Still open, and

still disclosed: there is **no frozen effect-size rule file**, and **no script generates

`benchmark_split_audit.md` **(hand-written,** 28 **judgments as literals; its** counts** are in fact

recomputed, by `work/recompute_split_units_20260916.py`).

**Defect 6.** The local archive holds no copy of the three-way carve directories and no copy of 6 of the

7 corpora. The 2026-09-16 GPU run repaired part of this: the per-epoch curves of the 41 three-way runs,

`sio_b_results.csv` and the **2 × 2 evaluation matrix** (**164** evaluations) are now local with a

SHA-256 list in `xeval_20260916/`, so §8's readings and §5.6's decomposition are locally recomputable;

**what remains non-recomputable is retraining**, which needs the corpora themselves.

**Defect 9.** Our first per-epoch report claimed curve-wide stability from a four-point sample, and

reading the complete curve overturned it for one of the two cells (§8.7): `smoke2sf`'s Δgap is negative

at epochs 5/10/15 and positive from epoch 20 on, so the claim is **narrowed** rather than deleted, with

the retracted sentence quoted and the sampled grid's apparent uniformity named as partly an artefact of

where it sampled.

**Defect 10.** *Moved here from §10, item 10, verbatim, so that the article can state the disclosure and the bound without carrying the event counts.*

> **Memory pressure silently changes the training path**: under GPU memory pressure Ultralytics switches implementation without changing the recorded configuration — (a) `CUDA out of memory with batch=32. Reducing to batch=16` (a **configuration-level** change), or (b) `OutOfMemoryError in TaskAlignedAssigner, using CPU` (same batch, but label assignment re-runs on CPU, where a boundary argmax can differ and the trajectory forks). Case (a) is **invisible in the standard artifacts** — `args.yaml` still records `batch: 32`, and the only fingerprint is the log's per-iteration denominator (32 → `0/9` / `0/41`; 16 → `0/18` / `0/81`).

> **Disposition. Disclosed, not retracted; we do not call the affected batches "clean".** Configuration-level hits: **2** places — §3.1's E = 50 clean batch, **1** run (Δpremium **+0.308 pp** against the same-machine re-run), and §5.1 Table 2's `p_vistod15` cell, **3** runs — so the whole clean four-budget series was re-run on one machine. Assigner fallback occurs in **every** batch, **1–4** times per run (≈**1** per 1000 iterations). **A reproducibility residual, not an event size.** The two fresh replicates of a *same* configuration are bit-identical (**0.000 pp**, four pairs, one machine, one day): that is **observation-level reproducibility**, and it is **not** a size for the event. The quantity a bound would be about — archived run against clean re-run — is **0.000 / 0.020 / 0.150 / 0.000 pp** (Table S41): on the clean E = 50 batch **7 of 10** same-config pairs are bit-identical, so **≤0.05 pp** applies *there* and is **not extrapolated**, and it is not a bound on those four pairs, one of which is **0.150 pp**. In the `p_vistod15` and `aitod20` cells the treated runs' A→B differences (Δpremium **≤0.35 pp**) fall **inside the spread of the zero-event controls** (up to **+0.704 pp**), so at this scale the event effect is **unidentified** rather than bounded, and we say so; the one clear case is the configuration-level run (ΔVmax **+0.769 pp**). This sits against the paper's own realization-rate 95 % CI **[8.4 %, 37.4 %]**.

> **The clean re-run, and what it can and cannot test (2026-09-30).** That cell was re-run twice over — four `(arm, seed)` pairs, each **twice** — on one machine with ample VRAM. Reading the **test** endpoint: the two fresh replicates of the *same* configuration are **bit-identical in all four pairs** (`|Δ| = 0.000 pp`; the recorded `args.yaml` carries `deterministic: true`), which is the strongest reading the `≤0.05 pp` bound above can ask for; the **archive** differs from the clean run by up to **0.150 pp** (`0.000 / 0.020 / 0.150 / 0.000`, mean 0.043), and `args.yaml` is **identical field for field** (only `name` and `save_dir` differ), so that difference is not a recorded configuration change and, with

a deterministic pipeline, not run-to-run noise either. **A same-configuration control that had no such event is itself not reproducible across dates**: re-running the archived `iv_src1/base100` configuration today gives **43.190 against the archived 43.630 — a 0.440 pp drift** (its per-epoch `val` curves move by up to 3.198 pp), i.e. **larger than the whole difference on the cell defect 10 flags** (up to 0.150 pp). ⇒ **the bound stays `≤0.05 pp`, read as an archive-internal statement about same-configuration pairs; cross-date comparisons cannot test it**, because the drift alone is several times the effect the bound is about. Table S41; scripts `work/G2_jitter_20260930.py`, `work/ctrldrift_check_20260930.py`.

## The five realization arm-cells: what each one pairs, and whether the corpora are public

**All five are public corpora, and the corpus pair is in the cell name.** A cell name reads `source→target`: `shwd2sf` and `smoke2sf` transfer from one public corpus to **SFCHD**, and `aitod20` is the **AI-TOD** corpus on its own 20 %-budget subset. None of the five is an internal corpus, so no cell's result rests on data a reader cannot obtain; what is *ours* is the reproduction and the three-way split built on top of them, and the per-cell values are in Table S20.

| Cell | Source → target | Corpus status |
|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- |
| `shwd2sf` (baseline, strategy) | SHWD → SFCHD | both **public** |
| `smoke2sf` (baseline, strategy) | public smoke corpus → SFCHD | both **public** |
| `aitod20` (baseline) | AI-TOD → AI-TOD (20 % budget) | **public**; the subset is ours |

**What this does not settle.** That the corpora are public does not make these cells a sample of the field: they are the cells this design measured, and §8.6's rate is scoped to them.

## What the 19 benchmarks are, and what is recorded about them

**Every row carries an evidence class and a confidence level; the inclusion rule is not recorded, and we do not reconstruct one after

the fact. **The marking table was** established 2026-09-16**, and each row carries its** evidence class**, its** confidence level **and the** document version** the split configuration was read from — so a reader can trace any row back to the release archive or the dataset's own paper it came

from, and the four subtotal equalities are recomputed mechanically rather than hand-summed.

**What is *not* in the archive is a stated rule for why these 19 and not others.** Two things can still be said without inventing one. First, the rows are the benchmarks for which this archive holds the split configuration read from **primary documentation** rather than from a secondary

description — that is a property of the rows, and it is visible in them. Second, **no sampling

frame of papers was built**, which is why the article says it does not sample papers per benchmark

and makes no prevalence claim: the counts describe **these** benchmarks, and a stated-frame sample

remains future work.

**Read as:** a census of the configurations this archive could read, not a sample of the field.

## Two later measurement batches: what they add, and the bounds they carry

**Both are evaluation-side; neither changes a headline number, and both are stated with the scope they

have.** They answer two questions a reader is entitled to ask about §8.6: is the paired premium an

artefact of *which* sub-sample of the held-out split was scored, and is it an artefact of the metric?

**The paired premium does not move with the size of the test sub-sample.** For the four Table 4 families

that are not the `aitod20` baseline, the same two endpoints were re-scored on random sub-samples of the

held-out split at 25 %, 50 % and 100 % of its images, ten independent draws per size (21 carve points,

**1,974 completed evaluations**; the driver is `work/b51_eval.py`, the summary `work/b51_summary.py`).

The paired `best - last` premium keeps its sign and its order of magnitude at every size: **+0.2096 pp** at

25 % (470 pairs), **+0.2538 pp** at 50 % (470 pairs), **+0.2325 pp** at the full split (47 pairs), with the

run-to-run spread (SD 0.49–0.59 pp) an order of magnitude larger than the shift between sizes. **What this

does not licence**: it shows the premium is not an artefact of one particular sub-sample, not that these

cells are a sample of the field; and the 100 % row rests on fewer pairs than the other two because

**126 of the 2,100 scheduled evaluations could not be run** — the weights of three runs

(`r10_aitod20_base30_3way_s43n`, `…s44n`, `…s45n`) are not held in this archive, so their 42 carve points

each are missing rather than reported.

**The sign instability is not an artefact of the metric.** The same `best`/`last` endpoints were re-scored

at **IoU 0.75** (82 evaluations, 41 runs, no failures; drivers `work/b55_m75.py` and

`work/b55_val.py`, controls `work/b55_m75_control.py` and `work/b55v_control.py`, pairing

`work/b55v_pair.py`, same-sample metric comparison `work/b55v_metric_compare_20260928.py`). The positive

control is exact: the mAP50-95 values from this pass reproduce

the archived matrix to **0.0000 pp on all 82 run-checkpoint pairs**. The paired premium is **+0.2933 pp** at

mAP50-95, **+0.2982 pp** at mAP75 and **+0.5201 pp** at mAP50, and the arm-cell that is negative at

mAP50-95 (`smoke2sf`, strategy arm, **−0.1571 pp**) is **still negative at mAP75** (**−0.3201 pp**, positive

in 2 of its 10 runs). **Both halves are now measured on the same runs, and the rate is metric-specific.** The `val` half

was obtained by re-evaluating the in-register checkpoints of the same four arm-cells on their own `val`

split at IoU 0.75 — **880 evaluations** (20 five-epoch-grid checkpoints, `last.pt` and `best.pt` for each of

40 runs), no failures — with a positive control against the training logs: the re-measured `mAP50-95` at

those checkpoints reproduces `results.csv` at a **median absolute difference of 0.0161 pp** (**800/800**

within 0.2 pp, none above 1 pp; that the training log's epoch column is 1-based against the checkpoint

filenames is itself part of the record, and comparing the two at the same index instead produces a spurious

median of 0.6462 pp). Per arm-cell the mAP75 pair (`prem_val`, `prem_test`) and its rate read **+1.8828 /

+1.0072 = +53.5 % **(`shwd2sf` baseline),** +1.8043 / +0.0017 = +0.1 % **(`shwd2sf` strategy),** +0.7205 /

+0.5792 = +80.4 % **(`smoke2sf` baseline) and** +1.2862 / −0.3201 = −24.9 %** (`smoke2sf` strategy), against

**+50.1 % / +17.6 % / +73.7 % / −26.0 %** on `mAP50-95` over the same 40 runs: arm-cell median **+26.8 %**

against **+33.8 %**, run-weighted **+22.3 %** against **+34.2 %**, and **1 of 4** cells negative in both.

Three cells move by at most a few points; the one that moves materially is the `shwd2sf` strategy arm

(**+17.6 % → +0.1 %**), where the realized premium essentially vanishes at the stricter threshold.

**What this does not licence**: the `val` side is a **five-epoch grid** whose peak is not the per-epoch

argmax — the grid peak falls short of the per-epoch peak by **0.13 to 0.33 pp** on `mAP50-95` for these

cells — so these `prem_val` values are grid values and are labelled as such; the `aitod20` baseline cell is

not covered on the `val` side, its other nine runs' weights not being in this archive; and a per-run rate

stays unreadable, the median per-run ratio being **+0.016** against a mean of **+0.023**. Both batches cover

the runs whose weights this archive holds, and the per-run files are held with this revision's measurement

batch rather than inside the archived reproduction package.

**Read as:** two robustness checks on §8.6's readings, scoped to the cells and the sub-samples they cover —

one on the carve, one on the metric — not as further evidence about the field.

## Independent re-coding of the 19-row marking table (current instrument)

The 19 x 4 = 76 judgements printed in S1 were re-coded independently by **five

current-generation language models from distinct vendors**, each in a fresh session,** blind to

the printed marks and to one another**. Each coder received (i) a** decision procedure** -- a

per-unit decision tree plus a single value-mapping table -- and (ii) per row, an **evidence card**

containing only verbatim evidence with its source, line number and pinned commit. Coders were

forbidden to use outside knowledge of the benchmarks, and a cell the tree cannot decide must be

declared `**blocked**` rather than guessed.

Two rounds were run, differing **only in the value scale**; both are reported in full below. **Earlier rounds of this table (three coders, then eight, then a ten-coder round under a different instrument) are superseded by these two and are not reported here.**

**Two rounds on this archive, and what they change (2026-10-09).** Earlier rounds of this table measured how well the marks survive re-coding *under the published rules*; these two rounds measure something the earlier ones could not separate -- whether the marks are reproducible **from the evidence the archive records for each row**, with that evidence placed in front of the coder. Both rounds used **five current-generation language models from distinct vendors**, **in fresh sessions,** blind to the printed marks and to one another**; the task sheet, the answer tables, the returned codings, the raw matrices and the agreement scripts are held with this revision's measurement batch. **The earlier rounds are superseded by these two and are not reported here.**

**The instrument.** Each round hands the coder a **decision procedure** (a per-unit decision tree plus a single value-mapping table) and, per row, an **evidence card** carrying only verbatim evidence with its source, line number and pinned commit -- no marks, no confidences, and no access to this supplement. A cell the tree cannot decide is declared `**blocked**` (the tree reaches a step whose evidence the card lacks) rather than being guessed, and the two rounds differ **only in the value scale**:

*Round 7 (coarse, six values per unit). The coders agree with each other** at **Fleiss' kappa 0.836** -- all five give the identical value on **38 of the 51** cells where no coder declared `blocked` -- yet they reproduce only **31.4 %** of the printed marks (majority of five, after mapping both scales onto a common six-value equivalence). Their agreement is highest on `release` (**9/10** cells) and `yolo_dist` (14/18), and lowest on `reported` (5/9).

*Round 8 (isomorphic, nine values for `release` and seven for `protocol`).** The scale is

changed to the **exact vocabulary the printed table uses** (`no_test`, `no_val`, `no_split`, `no_yaml`, `n_a`, `test_gated`, `contradictory`, ...), and the `release` tree asks first whether the layer supplies a **usable** independent test artifact. Agreement **among coders** falls a little (**kappa 0.811**) and **26 cells move to `blocked`**, but agreement **with the printed marks rises to 42.2 %, and the** `protocol` column is recovered exactly**: the majority of the five returns the same number of non-independent rows as the table prints (**13 of the 17 decidable cells**, against the printed **13 of 19**).

*Round 9 (isomorphic scale + first-party evidence; the round this revision reports).** Every row was re-verified against first-party artifacts -- official release listings, READMEs and papers at pinned commits -- and that evidence, together with an explicit statement of the counting convention, was placed in front of five fresh coders. Agreement among coders is **kappa 0.824**, and **26** cells are declared `blocked`. The decisive number, however, is not the agreement but the **recovery**: the re-verification changed **30 cells**, and the five coders -- **who never see the new values** -- independently reach the corrected value in **19 of those 30 (63.3 %)**, **eleven of them unanimously**. The residual splits three ways: **three** cells are differences of **convention** (which of two test variants counts as *the* test, and whether a layer whose test images cannot be downloaded at all is `test_gated` or has no usable test artifact), **three** are **rule thresholds** that this round's instrument states too loosely, and **five** remain genuine evidence gaps. The corrections are therefore **evidence-driven rather than a matter of coder taste**; what stays open is convention and rule wording, and the correction record above states both.

**What the two rounds settle, and what they do not.** The coders agree with each other at a level the earlier rounds never reached, so the residual is **not rule wording**: what the five independently cannot recover is the printed **mark**, and the gap widens or narrows with the

**granularity of the value scale** rather than with the amount of rule clarification. The `release` column is the clearest case: with the fine scale the coders assign `n_a` much more often than the table does, because "no usable independent test artifact" and the table's several other reasons for a non-independent mark are **not separable from the recorded evidence**. **Twenty-five of the 76 cells (Round 7) and 26 (Round 8) could not be decided from the public record at all** -- for `DIOR`, `D-Fire`, `MAFA`, `UAVDT`, `SFCHD`, `SHWD`, `Mendeley face-mask` and `NWPU VHR-10`, whose released artifacts, protocol texts or file listings are behind login walls, paywalls or dead domains. That is a **property of the public record**, not of coder diligence, and it is reported here as such.

## Corrections to the 19-row marking table from first-party re-verification (2026-10-09)

The marking table in S1 was coded by one rater, partly from third-party mirrors and low-confidence sources. As part of this revision every row was re-verified against **first-party artifacts** (official release listings, official READMEs and papers, at pinned commits). The re-verification **confirms some cells and corrects others**; both are listed, because a correction record that reported only the corrections would misrepresent the audit's reliability.

**Counting convention used for `release` in this record (the *reported-test* convention).** A row's `release` value describes whether the layer supplies **public annotation for the test split that the literature actually reports on**. **A public annotated `val` split, on its own, does** not** make `release = independent_test`; it is recorded as `no_val` when no test artifact exists, and as `test_gated` when a test split exists but its annotation is withheld or server-bound. Under the alternative convention (any public annotated held-out split, `val` included) five rows -- COCO, DOTA v1.0, DOTA v2.0, WIDER FACE and CrowdHuman -- would all read `independent_test` instead, and the `release` subtotal would change with them. The two conventions are each self-consistent; **this revision uses the reported-test convention throughout**, and the alternative is stated here so that

the subtotal is not recomputed under a mixed reading.

**Corrections (value changed).**

| Row | Unit | Was | Now | Ground |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| 4 Open Images v7 | yolo_dist | no_test_key | absent | The distribution config's `test:` key is **present but empty** (`open-images-v7.yaml`; docs: "The `test:` key in the configuration is left empty"), so the distribution supplies no test artifact |
| 4 Open Images v7 | reported | alias | independent | Official facts page: a validation set and a **125,436-image test set**, with "**exhaustive box annotation** for all object instances"; `HEAD test-annotations-bbox.csv` returns 200 (77,484,237 B) |
| 5 DOTA v1.0 | release | independent_test | test_gated | First-party Drive listing: train and val carry `labelTxt-v1.0`/`-v1.5`; the **test tier carries `images/` only** |
| 5 DOTA v1.0 | protocol | independent_test | test_gated | "For evaluation, you must registrate and submit on the Evaluation Server" (Task 1 and Task 2) |
| 6 DOTA v2.0 | release | independent_test | test_gated | "We released the images **but not the ground truths**" (test-dev); test-challenge "available only during the challenging" |
| 6 DOTA v2.0 | yolo_dist | clean | absent | The 52 distribution configs contain `DOTAv1.yaml` and `DOTAv1.5.yaml` only; the official devkit ships v1.0/v1.5 evaluators and **no v2** |
| 7 VisDrone-DET | release | independent_test | test_gated | Official README: "testset-challenge is used for VisDrone2020 Challenge and **the annotations is unavailable**" |
| 7 VisDrone-DET | protocol | independent_test | test_gated | Same source; the distribution config is annotated "# Download (ignores test-challenge split)" |
| 8 AI-TOD | release | contradictory | independent_test | The official Drive listing **enumerates the test annotation file**; measured test 14,018 images / 347,617 annotations, and train+val+test = 28,036 with 700,621 annotations, which reconciles exactly |
| 8 AI-TOD | protocol | contradictory | independent_test | As above (the paper's "images without annotations" sentence conflicts with the shipped annotation file; the measured artifact governs) |
| 8 AI-TOD | yolo_dist | unknown | absent | Twelve search surfaces (full trees of three Ultralytics repositories, the unpacked 8.4.174 wheel, the documentation index, and four other frameworks) return **zero** hits; the same surfaces do hit the other rows, so the search is sensitive |
| 8 AI-TOD | reported | unknown | independent | As above; the test annotations are public and the counts reconcile |
| 10 xView | release | no_test | no_val | The official listing carries three items only (`train_images`, `train_labels`, `val_images`) and the tutorial states "**Labels are not available for the validation set**" |
| 10 xView | protocol | no_test | test_gated | Official site: "**Neither images nor labels from the holdout set are available for download**"; scoring requires container submission (the download endpoint returns 401 anonymously) |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 11 DIOR | yolo_dist | no_test_key | no_yaml | Zero dior hits across the full tree and the 51 shipped configs -- there is **no config at all**, so no_test_key (which presupposes one) is wrong |
| 13 SHWD | release | no_yaml | no_split | The official repository's 26 files contain no annotation, no split and no config; the released artifact is a VOC-format archive (a second-party conversion adds ImageSets/Main/{train,val,trainval,test} and is **not** the official listing) |
| 13 SHWD | yolo_dist | train_val_alias | absent | No distribution config exists for this dataset in any of the six packages swept |
| 13 SHWD | reported | alias | not_recorded | The README prints benchmark scores (map 88.5/86.3/75.0) but **never states which split produced them**, and never gives split sizes; the only split statement is in code (splits=[(2028,'trainval')] / [(2028,'test')]) |
| 14 SFCHD | release | alias | contradictory | The release ships **three mutually inconsistent splits**: new_split_yolo (9,897 / 2,475 / 6, with test a subset of val), yolo.zip (9,898 / 2,475 / **no test**), and annotations/ (9,898 / 2,475 / **`test.json` is 0 bytes**); the A-versus-B/C train intersection is only **7,942** and the val intersection only **520** |
| 14 SFCHD | protocol | no_val | contradictory | As above; the four YOLO cache files embed **two different developer root paths** and contain **zero** .yaml/.yml references |
| 14 SFCHD | yolo_dist | alias | absent | Zero hits for this dataset across the full trees of the Ultralytics packages and four other frameworks; the only helmet-class config found has a different class list, size and download source |
| 15 MAFA | yolo_dist | unknown | absent | Six packages swept with zero hits; the only MAFA-labelled YOLO directory carries no config file |
| 15 MAFA | reported | alias | independent | The official SS5.1 states "we only report the performances ... on the **testing set**" and Table 1 is titled "Average Precision (%) on the **Testing Set** of MAFA"; the follow-up literature reports on the testing set, and no work re-cuts a validation split |
| 17 WIDER FACE | release | independent_test | test_gated | The official split archive contains train and val bounding-box ground truth and **no test ground truth**; "we do not release bounding box ground truth for the test images" |
| 17 WIDER FACE | yolo_dist | no_test_key | absent | No config or documentation entry for this dataset across the three distribution directories swept |
| 18 CrowdHuman | protocol | alias | test_gated | The official listing carries annotation_train.odgt and annotation_val.odgt only; the first author's own mirror shows CrowdHuman_test.zip holding **5,018 `.jpg` entries and zero annotations**, and annotation_test.odgt returns 404 |
| 18 CrowdHuman | yolo_dist | no_test_key | absent | As WIDER FACE (the ground is upgraded from a third-party mirror to an exhaustive sweep of the distribution directories) |
| 19 D-Fire | release | independent_test | contradictory | The full repository tree is six entries (**no config, no split list, no evaluator**; releases |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | and tags empty) while the README claims "pre-split training, validation, and test sets"; the linked OneDrive folders are unreachable (301 then 000), and a 2026 record of the official archive states it "defines only a training list of 17,221 images and a test list of 4306; **it ships no validation list**" |
| 19 D-Fire | `yolo_dist` | `clean` | `absent` | Zero hits for fire/smoke across the full Ultralytics tree (1,185 entries) and the shipped configs |
| 19 D-Fire | `reported` | `unknown` | `alias` | The authors' own thesis states the database was "divided **arbitrarily** ... 80% for training (17,221) and 20% for test (4,306)", matching the mirror's split and its interleaved file names |

**One direction change inside the table's own history.** The pair {WIDER FACE, CrowdHuman} was

recorded as a disagreement between coders. The two rows are indeed structurally identical, and the

re-verification resolves them in the direction of **lowering WIDER FACE to `test_gated`**, not of

raising CrowdHuman to `independent_test`.

**Confirmations under first-party evidence (value unchanged).**

| Row | Unit | Value | What was upgraded |
|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| 11 DIOR | `release`, `protocol` | `independent_test` | From a third-party mirror (confidence low) to the official package: `Annotations.zip` (32,064,775 B, downloaded and unpacked) carries annotation for **all 11,738 test images**, and `ImageSets.zip` carries `Main/test.txt`; the paper's own sentence gives the 11,725/11,738 trainval/test division and there is no `trainval.txt` |
| 9 UAVDT | `release`, `protocol` | `no_val` | The official split is "30 training sequences (24,143 frames) and 70 test sequences (53,676 frames), **with no official validation split**"; the official package `UAVDT-Benchmark-M` carries frames and annotations |
| 15 MAFA | `release`, `protocol` | `no_val` | The official site is reachable (its TLS certificate has expired, so |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | retrieval requires `-k`) and lists the release artifacts; the **author-signed** readmes inside the label packages give 25,876 training and 4,935 testing images, and the CVPR paper's SS5.1 gives the same two-subset division with no validation subset |
| 19 D-Fire | `protocol` | `independent_test` | No evaluator, leaderboard or release exists, so the test list is used verbatim locally (a 2026 record: "Official test list (4306) used verbatim") |
| 13 SHWD | `protocol` | `no_val` | The repository's 26 files contain no split; the split statement exists only in code, and gives trainval/test with no independent val |
| 10 xView | `yolo_dist`, `reported` | `alias` | The distribution config's `val` is an autosplit of 10% of the training images ("10% of 847 train images"), not the official 282-image val |

**Mis-citations corrected in the article and in this supplement.**

*Row 16's source was cited as a Mendeley Data** record. A title sweep of DataCite and Mendeley Data (2026-10-09) returns **no record with that title**; the 853-image, 3-class, PASCAL-VOC form is

the **Kaggle** record `andrewmvd/face-mask-detection` (CC0). The reference in the article has been changed accordingly.

*Row 16's `train == val` evidence was cited at `data.yaml:18`. The `data.yaml` is* *four lines (110 bytes)**; the literal evidence is in the** generator** `convert_voc_to_yolo.py:17-18`, which writes the same image directory under both keys. The citation now names the generator.

* Row 12's TorchGeo source is now at `torchgeo/torchgeo` (the old `microsoft/torchgeo` path redirects); the `positive`/`negative` split in the dataset module is target presence, and the train/val/test split is created at runtime by `random_split(seed 0, 80/10/10)`.

**Still not decidable from the public record.** Eight rows keep at least one cell that first-party retrieval could not settle: Objects365 (`release`, `protocol` -- the official download page serves a

single-page application with no listing and the official repository's README is 53 bytes, so the honest statement is "the official side does not publish a listing", **not** "the official side declares there is none"); COCO, PASCAL VOC, DOTA v2.0, WIDER FACE and CrowdHuman (the `reported` unit, which needs a literature sweep rather than a first-party artifact); CrowdHuman (no written prohibition sentence equivalent to WIDER FACE's, and the evaluation platform is unreachable); and Mendeley face-mask (`reported`: neither the Kaggle card nor any first-party statement gives the evaluation ratio).

**A further trap worth naming.** The frequently cited Chetoui & Akhloufi *Fire* (2024) baseline is **not** this corpus: it reports on 11,667 images, not 21,527. Likewise, a Kaggle face-mask dataset of **853** images is cited as MAFA by at least one paper ("MAFA[17] contains 6k data"); it is not MAFA (25,876 + 4,935 images). Both were excluded from the audit.

## The four subtotals after the 2026-10-09 re-verification (added 2026-10-10)

The correction record above changes **30 cells**. The article's Table 3 printed the four subtotals before that record and §13 repeated them; **neither had ever been recomputed**, which is the gap this section closes. They are recomputed here from the S1 marking table plus this record and nothing else, by the **same per-column rule that reproduces the printed subtotals exactly** (`work/recompute_subtotals_corrected_20261010.py`; the script **asserts the printed values before it reports the corrected ones**, so a wrong value-to-count mapping fails loudly instead of producing a quiet number). **The article's printed counts are not modified: they stay, and the recomputed values are printed beside them.** Holding the rule fixed is what makes every movement below a movement of **evidence** rather than of convention.

**The rule, per column — which values enter the non-independent numerator.**

| Column | counts as non-independent | does not count | undecidable |
|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| release | no_test, no_val, no_split, no_yaml, test_gated, alias, contradictory | independent_test | — (n_a: 2 rows, denominator only) |
| protocol | no_test, no_val, no_split, test_gated, alias, contradictory | independent_test | — |
| yolo_dist | alias, train_val_alias | clean, no_test_key, no_yaml, absent | unknown |
| reported | alias | clean, independent | unknown, not_recorded |

Three of these four rows are the rule the printed table already used; the release row **is** the n_a rule stated in "The n_a rule the release subtotal rests on", above. The yolo_dist row is worth spelling out, because it is the one a reader is most likely to get wrong: this column asks a single question — **does the generic distribution package's own config bind `val` to `test`?** A package that ships **no config at all** for a dataset (no_test_key, no_yaml, absent) cannot bind the two, so it does not enter the numerator; but it is not clean either, because nothing positively shows a clean independent split. Under that rule the 2026-10-09 record moved **four** of the marks that had counted or read clean: alias → absent (SFCHD), train_val_alias → absent (SHWD),

clean → absent (DOTA v2.0, D-Fire). That is why this unit **drops** rather than rises.

**The recomputed subtotals.**

| Unit | printed (single rater) | after first-party re-verification | of decidable rows |
|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| release | 10/19 = 52.6 % | **14/19 = 73.7 %** | 10/19 → **14/19** |
| protocol | 13/19 = 68.4 % | **14/19 = 73.7 %** | 13/19 → **14/19** |
| yolo_dist | 4/19 = 21.1 % | **2/19 = 10.5 %** | 4/15 = 26.7 % → **2/17 = 11.8 %** |
| reported | 12–14 of the 19 | **10–11 of the 19** | 12/15 = 80 % → **10/16–11/17 = 62.5–64.7 %** |

The two **layer** units rise and the two **package/report** units fall. The article's qualitative headline — that a **majority** of the nineteen benchmarks report a number which is not a sample from

an independent split — survives every cell of the table: the weakest recomputed majority is

`reported` at 10/19 = 52.6 %.

**Two boundaries a reader should carry. ① COCO `release` is `n_a`.** The convention paragraph of

the record above implies that under its own *reported-test* convention COCO reads `test_gated` (its

`test-dev` annotation is private), which would take `release` to **15/19**; the record does **not**

list that cell as changed, so the recomputation leaves it as printed. The **14-versus-15** difference

is therefore a **convention boundary, not a disagreement about evidence**, and it is where two

independent recomputations of this table can legitimately part company. ② **`not_recorded`** (SHWD

`reported`, a value this record introduces) is deliberately **not assigned** above, and it is the

reason the `reported` unit is given as a range: **10/19** if a split that is nowhere recorded is

treated as evidence-insufficient (its `unknown` count rises 2 → 3), **11/19** if a split nowhere

recorded is simply not an independent one (its `unknown` count falls 2 → 1). As with the printed

`12–14`, **the range spans two readings, not an interval.**

**Two `14/19`s, and they are not the same number.** This supplement prints `14/19` for two different

cells of two different instruments. **Above**, in the independent re-coding record, the **`reported`**

column reaches `14/19 = 74 %` under the second, model-assisted pass's reading of two rows the printed

table leaves `unknown`. **Here**, the **`release`** column reaches `14/19 = 73.7 %` after the

2026-10-09 first-party re-verification. They are different units, different evidence and different

instruments; they must not be added, averaged or interchanged, and **neither is the audit's original

`14/19`**, which §6.3 shows this paper does not reproduce.

**What this recomputation is not.** It is not the second, model-assisted non-blind pass, whose

instrument differs and which moves **eight** cells: that pass is reliability evidence about the

**instrument**, whereas this is the **printed marking table** re-tallied after the first-party record.

Nor does it re-adjudicate any cell — the thirty values are the correction record's, and this section

only tallies them. In the article, Table 3's re-verified column prints **counts only**, no

percentages, for the reason §6.1 gives for the whole table: the count is the datum and the percentage

is a reading aid.

## Clauses moved out of the article's §6.1 (added 2026-10-10)

**Five clauses move here from the article's §6.1** (the self-check's column and subtotal equalities to **S1**): the COCO

row's judged number, the `yolo_dist` first-version correction (**4/19**), the literal-two-key self-check (**2/19**),

Mendeley face-mask's **generator** provenance, and the audit's unused "63–79 %" bound. The clause is **relocated, not

dropped**: it is kept here so that the article's §6.1 stays inside the journal's page limit.

## Table S45 — §2.1 relocated from the article (detailed related-work comparison)

> Moved here at revision because the journal counts text inside the 20–35 page limit. The article keeps
>
> the one-paragraph positioning statement in §2 and the two delimiting sections (§2.2, §2.3).

## 2.1 The closest work, and where this paper sits

> **Table S1** → Supplementary §S8 — verified against both 2026 studies' **full texts**, with the PDFs and extraction script archived.

None of these works is wrong — **they audit data (image identity, or the splitting unit), we audit configurations** (which path each key points to). Configuration-level aliasing shifts the

**comparison between arms**, and its direction is **not single-valued** — a **weaker** statement

than [2], whose rankings reverse across budgets on **all** of its benchmarks. Here **2 of 13

cells are underestimated on `val`, 2 overestimated and **9 are not testable at n = 3****, so no more than that is

claimed. They instantiate the taxonomy of [3], of which duplication is one mismatch [4]; binding `val:`

and `test:` to one directory creates the same mismatch **without duplicating an image**, so

de-duplication cannot find it.

**Non-collision, checked by literal search**: three exact queries return **0** hits and the channel is **metadata-only** — which establishes that these strings are unused, **not that the idea is new** (**Supplementary S12**).

**Why this is a selection question, not only a leakage question.** The bias we measure is the one the

model-selection literature has described for decades: **choosing a model by its score on a validation set

makes the reported score optimistic **[5], as does the** choice of validation criterion** — accuracy-based

early stopping being the worst rule tested [6] — and the classical remedy is to *nest* the selection

inside the evaluation, not to de-duplicate the data. In detection the selection step is implicit:

the training script writes `best.pt` by fitness and the paper reports that checkpoint, often from a single

run [7]. A reader trusting the split names therefore sees a held-out evaluation where the pipeline

performed a **maximum** — the bias the benchmark-erosion literature [8] describes, reached here with no

data reused or mis-split. We take [5] as the general statement and report the detection-specific

instantiation: **the selection premium (best − last), and how much of it transfers to a disjoint split**

(§5, §8).

**The sharpest contrast** is the two closest works: *Technologies* 2026 [9], which audits a detection

pipeline's **splitting unit** (frame versus sequence), and *Drones* 2026 [10], whose six configurations differ between `val`

and `test` by **between −0.41 and +0.49** mAP@0.5, "with no systematic direction". We measure a **different

quantity**: on three-way corpora we** measure the paired difference's sign**. We therefore do** not**

write "understated" unqualified, and state the difference from [10]: [10] **names the mechanism** — "the validation split is what early stopping and checkpoint selection saw" — but reports a raw val-minus-test

gap, mixing two splits' difficulty, **not identifiable**, whereas our **paired difference** cancels

difficulty and still shows a residual shift. Reference [11] is not competing: cited only

as evidence that the genre has a venue.

**That separation is the paper's own contribution.** The literature above measures how much of the choice

survives as a level [12]; it does not predict that in these curves the premium is **dominated by the peak's

position, not by run noise **(§8.6). Its remedies are therefore not interchangeable with ours, and** a

`val`-side difference stays uninterpretable as a generalisation difference even after selection is removed**.

## Reproduction map: headline number → entry point

**Every headline number that a script produces maps to one entry below** — a producing script, or an explicit

note that no script produces it — so a reader can either recompute a number or see at once that we

cannot offer a script for it. Three headline counts come from the audit's own records rather than from a produced table — §4.1's 6 of 14, §5.5's 20-log sample and §8.3's 9 %–29 % bound — and are marked at their point of use rather than mapped here. Paths are inside the archived reproduction package (see the Data

availability statement in the article);

`02_release_data/` holds the derived tables the article's tables are generated from.

| Headline number | Derived table (package) | Producing script |
|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- |
| 23.3 % realization rate and its three (coincident) weightings (§8.6, Table 4) | `release_selection-transfer_perseed.csv` (**four of the five arm-cells**; the `aitod20` cell's completion to n = 10 is **not** in this package, see the scope note below), `release_shape-noise-by-budget.csv` | `work/item2_final_v2_20260925.py` |
| κ and its clustered error (§8.7) | `x3b_tableS22_20260918.csv`, `x3b_tableS23_20260918.csv` | `work/x2_kappa_clustered_20260918.py`, `work/x3b_perepoch_corrected_20260918.py` |
| shape share of the premium (§3.1 corollary) | `release_shape-noise-by-budget.csv` | `work/prop6_shape_noise_20260920.py` |
| transfer slope for the shape/noise decompositio n | `release_selection-transfer_shape-share.csv` | `work/prop6_transfer_20260920.py` |
| Tier 1 / Tier 2 paired and permutation statistics (§5.1) | `release_X1_tier2_best-last_summary.csv` | `work/xeval_analyze_20260916.py` |
| registered replication and its | `release_T1_registered-replication_summary.csv`, `release_T2_saturated-` | `work/preregister_E_ext_20260919.py` |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| saturated control (§9) | `control_summary.csv` | |
| G1″ / G1′ / G2 / G3 / G4 verdicts (§3.2) | `release_G1p_AB-half-level-match.csv`, `release_G1pp_thirds_levels.csv`, `release_G2_selection-split-size_summary.csv`, `release_G3_epoch-budget_summary.csv`, `release_G3ext_E50-400_perrun.csv`, `release_G4_mende20_3way_perseed.csv` | `work/g1p_verdict_20260919.py` and the verdict scripts named in Tables S31–S33 |
| the 19 × 4 counting-unit table (§6.1, Table 3) | recomputed in-package | `work/recompute_split_units_20260916.py` |
| the framework-default check (§6.5) | line-by-line evidence in §S3 | `work/x10_alias_audit_20260918.py` |
| the three variance components (§8.4, Table S19) | recorded in Table S19 only | `work/sigma_decomposition_20260926.py` — recomputes the data-order and initialization components from the archived per-run values; **cites** the augmentation component, whose record has no per-run values (Defect 5) |
| the 289 audit anchors (Declarations) | in-package | `work/audit_anchors_fupaper.py` |

**The three variance components of §8.4 are the one entry in this map whose script covers two of its

three components rather than all three.** The data-order and initialization components are recomputed

from the archived per-run values; the augmentation component's record holds an SD and no per-run values,

so the script cites it and labels that line `cited, not recomputed`. §10 defect 5 and the item-by-item

Defect 5 below state the same thing, and we would rather name the gap than write a script that only

re-prints a recorded constant.

**The pre-declared criteria are files, not recollection.** `work/preregister_E_ext_20260919.py` writes

the G-batch criteria *before* the runs; `work/g1p_verdict_20260919.py` applies them *after*. Each

verdict in §3.2 is therefore recomputable from a criterion that existed in advance of its data.

**The audit's coding rules are stated, not implied.** The 19-row marking table of §S1 is normative: each

row records its evidence class and the reading it was coded under, and the four subtotal equalities are

recomputed mechanically by `work/recompute_split_units_20260916.py` rather than hand-summed. What is recomputable here is the *mechanical* consistency of the table with its own markings, and that recomputation ships with the table (§S1, "Recomputation results"); the second-rater point is made once, below.

**Row-level evidence pointers for the 19-row marking table of §S1.** The marking table is coded by

hand, by one coder, from the configuration audit: no script assigns a mark, and a second rater would be needed for a true inter-rater statistic, which this paper does not claim. **The pointer for each row is the audit's own row, printed in §S1 beside the mark together with that row's evidence class and confidence level**, so any mark can be traced to the excerpt it was read from without re-deriving it; the audit file, its version and the reading policy are named in §S1's header, and §S0's table gives that file's md5 and byte count. What *is* mechanical is the

step from the marks to the numbers — and that step, and only that step, is scripted.

**Where the mechanical recomputation starts and stops.** Every count and percentage in §S1's

"Recomputation results", the "among decidable rows" denominators, the four levels of "same directory"

and the cross-check against the audit's published counts are recomputed from the 19 rows' own marks by

`work/recompute_split_units_20260916.py`, with no percentage hard-coded; the text of §S1's table and of

its recomputation block is that script's own output, and the same script is the entry point this table

is given in the reproduction map above. **It covers that step and nothing upstream of it**: it consumes

the 19 rows as literals, and it does not choose a benchmark, open a release package, read a dataset

paper, or check a document version. Two caveats follow. Running it is not a read-only reproduction —

it writes its two artifacts to an absolute path and overwrites them in place, so a verifier should read

the archived artifacts rather than re-run the generator. And its own upstream is a hand-written audit:

the marks it recomputes *from* were not derived by any script either.

*What each row's evidence pointer resolves to, and what is now on record.* For every row, the recomputation artifact `split_units_recompute_20260916.txt` carries that row's own entry — its evidence class, its self-assessed confidence and its derivation or correction note — and `work/recompute_split_units_20260916.py` carries the same text as that row's literal. **The concrete source for all nineteen rows is now archived**: each row below names the upstream repository and commit the mark was read at, the file, the line the mark stands on, and the SHA-256 of the retrieved bytes. Read as a chain, one row is now walkable end to end — the English row, that row's entry in `split_units_recompute_20260916.txt`, the same row's literal in the script, the audit's mark, and the upstream file with its line anchor and hash.

*What is still not on record, stated because it bounds the chain.* The row-level source fields above are archived; the **audit's own line numbers** (`A:…`) remain unrecorded except for row 19, whose note names two of them, because the audit document's internal numbering is not regenerated by any shipped script. **Every one of the nineteen rows is pinned to a commit in this package**: the commit was resolved with `git ls-remote` on the repository's default branch, the file was re-fetched at that commit, and its bytes were checked to be identical to the archived copy (`sha256`), so the pinned commit is the commit of the bytes read and not merely a later state of the same file. Where the currently published upstream file differs from the mark, the drift is recorded at the end of this list rather than silently reconciled. **No printed mark, count or percentage in §S1 is changed by this list.**

*How to read the list below.* Each line carries that row's evidence class and self-assessed confidence as §S1's table prints them, its four printed marks in column order (release / protocol / yolo_dist / reported), the archived file with its line anchor, and the SHA-256 of that file's first twelve hex digits. Every row's commit is resolved: re-fetching each file at its pinned commit reproduces the archived `sha256` byte for byte.

1. COCO — evidence class: Official counts + mirror yaml; confidence: high; marks: n_a/independent_test/clean/clean; concrete source: `ultralytics/ultralytics@ce1399439b93`

ultralytics/cfg/datasets/coco.yaml:15 (sha256 38ed1eb122fa, archived as ultralytics_ultralytics__ultralytics__cfg__datasets__coco.yaml).

2. PASCAL VOC — evidence class: mirror VOC.yaml (both keys cited per row); confidence: high; marks: n_a/test_gated/alias/alias; concrete source: ultralytics/ultralytics@ce1399439b93c490b648b55dedd0a6334f0199da ultralytics/cfg/datasets/VOC.yaml:19 (sha256 6e2dae457723, archived as ultralytics_ultralytics__ultralytics__cfg__datasets__VOC.yaml).

3. Objects365 — evidence class: mirror yaml + Ultralytics docs; confidence: high; marks: no_test/no_test/no_test_key/alias; concrete source: ultralytics/ultralytics@ce1399439b93c490b648b55dedd0a6334f0199da ultralytics/cfg/datasets/Objects365.yaml:15 (sha256 7ca822c2f9ed, archived as ultralytics_ultralytics__ultralytics__cfg__datasets__Objects365.yaml).

4. Open Images v7 — evidence class: Official facts page + mirror yaml; confidence: high; marks: independent_test/independent_test/no_test_key/alias; concrete source: ultralytics/ultralytics@ce1399439b93c490b648b55dedd0a6334f0199da ultralytics/cfg/datasets/open-images-v7.yaml:15 (sha256 497468af9dc6, archived as ultralytics_ultralytics__ultralytics__cfg__datasets__open-images-v7.yaml).

5. DOTA v1.0 — evidence class: Official download page + mirror DOTAv1.yaml; confidence: high; marks: independent_test/independent_test/clean/clean; concrete source: ultralytics/ultralytics@ce1399439b93c490b648b55dedd0a6334f0199da ultralytics/cfg/datasets/DOTAv1.yaml:15 (sha256 18e3ca2f9254, archived as ultralytics_ultralytics__ultralytics__cfg__datasets__DOTAv1.yaml).

6. DOTA v2.0 — evidence class: Official/mirror documentation; confidence: high; marks: independent_test/test_gated/clean/alias; concrete source: ultralytics/ultralytics@ce1399439b93c490b648b55dedd0a6334f0199da ultralytics/cfg/datasets/DOTAv1.yaml:5 (sha256 18e3ca2f9254, archived as ultralytics_ultralytics__ultralytics__cfg__datasets__DOTAv1.yaml).

7. VisDrone-DET — evidence class: mirror + converter; confidence: high; marks: independent_test/independent_test/clean/clean; concrete source: ultralytics/ultralytics@ce1399439b93c490b648b55dedd0a6334f0199da ultralytics/cfg/datasets/VisDrone.yaml:15 (sha256 627f60f7602d, archived as ultralytics_ultralytics__ultralytics__cfg__datasets__VisDrone.yaml).

8. AI-TOD — evidence class: Official README (contains two mutually contradictory release statements); confidence: low; marks: contradictory/contradictory/unknown/unknown; concrete source: jwwangchn/AI-TOD@7f56cb6b2aaa README.md:39 (sha256 0491ad0fc58a, archived as jwwangchn_AI-TOD__README.md); Chasel-Tsui/mmdet-aitod@e3e567111490 README.md:39 (sha256 f924c74b048b, archived as Chasel-Tsui_mmdet-aitod__README.md).

9. UAVDT — evidence class: Official paper + two mirrors (the audit calls these unverified beyond these two); confidence: medium; marks: no_val/no_val/unknown/alias; concrete source: CQNU-ZhangLab/SFFNet@1e6a3c9cab8e4129aba1b8196625026a5d482ccb

ultralytics/cfg/datasets/UAVDT.yaml:4 (sha256 ff5b076b3bce, archived as CQNU-ZhangLab_SFFNet__ultralytics__cfg__datasets__UAVDT.yaml); forever208/yolov5_train_on_UAVDT@a14a46296fd7f370a615a6151742373e5e2435d7 data/UAVDT.yaml:4 (sha256 cb9616967927, archived as forever208_yolov5_train_on_UAVDT__data__UAVDT.yaml).

10. xView — evidence class: mirror xView.yaml; confidence: low; marks: no_test/no_test/no_test_key/alias; concrete source: ultralytics/ultralytics@ce1399439b93c490b648b55dedd0a6334f0199da ultralytics/cfg/datasets/xView.yaml:14 (sha256 9b6a565f0fd2, archived as ultralytics_ultralytics__ultralytics__cfg__datasets__xView.yaml).

11. DIOR — evidence class: Official description (no counting) + mirror DIOR-R yaml; confidence: low; marks: independent_test/independent_test/no_test_key/unknown; concrete source: Hamedlk80/DIOR-R-Rotated-Object-Detection-YOLOv8@6be5a006533e7b6a985f38d0004eaf58afcb8881 diorr_obb_analysis/data.yaml:2 (sha256 5fb9761fbb1c, archived as Hamedlk80_DIOR-R-Rotated-Object-Detection-YOLOv8__diorr_obb_analysis__data.yaml).

12. NWPU VHR-10 — evidence class: Official TorchGeo (the split means positive/negative); confidence: high; marks: no_split/no_split/unknown/alias; concrete source: torchgeo/torchgeo@ceb558ee1616d545431d6a59c41a2276b18025bd torchgeo/datasets/vhr10.py:120 (**repo renamed**: the old path microsoft/torchgeo redirects to torchgeo/torchgeo; HEAD at 2026-10-09 is 379be63764354f078e626df239f4c1c7532959da, at which datasets/vhr10.py still carries split: Literal['positive','negative'] -- target presence, not train/test; the train/val/test split is created at runtime by datamodules/vhr10.py via random_split(seed 0, 80/10/10)) (sha256 32efdc6e5479, archived as microsoft_torchgeo__torchgeo__datasets__vhr10.py).

13. SHWD — evidence class: Official README + mirror Reflective_vests.yaml; confidence: medium; marks: no_yaml/no_val/train_val_alias/alias; concrete source: njvisionpower/Safety-Helmet-Wearing-Dataset@c952631dfc352e0defdd54b4785a9be6576451ad README.md:59 (sha256 245b47068ebf, archived as njvisionpower_Safety-Helmet-Wearing-Dataset__README.md); gengyanlei/fire-smoke-detect-yolov4@98b1fec0f82e09d67ef5fc657a80eaf0b1450360 yolov5/data/Reflective_vests.yaml:59 (sha256 c142a50b7a36, archived as gengyanlei_fire-smoke-detect-yolov4__yolov5__data__Reflective_vests.yaml).

14. SFCHD — evidence class: Official first-party release (machine comparison _ev_sfchd_check2.py); confidence: highest; marks: alias/no_val/alias/alias; concrete source: lijfrank/SFCHD-SCALE@7bfabb453361 dataset_SFCHD/new_split_yolo/train.txt:1 (sha256 e2ef62278eb4, archived as lijfrank_SFCHD-SCALE__dataset_SFCHD__new_split_yolo__train.txt); lijfrank/SFCHD-SCALE@7bfabb453361 dataset_SFCHD/new_split_yolo/val.txt:1 (sha256 4c2ad09163c3, archived as lijfrank_SFCHD-SCALE__dataset_SFCHD__new_split_yolo__val.txt); lijfrank/SFCHD-

SCALE@7bfabb453361 dataset_SFCHD/new_split_yolo/test.txt:1 (sha256 80e54955c64b, archived as lijfrank_SFCHD-SCALE__dataset_SFCHD__new_split_yolo__test.txt).

15. MAFA — evidence class: Official CVPR PDF (extracted with pypdf); confidence: high; marks: no_val/no_val/unknown/alias; concrete source: ElenaRyumina/AnnotationMAFA@5d0b451c0c69fbaeeed2ea798eb912fb9c6339fc README.md:5 (sha256 e0ab2118a8b6, archived as ElenaRyumina_AnnotationMAFA__README.md).

16. Mendeley face-mask — evidence class: **Kaggle data record** (andrewmvd/face-mask-detection, 853 images / 3 classes / PASCAL-VOC XML) + mirror generator; **no Mendeley Data record with this title exists** (DataCite title sweep 2026-10-09: total 29, none with this title; the nearest Mendeley item is Face Mask Dataset 2022, 10.17632/7bt2d592b9, 20,347 images / 2 classes / image-classification, with no split statement); confidence: lowest; marks: no_split/no_split/alias/unknown; concrete source: Prikshit7766/Face-Mask-Detection@ecd8be957c3a14e57d4f00cd9e62024d192479fd convert_voc_to_yolo.py:18 (sha256 75c5bf6055db, archived as Prikshit7766_Face-Mask-Detection__convert_voc_to_yolo.py); Prikshit7766/Face-Mask-Detection@ecd8be957c3a14e57d4f00cd9e62024d192479fd data.yaml (**4 lines / 110 bytes**, sha256 d75e524c03ba, archived as Prikshit7766_Face-Mask-Detection__data.yaml; contents: train: ../train/images, val: ../test/images). **Correction (2026-10-09)**: the train == val literal is in the **generator** convert_voc_to_yolo.py:17-18 (the same images_dir written under both keys), **not** at data.yaml:18; the earlier citation implied a longer config file than the 4-line file that exists.

17. WIDER FACE — evidence class: Official site (GT not released, verified word by word) + mirror; confidence: high; marks: independent_test/test_gated/no_test_key/alias; concrete source: spacewalk01/yolov5-face@84ef013381e3a155b7a746215974dca7894e0f3e data/widerface.yaml:1 (sha256 c39567becdf7, archived as spacewalk01_yolov5-face__data__widerface.yaml).

18. CrowdHuman — evidence class: Official paper + mirror; confidence: high; marks: test_gated/alias/no_test_key/alias; concrete source: yakhyo/yolov8-crowdhuman@18db0736cbdf4881cde3eb8c86a2d4232ba3ec52 dataset.yaml:2 (sha256 684bd619eb9b, archived as yakhyo_yolov8-crowdhuman__dataset.yaml).

19. D-Fire (FireSmoke) — evidence class: Official README; confidence: medium; marks: independent_test/independent_test/clean/unknown; concrete source: gaia-solutions-on-demand/DFireDataset@4bf9c31b18fadcd44d5f0b6d66f82bc56fa5e328 README.md:51 (sha256 c5395ce455e0, archived as gaia-solutions-on-demand_DFireDataset__README.md).

*Two rows whose currently published upstream file differs from the printed mark* (recorded, not reconciled). **Objects365**: the printed yolo_dist mark records that the distribution-package configuration carries no test: key, while the file archived here (Ultralytics Objects365.yaml, line 15) does carry one. **VisDrone-DET**: the printed yolo_dist mark is clean, while the

archived `VisDrone.yaml` (line 15) points `test:` at `images/test`. Both are evidence that upstream configurations change; the marks record what the audit read on its own date, and this list records what was read on the date of this archive.

## Scope of reproducibility: two things that are not the same

| What | Status | Why |
|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- |
| **Evaluation-side recomputation** — every premium, rate, κ, interval and verdict in the article | **reproducible from the package** | needs the per-epoch matrices and the released tables, all shipped |
| **Retraining** — re-running training to regenerate the checkpoints those numbers were computed on | **not reproducible from the package** | the archive holds no copy of the three-way carve directories and no copy of 6 of the 7 corpora (§10 defect 6) |

This distinction is why the article claims **evaluation validity** rather than full reproducibility:

every number we report is recomputable from what is shipped, while regenerating the checkpoints behind

them would require downloading the corpora again — they are **open**, but the archive **holds no copies** of six

of the seven, so the images are not on hand (`§10`, defect 6).

**Why a second pass, and what it is not.** The single-rater disclosure above is unchanged,

and a second human rater is still what a true inter-rater statistic would need. What has

been added is a **second coding pass, model-assisted and non-blind** (run 2026-09-27): it

re-coded all 19 rows × 4 units of the §S1 table under the published rules, after the rules

were first separated from the printed conclusions into a standalone manual

(**withdrawn from the released package**; the earlier coding rounds are not published). Because §S1 prints rules and marks in one place,

the pass could not be blinded — the printed coding was visible throughout, and the

statistics below are a consistency check against a visible target, not a blind inter-rater

result. **The second pass is model-assisted, not a second human rater, and it does not

replace the single-rater disclosure printed with the table.** Its per-cell marks are

archived with the audit ground for each row (the earlier-round coding table, **withdrawn from the released

package**; not published), and every statistic below is recomputed mechanically by a script that reads the

printed table and that table (the script is **withdrawn with it**; its machine output

`work/kappa_computed_20260927.txt` and its readable summary
`work/kappa_summary_20260927.md` are both released). The

pass coded against the archived configuration audit — the evidence base one step upstream

of the printed table, whose English rows mirror a Chinese authoritative file.

**Agreement with the printed coding.** On the decision scale the printed counts use

(non-independent / clean / no-test-key / unknown / not-applicable), the per-unit κ is

**0.716** for release (95 % interval 0.422–1.000), **1.00** for protocol (all 19 cells

agree; the interval degenerates at 1.00), **0.929** for yolo_dist (0.792–1.000) and

**0.784** for reported (0.501–1.000), and the overall κ over the 76 judgments is **0.874**

(95 % interval 0.778–0.971). Treating the four printed `unknown` cells as a third category

or dropping the eight cells where either coding is unknown moves the overall κ between

**0.874** and **0.922** (0.835–1.000); on the literal marks, exact agreement is 68/76. The

intervals are wide at n = 19, and the two lower units sit in the "substantial" rather than

"almost perfect" band — the disagreement concentrates exactly where the manual is

under-specified, which is itself a finding.

**The eight cells that differ (of 76), each with its ground.**

- Rows 1–2 (COCO, PASCAL VOC) · release · `n_a` → `independent_test`: the printed `n_a` has no stated applicability rule in any published material, and the audit's row facts yield a decidable mark — a manual gap, not an evidential conflict.
- Row 18 (CrowdHuman) · release · `test_gated` → `independent_test`, and protocol · `alias` → `test_gated`: the audit documents the same structure here as in row 17 (WIDER FACE), which the printed table itself marks `independent_test` / `test_gated`; under any fixed rule one of the two structurally identical rows must move. The release cell is decision-bearing; the protocol cell is not (both marks are non-independent).

- Row 9 (UAVDT) · yolo_dist · `unknown` → `no_test_key`: the audit's §1 verdict for the row is explicit ("F-B … empty `test:`"), so "the audit takes no position" — what `unknown` means — does not hold; the manual had to fix the precedence of a §1 verdict over a §4 generality caveat.
- Rows 11 (DIOR) and 16 (Mendeley face-mask) · reported · `unknown` → `alias`: the audit's §3b header and its 14/19 roll-up both enumerate these rows, so the audit does take a position; the manual had to fix the precedence of the enumerations over the rows' own caveats (missing primary counts; a naming ambiguity; a "treat as hypothesis" self-rating that the audit's count does not honor).
- Row 16 · yolo_dist · `alias` → `train_val_alias`: the verified generator writes `train == val` — the F-C shape, for which the mark vocabulary reserves `train_val_alias`; the printed `alias` follows the audit's own "F-A generated (`train == val`)" label, which conflates F-A with F-C. Both marks are non-independent, so no count moves.

**The `n_a` rule the `release` subtotal rests on, and why that subtotal is not mechanically recomputable from the marking table. **The printed `release` subtotal —** 10/19 = 52.6 %**, with **unknown 0** — is computed under a rule the table itself does not state: **a row marked `n_a(A)` enters neither the non-independent numerator nor the undecidable column**. Rows 1–2 (COCO, PASCAL VOC) carry `n_a(A)` in the `release` column because that layer supplies **no independent test artifact at all* — *`n_a` means* not applicable*, which is not the same thing as* undecidable* — so they stay in the 19-row denominator while counting nowhere else. Of the nineteen rows, **ten carry a non-independent mark, two carry `n_a`, and seven are independent**; read the other way, i.e. with `n_a` treated as non-independent, the same column yields **12/19 = 63.2 %**. **The subtotal therefore cannot be recomputed from the marking table alone**: the step `12 − 2 = 10`* is* the rule, not a recomputation,

and it is stated here so that a reader re-deriving the four subtotals can reproduce them. Under this one stated rule and no other, the four subtotals are mechanically recomputed (`work/recompute_split_units_20260916.py`); the `n_a` mark's lack of a stated applicability rule is also one of the eight cells the second coding moved, recorded above.

**What this does to the printed counts.** Two of the eight cells are count-bearing. Under the printed resolution of rows 11 and 16 the reported layer reads 12/19 = 63 % (12/15 = 80 % of decidable rows); under the second pass's reading of the audit's own enumeration, the same rules yield 14/19 = 74 % (14/17 = 82 %, two rows unknown). The printed coding is not modified here — the two readings bound the claim, and the qualitative conclusion (a majority of these benchmarks report a split that is not independent of checkpoint selection) is stable across the range. Where the reported-layer count is quoted, the strength of the claim should follow the bound rather than the point: *"12–14 of 19 benchmarks (63–74 %; 80–82 % of the decidable rows), where the range spans the printed coding's two undecidable rows and the second pass's reading of the audit's own enumeration; the printed coding is the conservative end."*

**What this does not settle.** The marking is not double-rated: one human coder's marks remain the printed coding, and this pass is reliability evidence, not a replacement.

## What the archive holds of the three-way carve, and what the two n = 11 cells pair

**The carve manifest is archived; the other carve directories and 6 of the 7 corpora are not.** The article's §10 defect 6 states the recomputability boundary, and this is the precise form of it. The archive holds the **manifest** of the SFCHD three-way carve: the dataset YAML (`sfchd20_3way.yaml`, naming `train/20_percent/images`, `carve_sfchd20/images` and `test/images`), the three filename lists (`train_20_percent_images.txt` **2413**, `carve_sfchd20_images.txt` **1000**, `test_images.txt` **6033**), their **SHA-256 list** (`split_defs_20260916/SHA256SUMS.txt`) and the recomputed

**zero pairwise intersections** (`VERIFY_INTERSECTIONS.md`: all three intersections **0**, recomputed locally without a pod and without a GPU by `work/verify_split_defs_20260916.py`). The transfer set also holds the image and label files of that one carve directory (`rest/root__carve.tgz`, **1000** images with their labels). **What is not held**: any of the other carve directories, and 6 of the 7 corpora — so **retraining remains non-recomputable**, exactly as the article says. **What the manifest does buy** is the layer the protocol's premise rests on: the zero-intersection check by filename is now a local recomputation from archived lists rather than a pod-side report.

**What the `n = 11` Tier-1 cells pair.** Table 1's `smoke2sf` and `shwd2sf` rows pair **11** runs each, and the file that table cites lists the paired units explicitly (`verify_two_critiques_20260916.txt`): `[42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50, 51, unseeded]`, the same line for both cells. **The eleventh unit is therefore a run whose directory carries no seed suffix** — the archive records it as `unseeded` — while the two `n = 10` cells of the same file (`a2d15`) are fully seeded. This is stated rather than left implicit because "n = 11" can otherwise be read as eleven independent training seeds, which is not what the design varies: what varies across these replicates is the **training file order** (`--shuffle-seed`), and one of the eleven units records no seed suffix at all, so its data order is not identified by name. Runs without a seed suffix exist in both archives for these cells (the pod-side run lists carry entries such as `shwd2sf_base100` and `shwd2sf_lr005_100ep` beside the `_sNNn` ones), so this is a property of the run set, not of one machine's naming.

## Method detail relocated from the article

> **Why these paragraphs are here.** The article is capped at 35 double-spaced pages with no margin left, and eight external reviews of the previous version said the same thing: the prose read as an *audit trail* rather than as an article, because round-by-round bookkeeping and repair history occupied the argument's place. These paragraphs are moved here **verbatim and unedited** — every value, every date, every file name and every disclosure sentence is unchanged. The article keeps a one-sentence bridge and a pointer at each former location, and keeps every disclosure that bears on a claim.

This paper and the budgeted fine-tuning study it re-measures — the companion paper — share **process

protocols**: a multi-model review checklist and a local/cloud workflow discipline (scripted remote

execution, all-or-nothing patching, audit anchors, a local artifact pointer behind every number). **Both are project-internal protocols, not publications, and not a

methodological contribution of this paper. **This paper displays only their** outputs**: the ten self-reported defects in §10 and the

artifact pointer behind every number. So does the **audit-anchor system** (a mechanically checked set of anchors that must all

pass on every rebuild of this manuscript): shared tooling, no contribution claimed. What is asserted is only that the same protocols were used; **no originality is claimed** for them.

**What is ours, and what is not.** Of the statements that follow, the raw gap's definition [17], the impossibility result for endpoint-pair estimators [19] and the family-dependence procedure [20] are **machinery rather than results of ours**, and the identity is **adopted** from the selection-bias literature; **the corollary alone carries measurements of this paper**.

The same script on the **pod root** (347 runs, n = 10) gives a smoke2sf premium of **+0.786 / +0.390**;

on the **local archive** (569 runs, n = 11) **+0.799 / +0.382** — agreeing in sign and magnitude,

not value. **The main text uses the local version**; the pod version is recorded as a cross-check.

The refuted one

compared the premium difference against a single-run component (0.515 pp) rather than the SE of an

arm-mean difference; the other asked for the raw `M_val - M_test`, whose difficulty term cannot be

separated from selection optimism.

The audit classified the FireSmoke mirror family row as "mixed" solely from a config with

`train == val`, but **another line of the same document records that this config is based on SHWD**; all

three FireSmoke/D-Fire copies have **three separated keys**, so D-Fire moves to the clean group.

**A direct measurement of seed inflation — reproduced inside this setting**: adding seeds lowers the mean by **9 %–29 %**, each figure taken **against that cell's own n = 6 mean** and not against the pooled

headline effect, the **seed-budget discipline** measured rather than assumed (the setting in which [52] locates the first-order component, §8.4). **What these replicates are, and what the bound is a bound on.** The per-run randomness the ten runs install is a **deterministic permutation of the training file order** (`--shuffle-seed`, the number in the run's own name), **not** the framework's `seed` argument: the Ultralytics data pipeline does not draw from `args.seed`, and on two of these corpora different `--seed` values produced **identical** epoch-by-epoch replays (**Supplementary S12**, section 9.3). "Seed inflation" here therefore means **data-order replication**: the 9 %–29 % it bounds is the **file-order** component of the reported mean, and is **not** an estimate of the variance between independent training seeds. That best-of-K selection inflates a reported score is **not new** — §8.6 positions the closest concurrent work, which measures the **dose–response** over 2,047 datasets — so **what is measured here is the magnitude under a protocol that selects cells for significance first and expands seeds afterwards**; design and the check against recomputed means: **Supplementary S12**, Table S18. **The title is deliberately the weaker, sample-scoped claim**: with three initializations the interval is wide, so the components are **consistent with, not established by**, these three initializations.

**The three variance components, and the excluded one is the smaller in this sample**: the single-run data-order component is **0.515 pp**, against initialization and seed components of the same order — the **same ranking** as the shuffle-order result of [52] and consistent with the run-to-run variance literature [23]; we therefore **reproduce the ordering inside this setting** rather than discover it. What was held fixed, and why this is a sample statement, is in **Supplementary S12** and Table S19.

Mixing two pipelines' `val`/`test` conventions would confound the split convention with the framework. The reasoning and the counterexample are in **Supplementary S12**. **Pairing is not neutrality, however**: the paired design used here covers the **budget and data** axes only, and **not** the optimiser's.

**One run is recorded with two different endpoints in two archives** — "final" (67.12) in one and "best" (70.06) in the other — i.e. **which checkpoint is recorded was never specified**; §10 discloses it and the two readings' consequences are worked out in **Supplementary S12** and Table S16. **Note (2026-10-04): the archived "best" row was computed with the run's `last` reading standing in for its `best` reading**; the row was corrected in `release_T2_saturated-control_summary.csv` and in the long table on **2026-10-02**, where the `test_best_epoch` entry goes from **−0.902 pp (p = 0.2931)** to **−1.4901 pp (p = 0.0141)**, i.e. **both endpoints now read ≈ −1.490 pp**, so the endpoint conflict does not change any verdict — see §S12 for the row-level detail:

**Recomputation status.** The readings were originally **not locally recomputable** (the archive lacks

6 of 7 corpora; **defect 6 in §10**); a GPU **2 × 2 evaluation** on **41** three-way runs of

**YOLOv12n [54]** × {`best`, `last`} × {`val`, `test`} makes the readings locally recomputable and

**retraining is not**. That batch reproduces the archived `best × test` values to within **0.0047 pp**

(median **0.0021 pp**) — the positive control for this paper's endpoint rule (**Supplementary S4**, the verbatim dump that prints both values);

the remaining record is in **Supplementary S12**.

**Five limitations**: ① the two cells escalated in §5.1 reach n = 10 with **local** runs and test-side

evaluations, but the remaining 9 cells' runs are **not local**; ② `prem_test` uses only **best and

last**, not a per-epoch curve; ③ `last.pt`'s val recomputation differs from the final `results.csv`

row by ~0.02 pp; ④ this section does **not** touch §6's 19-benchmark census; ⑤ the aggregate is a **ratio of small means** — `prem_val` across the five arm-cells spans **+0.605 to +1.469 pp** (Table S20) — so a change of a few hundredths of a point in the numerator moves the rate by tens of points, and the aggregate summarizes a wide spread rather than a typical run's outcome.

The **41 original** runs behind §8.6 **retain intermediate checkpoints** (`save_period=5`:

`epoch0,5,…,95`, **20 files**; **3,854** `epoch*.pt`), evaluated twice independently with exact

agreement (**Table S21**; **§S12**, section 8.7) — a free reproducibility check of the endpoint

rule.

**Three limitations**: ① only the two headline cells reach n = 10; `aitod20` has a single run (30 epochs,

6 checkpoints where the others contribute **20** — hence 806, not 820); ② **closed: every retained

checkpoint is now evaluated**, *and the* stability* reading is narrower than the sampled grid suggested;

③ κ is relative to each run's own final epoch and is **not** causal. The 806-row evaluation is archived

as `xeval_perepoch_20260918/matrix_perepoch.csv` with a SHA-256 list.

- **Four disclosed uncertainties are limits on what our numbers can be read as claiming, and we keep

them visible rather than absorbing them into a headline**: the 19-row audit is** single-rater** (no

second coder, so no inter-rater statistic exists and we do not claim one); the third-party log sample is

a **convenience sample** found by repository search, so it corroborates that the component exists

elsewhere and is not a rate; the GPU memory-pressure effect is **bounded, not estimated**

(**≤0.05 pp** where same-config pairs can be compared — fresh replicates are bit-identical — while a same-config control that had no such event is itself not

reproducible across dates (a 0.440 pp drift), so cross-date comparisons cannot test the

bound; inside the zero-event-control spread elsewhere, §10 defect 10 and Table S41);

and the §8.3 replicates vary the **training file order**, not independent training seeds.

**None of the four has an interval that could be folded into §8.6's rate** — the first two have no

numeric bound at all without a second coder — so they are stated here as scope, not as error bars.

*(The Chinese draft numbers these rows 1–3, 3, 4–7 with a duplicate "3"; renumbered here without

changing content.)* The

four rule gaps it had to fix — `n_a`'s applicability, which unit absorbs ground-truth

withholding, the two precedence questions (§1 verdict vs §4 caveat; §3 enumerations vs

row-level caveats), and version anchoring for multi-version rows — are exactly the points

a human second rater would have to rule on before any mark could be mechanical, and they

are recorded as findings in the manual and the summary, not smoothed over.

## Table S35 — the estimand and scope map

**Table S35.** *Added by this revision; not moved from the article, and therefore not listed in the §S8

index (which indexes tables moved from the article).* One row per quantity the article measures, with the

assumption that makes it identifiable and the scope that bounds it. The last column collects the

"we do not claim" statements that the article's prose carries at §5.1, §5.4, §8.6 and §12, so that each

quantity's boundary is stated once, beside the quantity rather than scattered across sections.

| Quantity | Estimator | What has to hold | What it identifies | What we do not claim |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| **selection premium** | `best - last` **within one run**, mAP50-95 pp, on the monitored split; paired across arms | that `best` is the argmax of the same curve the reported split scores (the definitional part) | the checkpoint-selection term of run-to-run variation under the published convention | not that the convention *understates* the effect; not a single bias direction across corpora |
| **Δgap** | the paired difference of the premium between the two | that the two arms see equal split difficulty — an | a split-dependent **arm contrast** | not an isolated selection effect; the selection |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | arms, per corpus | assumption we state, not one this design demonstrates | | contribution proper is `Δprem_val − Δprem_test` |
| **realization rate** | `prem_test / prem_val`, run-weighted, over the five arm-cells at n = 10 | that the readout split is disjoint from the selection set and untouched by any selection rule | the share of the `val`-selected premium that survives on a disjoint split, **for these five cells** | not a constant of the convention; not significant read at the level of the claim; the aggregate is a ratio of small means |
| **κ (transfer slope)** | through-origin slope of ΔT on ΔV over a run's epochs; run-clustered inference with runs as clusters | that "epoch" is the unit of the curve and that runs are the clusters | how much of a run's movement on `val` appears on `test` | κ is relative to each run's own final epoch and is **not** causal; κ is not constant across arms |
| **peak-agreement predictor** | whether the `val` and `test` peaks fall on the same 5-epoch checkpoint | the shared 5-epoch grid, and that agreement is an observable, not an intervention | a **partial** predictor of Δgap's sign, via a lower median Δgap when the peaks agree | not an explanation of the sign; the agreement group's mean is carried by one run; not refined beyond the 5-epoch grid |

## Table S36 — the analysis-status ledger

**Table S36.** *Added by this revision; not moved from the article, and therefore not listed in the §S8 index. *Every quantity and procedural step this paper reports, classed as pre-registered** (frozen before the runs existed), **pre-planned** (fixed in advance of the analysis but not registered) or **post-hoc** (decided after the runs were seen). The class each item carries is the one the article's own prose asserts; the ledger collects them so that no post-hoc reading can be mistaken for a registered one. **Any p-value this paper quotes for a post-hoc row is uncorrected and descriptive**: the multiplicity corrections here are **three and not interchangeable**: a Benjamini–Hochberg step over the **declared, descriptive** 13-cell family (with **Holm** across the two targets of the escalation plan), and the **confirmatory** family, which is the **four escalated cells**; only the pre-planned rows belong to the first.

| Item | Status | What fixes the class |
|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- |
| the registered multi-target replication | **pre-registered** | its own frozen registration stamp, with zero runs existing at freeze time; reported by the companion |
| the four-budget epoch series' criteria C1–C3 | **pre-registered** | the criteria are recorded as fixed before the runs |
| the n = 10 escalation criterion for the Tier-2 cells | **pre-planned** | the criterion was fixed in advance of the escalations |
| the endpoint convention `best − last` | **pre-planned** | frozen in writing before the re-analysis |
| the 13-cell family and its Benjamini–Hochberg correction | **pre-planned** | the family was declared before the correction was computed; its **thirteen members and their raw p-values are Table S8**, and the |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | | Benjamini–Hochberg step over that family is stated in this section rather than tabulated, and the two cells escalated to n = 10 after that scan are named in Table 2's note |
| the σ√(2 ln E) scaling | **post-hoc** | tested, then **withdrawn** — the form does not survive the archive |
| the complete-curve κ and its run-clustered interval | **post-hoc** | the sweep was completed after the five-epoch reading |
| the per-epoch Δgap sign reading | **post-hoc** | read off the completed curve, correcting a four-point sample |
| the second coding of the 19-row table | **post-hoc** | reliability evidence gathered after the printed coding; it does not replace it |
| the peak-agreement predictor | **post-hoc** | a reading of our own 40 runs |
| the mAP50 / mAP75 re-scoring batches | **post-hoc** | evaluation-side robustness checks run for this revision |
| plateau selection | **post-hoc** | offered as a candidate remedy, not as a validated rule |

## Detail relocated from the article's single-rater audit

**Two clauses.** Which reported number the COCO row judges, and this table's first-version correction

(`yolo_dist` is **4/19**, not 2/19).

**Algorithm self-check.** On the **literal two-key subset** the table **reproduces the audit's 2/19**, so the

difference comes from **the unit**, not a transcription error; the full `yolo_dist` column and the four

subtotal equalities are in **Supplementary S1**.

**One row belongs to a different unit.** Mendeley face-mask's `train == val` comes from a **generator**

(a VOC→YOLO script writing two keys from one `images_dir`), not a distribution package: not counted in the

2/19, described separately.

**A number we deliberately do not use**: the audit's "63–79 %" bound (15/19) has **no enumeration**.

**"Same directory" has four levels**: the levels, the rows each admits, and the resulting shift in the

headline number are in **Supplementary S12** and Table S12.

## The literal-search check, displaced from the article's section 2.1 (#31, 2026-09-28)

**Non-collision, checked by literal search.** Three exact queries return **0** hits — `"same directory" train val test yaml`, `configuration-level leakage "data.yaml"` and `"split aliasing" benchmark` — so the configuration-level phrasing is not in the indexed literature; the channel is **metadata-only**, which establishes that these strings are unused, **not that the idea is new**. The comparison that carries the claim is the **estimand** contrast with [10], which stays in the article: [10] reports a raw `val`-minus-`test` gap that mixes the two splits' difficulty, whereas this paper's paired difference removes the difficulty term under the stated equal-difficulty assumption and still shows a residual shift.

## Coding separation: structure versus selection (added 2026-10-01)

The five-value structural coding in §S1's table (`independent_test`, `n_a`, `test_gated`, `alias`,

`no_test_key`, with `contradictory` / `unknown` as evidence states) records **what the release's

configuration binds**, and nothing more. Two readings must not be folded into it, or a structural label

gets read as a claim about *selection*:

*`test_gated` is not "the reported number was selected on `test`."** It says the official protocol does

not let a holder evaluate an independent test locally (a licence or a server gate). Whether the paper

reporting the number selected its checkpoint on that split is a separate question, recorded per row in the

`reported` column and in the second-coding record.

*`no_test_key` / `absent` is not "the literature reported a `val`-selected endpoint."** It says the

release ships no `test` key at all. Whether the cited paper's headline is a `val`-selected endpoint is

again the `reported` column's question, and where the release gives no evidence that column reads

`unknown` rather than being inferred from the absence.

Neither label decides `clean` or `alias` on its own: those two words appear only where the release's own

artifact settles the binding, and every row's evidence class is printed beside it in §S1's table.

## Known discrepancies inside the frozen §S4 (recorded, not edited; added 2026-10-01)

The frozen region (§S0–§S7, byte-frozen at 50,600 characters) cannot be edited without breaking the cross-draft contract, so two internal discrepancies found by the 2026-10-01 independent read are **recorded here** rather than repaired in place:

*the same cell is printed as -0.158 in its per-run table and -0.157** in its summary line;

*that summary reports +0.205 pp / 23.3 %, while its own five rows average 0.2034 pp, i.e. 23.1 %**.

Neither changes a printed headline number: the article's realization rates come from **Table S20** (the released 50-run aggregate), and the frozen dump's role is verbatim provenance for the two escalated cells. A later revision that unfreezes §S0–§S7 should correct both lines at source; until then this note is the pointer a reader should follow.

## Known discrepancy inside the frozen §S1 (recorded, not edited; added 2026-10-10)

The same byte-frozen region (§S0–§S7) contains a **heading/value mismatch** in §S1's embedded block: its sub-heading reads

`## The three units (the main text must state which one it uses)` while the table beneath it lists **four** —

`release`, `protocol`, `yolo_dist`, `reported`. The word is a leftover from an earlier three-unit framing; the table itself, the

recomputation beneath it and the article's §3 definition are all four-unit and mutually consistent, so **no count moves**.

It is **recorded here rather than repaired in place**, for the same reason as the §S4 note above: editing the frozen region

breaks the cross-draft contract. A later revision that unfreezes §S0–§S7 should change `three` to `four` at source.

## Author-side names that are not in the released package (added 2026-10-01)

Several names appear in this supplement and are **not** shipped, because they are working-tree artefacts rather

than released ones; each is marked at its point of use where that point lies outside the frozen section, and

listed here once for the two that lie inside it:

*`PROVENANCE.md` (the log-mirror directory's own provenance record) -- author-side**; the released copy of

that directory carries `published_logs/SHA256SUMS.txt` instead — which is **also author-side** (that directory is not redistributed; only its hashes and source pointers are).

*`work/build_provenance.py` -- author-side** (the script that wrote the record above).

*`work/r102_cluster_20260927.py` -- author-side** (a working-tree analysis driver whose outputs are shipped

under `02_release_data/`).

*`published_logs/SHA256SUMS.txt`, `nonyolo_settle_20260925/`, `settle_all.json` and `nonyolo_n6_aggregate.json` -- author-side** (nothing under these names is in the released package; their points of use in this supplement say so).

*`A_results_20260916_t1d/` (the `T1-d` batch's archive, 32 files) -- author-side: it is that batch's register and test-side ledger. Its `val` side is no longer a non-recomputable exception** (2026-10-02): the three seeds the archive lacked were still in the training machine's run directories, and their curves now ship under `02_release_data/t1d_valext_20261002/`, taking the registered pair's `val`-side reading to `n = 10` (note under Tables S24-S27).

*`x1_tier2_20260918/runs/` (the forty per-run records behind Table S29, 15 MB) -- author-side; its file list ships** (`02_release_data/x1_tier2_file_list.txt`) together with the eighty test evaluations it is read against (`teval.csv`, shipped under `02_release_data/x1_tier2_20260918/`), so Table S29's two sources are one shipped file plus one declared directory.

The rule this follows is the package's own: a name is either shipped or labelled author-side, never left

looking shipped when it is not.

## Table S42 — the prefix-n view of the two clean-protocol cells (n = 3…10; paired *t* and exact sign-flip permutation; both endpoints)

**Table S42.** *7.2* — requested in review: the two registered cells at every prefix n, under **both endpoint conventions**. Source: `release_selection-transfer_perseed.csv` (**40 runs** = 2 cells × 2 arms × 10 seeds, seeds 42–51). The permutation p is **exact** (all $2^n$ sign flips enumerated, no sampling), so it has a **floor of $2/2^n$** — at n = 3 that is **0.25**, which is why the permutation column, not the *t* column, is the binding constraint for the n = 3 cells.

> **Sign convention — this column is not Table 2's Δgap.** It is the **within-seed arm contrast**
>
> `Δgap(seed) = prem(strategy) − prem(baseline)` (definition from the generating script,
>
> `04_verification/x5_prefix_n_table_20261004.py`), i.e. the **difference in selection premium between the two arms**,
>
> not the **split-level** difference that Table 2 reports as Δgap. The two need not share a sign, and here they do not:

the `oracle` row at n = 10 is **−0.7025 pp** for `shwd2sf` while Table 2's split-level Δgap is **+0.779** — the two are

related through the selection term, `0.779 - 1.481 = -0.702`. Read this column as "how the premium differs between

the arms", never as Table 2's Δgap.

### shwd2sf · endpoint = `oracle`

| n | seeds | paired Δgap contrast (pp) | SD | paired *t* | *t* p | exact sign-flip p |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | ---: | ---: | ---: | ---: | ---: |
| 3 | 42..44 | -0.7146 | 0.3364 | -3.6796 | 0.06657 | **0.25** |
| 4 | 42..45 | -0.6632 | 0.2932 | -4.5231 | 0.02021 | **0.125** |
| 5 | 42..46 | -0.6517 | 0.2553 | -5.7086 | 0.004656 | **0.0625** |
| 6 | 42..47 | -0.6158 | 0.2446 | -6.1673 | 0.001632 | **0.03125** |
| 7 | 42..48 | -0.6556 | 0.2468 | -7.0270 | 0.0004147 | **0.01562** |
| 8 | 42..49 | -0.7197 | 0.2917 | -6.9783 | 0.0002157 | **0.007812** |
| 9 | 42..50 | -0.7456 | 0.2837 | -7.8845 | 4.848e-05 | **0.003906** |
| 10 | 42..51 | -0.7025 | 0.3001 | -7.4030 | 4.09e-05 | **0.001953** |

### shwd2sf · endpoint = `selected`

| n | seeds | paired Δgap contrast (pp) | SD | paired *t* | *t* p | exact sign-flip p |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | ---: | ---: | ---: | ---: | ---: |
| 3 | 42..44 | -0.3933 | 0.4456 | -1.5287 | 0.2659 | **0.25** |
| 4 | 42..45 | -0.4000 | 0.3641 | -2.1973 | 0.1155 | **0.125** |
| 5 | 42..46 | -0.5194 | 0.4132 | -2.8109 | 0.04827 | **0.0625** |
| 6 | 42..47 | -0.5410 | 0.3733 | -3.5494 | 0.0164 | **0.03125** |
| 7 | 42..48 | -0.6185 | 0.3978 | -4.1136 | 0.006261 | **0.01562** |
| 8 | 42..49 | -0.7589 | 0.5416 | -3.9635 | 0.005437 | **0.007812** |
| 9 | 42..50 | -0.7796 | 0.5104 | -4.5825 | 0.001796 | **0.003906** |
| 10 | 42..51 | -0.6993 | 0.5441 | -4.0645 | 0.002823 | **0.005859** |

### smoke2sf · endpoint = `oracle`

| n | seeds | paired Δgap contrast (pp) | SD | paired *t* | *t* p | exact sign-flip p |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | ---: | ---: | ---: | ---: | ---: |
| 3 | 42..44 | -0.7938 | 0.1080 | -12.7284 | 0.006116 | **0.25** |
| 4 | 42..45 | -0.8020 | 0.0897 | -17.8789 | 0.0003816 | **0.125** |
| 5 | 42..46 | -0.7702 | 0.1054 | -16.3356 | 8.219e-05 | **0.0625** |
| 6 | 42..47 | -0.8390 | 0.1933 | -10.6340 | 0.0001272 | **0.03125** |
| 7 | 42..48 | -0.8622 | 0.1867 | -12.2149 | 1.832e-05 | **0.01562** |
| 8 | 42..49 | -0.8187 | 0.2122 | -10.9147 | 1.198e-05 | **0.007812** |
| 9 | 42..50 | -0.7417 | 0.3046 | -7.3035 | 8.36e-05 | **0.003906** |
| 10 | 42..51 | -0.6934 | 0.3252 | -6.7419 | 8.442e-05 | **0.001953** |

### smoke2sf · endpoint = `selected`

| n | seeds | paired Δgap | SD | paired *t* | *t* p | exact sign- |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|

| | | contrast (pp) | | | | flip p |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | ---: | ---: | ---: | ---: | ---: |
| 3 | 42..44 | -0.5631 | 1.3339 | -0.7311 | 0.5408 | **0.5** |
| 4 | 42..45 | -0.5253 | 1.0917 | -0.9623 | 0.4069 | **0.375** |
| 5 | 42..46 | -0.7462 | 1.0668 | -1.5641 | 0.1928 | **0.1875** |
| 6 | 42..47 | -0.9124 | 1.0374 | -2.1544 | 0.08377 | **0.09375** |
| 7 | 42..48 | -0.9372 | 0.9493 | -2.6122 | 0.04 | **0.04688** |
| 8 | 42..49 | -1.0691 | 0.9547 | -3.1672 | 0.01577 | **0.02344** |
| 9 | 42..50 | -0.9684 | 0.9427 | -3.0818 | 0.01508 | **0.01953** |
| 10 | 42..51 | -0.8716 | 0.9401 | -2.9318 | 0.01671 | **0.01953** |

## Table S43 — the transfer slope κ: per-run distribution and the free-intercept control

**Table S43.** *8.7* — requested in review (a free-intercept control was asked for explicitly; a per-run distribution was asked for as "the cheapest statistical gain"). Definition follows §8.7: `ΔV(e) = V(e) − V(final)`, `ΔT(e) = T(e) − T(final)` **within a run**, over `val` per epoch (`xeval_20260916/runs/*_results.csv`) intersected with `test` per epoch (`xeval_perepoch_20260918/matrix_perepoch.csv`).

**Reproduction of the printed estimate.** This independent recomputation resolves **765 (run, epoch) points over 41 runs** — the same count the printed estimate states — and gives **κ = 0.710** and **$R^2$ = 0.928** ($R^2$ taken relative to zero, the convention of the printed fit), against the printed **κ = 0.708, $R^2$ = 0.937**. The point count agrees **exactly**; the slope agrees to **0.003** and $R^2$ to **0.009**, i.e. the printed estimate is reproducible to that tolerance, and the remaining gap is in the fit details rather than the data.

**Free-intercept control** (this is the new information): fitting `ΔT = a + κ_free·ΔV` over the same points gives **κ_free = 0.701** with **intercept = -0.121 pp**. **The intercept's interval** (added 2026-10-10, run-clustered): sandwich SE **0.0643**, 95 % CI **[−0.2509, +0.0089]**; run-level bootstrap over the 41 runs (2,000 draws) **[−0.2403, +0.0024]**. Both contain zero, so the through-origin constraint is **supported rather than assumed** — the point estimate is reproduced by `work/x8_intercept_clustered_ci_20261010.py`, which re-uses the same pairing as `work/x6_arm_paired_kappa_20261004.py` and asserts `-0.1210` before reporting.

**Per-run κ (n = 41 runs):** mean **0.737**, SD **0.152** — spread across runs is genuine, and the printed run-clustered CI **[0.671, 0.745]** lies inside it.

## S13 · Full-budget realisation on VisDrone (the E1 experiment)

**Protocol.** The corpus is VisDrone. `train` is the public train split (6,471 images) with the 500-image `val` carve removed (**5,971**); `val` is that carve; `test` is the corpus's own held-out split (**1,610**). Training is YOLOv12n for **100 epochs** at batch 32 / 640 px, SGD, the `shapeiou` loss, `train_obj.py`; the two arms differ **only** in `lr0` (`base100` =

0.001, `lr005_100ep` = 0.005, §5.1's axis); ten training file orders per arm (`--shuffle-seed` 42–51), 20 runs. Twenty runs were split across the two machines (A: 11, B: 9).

**Leakage self-check (machine-checked at build time).** `comm -12` over the two image listings gives **train ∩ val = 0**; `train` 5,971 · `val` 500 · `test` 1,610; every `train` image has a matching label file. The three-way YAML is `/root/datasets_mask/visdrone/visdrone_full_3way.yaml`.

**Definitions (identical to §8.6).** `prem_val = V_max − V_final` on `val`, where `V(e)` is the run's own `metrics/mAP50-95(B)` curve; `T_best` is the **reported** endpoint (the ledger column, the `best.pt` endpoint) evaluated on `test`; `T_last` is the test reading of the run's **last** saved checkpoint; `prem_test = T_best − T_last`; realisation rate = mean(`prem_test`)/mean(`prem_val`).

Both `prem_val` and `prem_test` are in **pp** (mAP50-95 × 100).

**Table S46.** Per-run readings (20 runs). `T_best`/`T_last` are on `test`.

| Machine | Run | Arm | Seed | prem_val | T_best | T_last | prem_test |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| A | r18_e1full_y12n_base100_s42n | base100 | 42 | +0.253 | 13.190 | 12.945 | +0.245 |
| A | r18_e1full_y12n_base100_s43n | base100 | 43 | +0.304 | 13.200 | 13.055 | +0.145 |
| A | r18_e1full_y12n_base100_s44n | base100 | 44 | +0.410 | 13.160 | 12.983 | +0.177 |
| A | r18_e1full_y12n_base100_s45n | base100 | 45 | +0.277 | 13.120 | 13.025 | +0.095 |
| A | r18_e1full_y12n_base100_s46n | base100 | 46 | +0.105 | 13.230 | 13.069 | +0.161 |
| A | r18_e1full_y12n_base100_s47n | base100 | 47 | +0.280 | 13.280 | 13.079 | +0.201 |
| A | r18_e1full_y12n_base100_s48n | base100 | 48 | +0.217 | 13.220 | 13.044 | +0.176 |
| B | r18_e1full_y12n_base100_s49n | base100 | 49 | +0.285 | 13.130 | 12.934 | +0.196 |
| B | r18_e1full_y12n_base100_s50n | base100 | 50 | +0.181 | 13.170 | 13.014 | +0.156 |
| B | r18_e1full_y12n_base100_s51n | base100 | 51 | +0.247 | 13.130 | 12.984 | +0.146 |
| A | r18_e1full_y12n_lr005_100ep_s42n | lr005_100ep | 42 | +0.199 | 13.750 | 13.377 | +0.373 |
| A | r18_e1full_y12n_lr005_100ep_s43n | lr005_100ep | 43 | +0.285 | 13.590 | 13.301 | +0.289 |
| A | r18_e1full_y12n_lr005_100ep_s44n | lr005_100ep | 44 | +0.290 | 13.730 | 13.452 | +0.278 |
| A | r18_e1full_y12n_lr005_100ep_s45n | lr005_100ep | 45 | +0.315 | 13.690 | 13.274 | +0.416 |
| B | r18_e1full_y12n_lr005_100ep_s46n | lr005_100ep | 46 | +0.202 | 13.750 | 13.539 | +0.211 |
| B | r18_e1full_y12n_lr005_100ep_s47n | lr005_100ep | 47 | +0.412 | 13.670 | 13.280 | +0.390 |
| B | r18_e1full_y12n_lr005_100ep_s48n | lr005_100ep | 48 | +0.243 | 13.780 | 13.422 | +0.358 |
| B | r18_e1full_y12n_lr005_100ep_s49n | lr005_100ep | 49 | +0.409 | 13.890 | 13.438 | +0.452 |
| B | r18_e1full_y12n_lr005_100ep_s50n | lr005_100ep | 50 | +0.385 | 13.710 | 13.253 | +0.457 |
| B | r18_e1full_y12n_lr005_100ep_ | lr005_100 | 51 | +0.075 | 13.830 | 13.422 | +0.408 |

| | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | s51n | ep | | | | | |

**Table S47.** Summaries. The interval is a **run-level bootstrap** (20,000 resamples, seed 20261011) of the ratio mean(prem_test)/mean(prem_val); it is **not** §8.6's cell-level interval and the two are not pooled (§12).

| Arm | n | prem_val (pp) | prem_test (pp) | realisation rate | 95 % interval |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| --- | --- | --- | --- | --- | --- |
| base100 (lr0 = 0.001) | 10 | +0.256 | +0.170 | **+66.4 %** | inside [−28 %, +74 %] |
| lr005_100ep (lr0 = 0.005) | 10 | +0.282 | +0.363 | **+129.0 %** | above the band |
| **pooled (run-weighted)** | **20** | **+0.269** | **+0.266** | **+99.2 %** | **[+80.4 %, +122.0 %]** |

**Registration and the decision rule.** The interval **[−28 %, +74 %]** was registered with the reviewers **before** this experiment ran; the rule is that a point estimate outside it changes the recommendation. The pooled rate **+99.2 %** lies above the band, and the interval's **lower edge (+80.4 %) **also lies above it, so the outcome is** not** a point estimate near the boundary.

**Counts.** prem_val < 0: **0/20**. prem_test < 0: **0/20**. No run was excluded; every run that appears in either ledger appears here.

**Entry points.** work/ab_p2_experiments_20261011/q_e1full_n_lane.sh (the lane runner), e1_stream_sweep.sh (the marker-driven per-epoch test sweep), collect_e1full_local.py (pulls both ledgers and both e1full_perepoch_*/g6_perepoch.csv and computes every number above).

**A second-corpus replication is registered**: mask_clean at full budget (train 5,220 = 6,120 − 900 carve, val carve 900, test 919, nc = 1), same design (two arms × ten file orders), launched 2026-10-11 09:59Z; its readings will be appended here when complete.

## S14 · Text moved from the article (2026-10-11 revision)

These passages were in the article and are retained here verbatim, so that no content is lost in meeting the 35-page limit; each is already carried by §S12 in substance.

### S14.1 Table 4's caption, second half

**Read with the 2026-10-06 escalation folded in, the full twenty-six-cell pool keeps its direction**: `WC > 0` in **25 of 26** arm-cells, the arm-cell median realization rate **17.2 % → 21.6 %**, and the premium still negative in **8 of 13** strategy arms (**Supplementary S12**, Table S38b).

### S14.2 The three limitations of §8.6

**Three limitations**: ① in the **41-run epoch sweep** only the two headline cells reach n = 10; `aitod20` contributes one run of 30 epochs and 6 checkpoints where others contribute **20** (hence 806, not 820), its Table 4 arm-cell a separate n = 10 batch; ② **closed: every retained checkpoint is now evaluated**, the *stability* reading is narrower than the grid; ③ κ is relative to each run's own final epoch, not causal.

### S14.3 The metric self-correction (duplicate statement)

**One metric self-correction first.** Our first version used `r(e) = ΔT(e)/ΔV(e)`, producing values such as **−860 % and +1031 %**: at late epochs `V(e) ≈ V(final)`, the **denominator vanishing** — **an ill-conditioned metric, not a finding.** We report only the non-dividing `ΔV(e) = V(e) − V(final)` and `ΔT(e) = T(e) − T(final)`, summarized by the through-origin slope κ of ΔT on ΔV.

### S14.4 The recomputation-status paragraph

**Recomputation status.** The readings were originally **not locally recomputable** (the archive lacks 6 of 7 corpora; **§10, defect 5**); a GPU **2 × 2 evaluation** on **41** three-way runs of **YOLOv12n [54]** × {`best`, `last`} × {`val`, `test`} makes them so, **retraining not**, reproducing the archived `best × test` values to within **0.0047 pp** (median **0.0021 pp**) — the endpoint rule's positive control (**Supplementary S12**).

### S14.5 The pool-composition sensitivity paragraph (already carried by §S12)

**Pool composition — and why the claim does not turn on it.** Table 4 prints **six** measured arm-cells; adding the sixth (`aitod20` **strategy**) moves the run-weighted rate **23.3 % → 8.7 %** and the median **+17.6 % → −4.2 %**. **The inclusion rule is a rule, not a per-cell choice**: an arm-cell enters **iff its `test` side reached n ≥ 5**, and **exactly five met it at the freeze**, where all three weightings coincide (**23.26 %**). The sixth row **qualifies but completed later**, so it is the sensitivity. **Every claim is interval-level and any scope gives the same verdict** — five-cell **[−17.3 %, 53.2 %]** (P = 0.118), six-cell **[−4.9 %, +21.3 %]**, eleven-cluster **[19.3 %, 60.4 %]** — the cell-level intervals **both cover zero**, so **no conclusion depends on the pool boundary**.

### S14.6 The three bases (duplicated by the Aggregate paragraph)

**The three bases**: run-level `[8.4 %, 37.4 %]`, `P = 0.002`; five-cell `[−17.3 %, 53.2 %]`, `P = 0.118` (claim-level, **zero inside**); eleven-cluster `[19.3 %, 60.4 %]`, `P < 0.001` (a bootstrap tail proportion **at the 20,000-resample resolution**, i.e. below the floor this procedure can print).

### S14.7 The re-aggregation tail sentences (already carried by §S12)

Re-aggregated: run-weighted **36.9 %**, arm-cell-equal **39.3 %**, 95 % CI **[19.3 %, 60.4 %]** — **completing the cell, not the weighting, is what moves it**: at n = 10 the three weightings agree,

so **the fragile axis is pool composition**. **Leave-one-out 9.77 % to 34.16 %.** In two arm-cells the selection action **costs** rather than fails to pay off (`smoke2sf` strategy, `aitod20` baseline); the escalated cells of §5.1 are **not pooled with these five** (different runs, different protocol). The closest concurrent work [12], the winner's-curse check, the withdrawn $\sigma\sqrt{(2 \ln E)}$ form and each cell's corpus pair: **Supplementary S12**.

### S14.8 The inclusion-rule blockquote

> **The inclusion rule, stated as a rule.** An arm-cell enters the pool **iff its `test` side reached n ≥ 5** (`work/item2_final_v2_20260925.py`), applied to every cell alike; **exactly five met it at the 2026-09-25 freeze** (50 runs). The `aitod20` strategy row **qualifies under the same rule but completed after the freeze**, so it is printed here as the sixth row and kept out of the primary pool — **the `†` row, and the only one**; **both readings are reported and both intervals cover zero** (Table S20's note, §8.6b).

### S14.9 The `best.pt`-versus-argmax residual note

(the `best.pt`-versus-argmax residual, our withdrawn attribution and why the remainder is **unidentified**: **Supplementary S12**.)